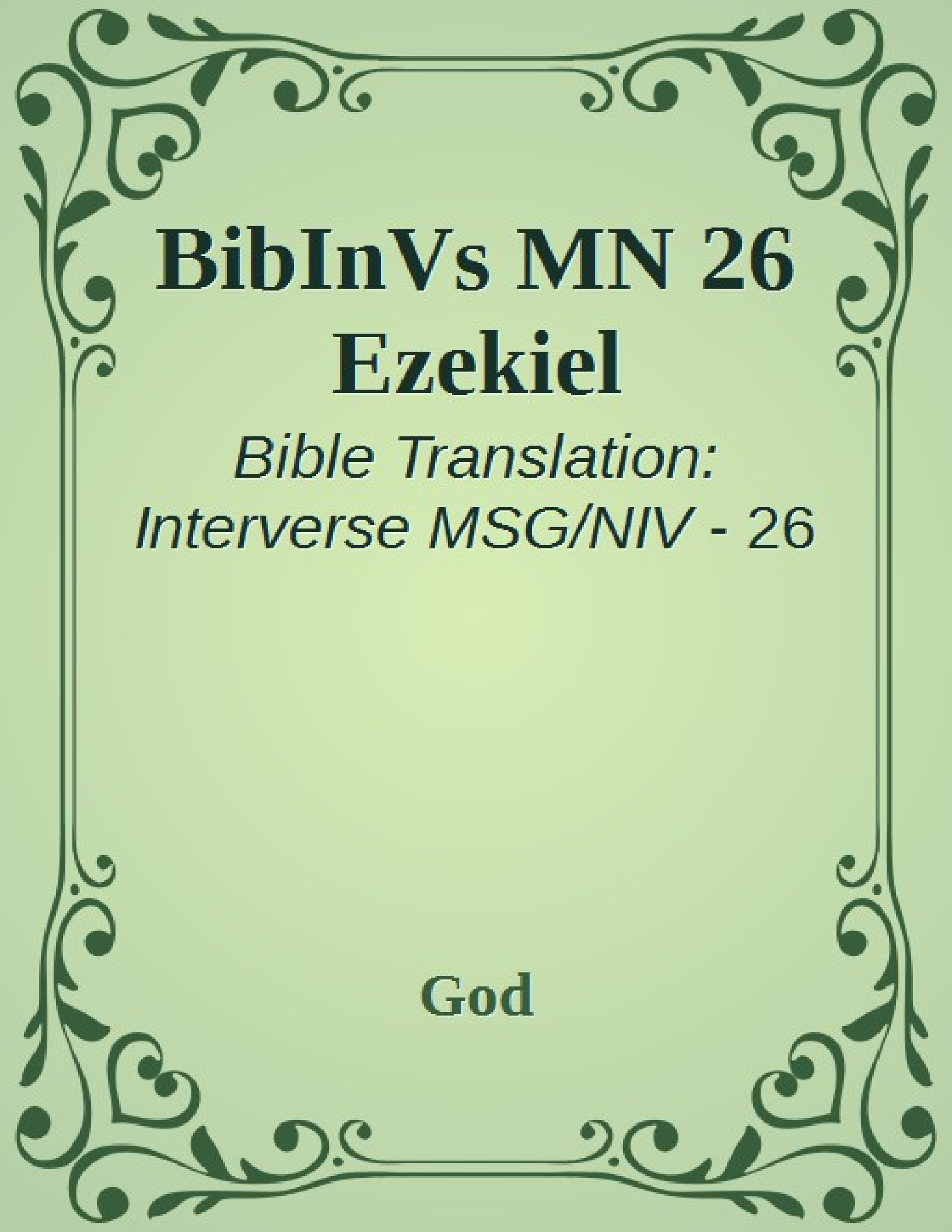


A decorative border with intricate floral and scrollwork patterns in a dark green color, framing the central text.

BibInVs MN 26

Ezekiel

Bible Translation:
Interverse MSG/NIV - 26

God

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Interversed Message/NIV Bible

Ezekiel

Ezekiel 1

MSG

NIV

- 1 When I was thirty years of age, I was living with the exiles on the Kebar River. On the fifth day of the fourth month, the sky opened up and I saw visions of God.
- 1 In the thirtieth year, in the fourth month on the fifth day, while I was among the exiles by the Kebar River, the heavens were opened and I saw visions of God.
- 2 (It was the fifth day of the month in the fifth year of the exile of King Jehoiachin
- 2 On the fifth of the month--it was the fifth year of the exile of King Jehoiachin--
- 3 that GOD's Word came to Ezekiel the priest, the son of Buzi, on the banks of the Kebar River in the country of Babylon. GOD's hand came upon him that day.)
- 3 the word of the LORD came to Ezekiel the priest, the son of Buzi, by the Kebar River in the land of the Babylonians. There the hand of the LORD was upon him.
- 4 I looked: I saw an immense dust storm come from the north, an immense cloud with lightning flashing from it, a huge ball of fire glowing like bronze.
- 4 I looked, and I saw a windstorm coming out of the north-- an immense cloud with flashing lightning and surrounded by brilliant light. The center of the fire looked like glowing metal,
- 5 Within the fire were what looked like four creatures vibrant with life. Each had the form of a human being,
- 5 and in the fire was what looked like four living creatures. In appearance their form was that of a man,
- 6 but each also had four faces and four wings.

- 6 but each of them had four faces and four wings.
- 7 Their legs were as sturdy and straight as columns, but their feet were hoofed like those of a calf and sparkled from the fire like burnished bronze.
- 7 Their legs were straight; their feet were like those of a calf and gleamed like burnished bronze.
- 8 On all four sides under their wings they had human hands. All four had both faces and wings,
- 8 Under their wings on their four sides they had the hands of a man. All four of them had faces and wings,
- 9 with the wings touching one another. They turned neither one way nor the other; they went straight forward.
- 9 and their wings touched one another. Each one went straight ahead; they did not turn as they moved.
- 10 Their faces looked like this: In front a human face, on the right side the face of a lion, on the left the face of an ox, and in back the face of an eagle.
- 10 Their faces looked like this: Each of the four had the face of a man, and on the right side each had the face of a lion, and on the left the face of an ox; each also had the face of an eagle.
- 11 So much for the faces. The wings were spread out with the tips of one pair touching the creature on either side; the other pair of wings covered its body.
- 11 Such were their faces. Their wings were spread out upward; each had two wings, one touching the wing of another creature on either side, and two wings covering its body.
- 12 Each creature went straight ahead. Wherever the spirit went, they went. They didn't turn as they went.
- 12 Each one went straight ahead. Wherever the spirit would go, they would go, without turning as they went.
- 13 The four creatures looked like a blazing fire, or like fiery torches. Tongues of fire shot back and forth between the creatures, and out of the fire, bolts of lightning.
- 13 The appearance of the living creatures was like burning coals of fire or like torches. Fire moved back and forth among the creatures; it was bright, and lightning flashed out of it.

- 14 The creatures flashed back and forth like strikes of lightning.
- 14 The creatures sped back and forth like flashes of lightning.
- 15 As I watched the four creatures, I saw something that looked like a wheel on the ground beside each of the four-faced creatures.
- 15 As I looked at the living creatures, I saw a wheel on the ground beside each creature with its four faces.
- 16 This is what the wheels looked like: They were identical wheels, sparkling like diamonds in the sun. It looked like they were wheels within wheels, like a gyroscope.
- 16 This was the appearance and structure of the wheels: They sparkled like chrysolite, and all four looked alike. Each appeared to be made like a wheel intersecting a wheel.
- 17 They went in any one of the four directions they faced, but straight, not veering off.
- 17 As they moved, they would go in any one of the four directions the creatures faced; the wheels did not turn about as the creatures went.
- 18 The rims were immense, circled with eyes.
- 18 Their rims were high and awesome, and all four rims were full of eyes all around.
- 19 When the living creatures went, the wheels went; when the living creatures lifted off, the wheels lifted off.
- 19 When the living creatures moved, the wheels beside them moved; and when the living creatures rose from the ground, the wheels also rose.
- 20 Wherever the spirit went, they went, the wheels sticking right with them, for the spirit of the living creatures was in the wheels.
- 20 Wherever the spirit would go, they would go, and the wheels would rise along with them, because the spirit of the living creatures was in the wheels.
- 21 When the creatures went, the wheels went; when the creatures stopped, the wheels stopped; when the creatures lifted off, the wheels lifted off, because the spirit of the living creatures was in the wheels.
- 21 When the creatures moved, they also moved; when the creatures stood still, they also stood still; and when the creatures rose from the ground, the wheels rose along with them, because the spirit of the living creatures was in the wheels.

- 22 Over the heads of the living creatures was something like a dome, shimmering like a sky full of cut glass, vaulted over their heads.
- 22 Spread out above the heads of the living creatures was what looked like an expanse, sparkling like ice, and awesome.
- 23 Under the dome one set of wings was extended toward the others, with another set of wings covering their bodies.
- 23 Under the expanse their wings were stretched out one toward the other, and each had two wings covering its body.
- 24 When they moved I heard their wings--it was like the roar of a great waterfall, like the voice of The Strong God, like the noise of a battlefield. When they stopped, they folded their wings.
- 24 When the creatures moved, I heard the sound of their wings, like the roar of rushing waters, like the voice of the Almighty, like the tumult of an army. When they stood still, they lowered their wings.
- 25 And then, as they stood with folded wings, there was a voice from above the dome over their heads.
- 25 Then there came a voice from above the expanse over their heads as they stood with lowered wings.
- 26 Above the dome there was something that looked like a throne, sky-blue like a sapphire, with a humanlike figure towering above the throne.
- 26 Above the expanse over their heads was what looked like a throne of sapphire, and high above on the throne was a figure like that of a man.
- 27 From what I could see, from the waist up he looked like burnished bronze and from the waist down like a blazing fire. Brightness everywhere!
- 27 I saw that from what appeared to be his waist up he looked like glowing metal, as if full of fire, and that from there down he looked like fire; and brilliant light surrounded him.
- 28 The way a rainbow springs out of the sky on a rainy day--that's what it was like. It turned out to be the Glory of GOD! When I saw all this, I fell to my knees, my face to the ground. Then I heard a voice.
- 28 Like the appearance of a rainbow in the clouds on a rainy day, so was the radiance around him. This was the appearance of the likeness of the glory of the LORD. When I saw it, I fell facedown, and I heard the voice of one speaking.

Ezekiel 2

MSG

NIV

- 1 It said, "Son of man, stand up. I have something to say to you."
- 1 He said to me, "Son of man, stand up on your feet and I will speak to you."
- 2 The moment I heard the voice, the Spirit entered me and put me on my feet. As he spoke to me, I listened.
- 2 As he spoke, the Spirit came into me and raised me to my feet, and I heard him speaking to me.
- 3 He said, "Son of man, I'm sending you to the family of Israel, a rebellious nation if there ever was one. They and their ancestors have fomented rebellion right up to the present.
- 3 He said: "Son of man, I am sending you to the Israelites, to a rebellious nation that has rebelled against me; they and their fathers have been in revolt against me to this very day.
- 4 They're a hard case, these people to whom I'm sending you--hardened in their sin. Tell them, 'This is the Message of GOD, the Master.'
- 4 The people to whom I am sending you are obstinate and stubborn. Say to them, 'This is what the Sovereign LORD says.'
- 5 They are a defiant bunch. Whether or not they listen, at least they'll know that a prophet's been here.
- 5 And whether they listen or fail to listen--for they are a rebellious house--they will know that a prophet has been among them.
- 6 But don't be afraid of them, son of man, and don't be afraid of anything they say. Don't be afraid when living among them is like stepping on thorns or finding scorpions in your bed. Don't be afraid of their mean words or their hard looks. They're a bunch of rebels.
- 6 And you, son of man, do not be afraid of them or their words. Do not be afraid, though briars and thorns are all around you and you live among scorpions. Do not be afraid of what they say or terrified by them, though they are a rebellious house.
- 7 Your job is to speak to them. Whether they listen is not your concern. They're hardened rebels.

- 7 You must speak my words to them, whether they listen or fail to listen, for they are rebellious.
- 8 "Only take care, son of man, that you don't rebel like these rebels. Open your mouth and eat what I give you."
- 8 But you, son of man, listen to what I say to you. Do not rebel like that rebellious house; open your mouth and eat what I give you."
- 9 When I looked he had his hand stretched out to me, and in the hand a book, a scroll.
- 9 Then I looked, and I saw a hand stretched out to me. In it was a scroll,
- 10 He unrolled the scroll. On both sides, front and back, were written lamentations and mourning and doom.
- 10 which he unrolled before me. On both sides of it were written words of lament and mourning and woe.

Ezekiel 3

MSG

NIV

- 1 He told me, "Son of man, eat what you see. Eat this book. Then go and speak to the family of Israel."
- 1 And he said to me, "Son of man, eat what is before you, eat this scroll; then go and speak to the house of Israel."
- 2 As I opened my mouth, he gave me the scroll to eat,
- 2 So I opened my mouth, and he gave me the scroll to eat.
- 3 saying, "Son of man, eat this book that I am giving you. Make a full meal of it!" So I ate it. It tasted so good--just like honey.
- 3 Then he said to me, "Son of man, eat this scroll I am giving you and fill your stomach with it." So I ate it, and it tasted as sweet as honey in my mouth.
- 4 Then he told me, "Son of man, go to the family of Israel and speak my Message.
- 4 He then said to me: "Son of man, go now to the house of Israel and speak my words to them.
- 5 Look, I'm not sending you to a people who speak a hard-to-learn language with words you can hardly pronounce.

- 5 You are not being sent to a people of obscure speech and difficult language, but to the house of Israel--
- 6 If I had sent you to such people, their ears would have perked up and they would have listened immediately.
- 6 not to many peoples of obscure speech and difficult language, whose words you cannot understand. Surely if I had sent you to them, they would have listened to you.
- 7 "But it won't work that way with the family of Israel. They won't listen to you because they won't listen to me. They are, as I said, a hard case, hardened in their sin.
- 7 But the house of Israel is not willing to listen to you because they are not willing to listen to me, for the whole house of Israel is hardened and obstinate.
- 8 But I'll make you as hard in your way as they are in theirs.
- 8 But I will make you as unyielding and hardened as they are.
- 9 I'll make your face as hard as rock, harder than granite. Don't let them intimidate you. Don't be afraid of them, even though they're a bunch of rebels."
- 9 I will make your forehead like the hardest stone, harder than flint. Do not be afraid of them or terrified by them, though they are a rebellious house."
- 10 Then he said, "Son of man, get all these words that I'm giving you inside you. Listen to them obediently. Make them your own.
- 10 And he said to me, "Son of man, listen carefully and take to heart all the words I speak to you.
- 11 And now go. Go to the exiles, your people, and speak. Tell them, 'This is the Message of GOD, the Master.' Speak your piece, whether they listen or not."
- 11 Go now to your countrymen in exile and speak to them. Say to them, 'This is what the Sovereign LORD says,' whether they listen or fail to listen."
- 12 Then the Spirit picked me up. Behind me I heard a great commotion-- "Blessed be the Glory of GOD in his Sanctuary!"--
- 12 Then the Spirit lifted me up, and I heard behind me a loud rumbling sound--May the glory of the LORD be praised in his dwelling place!--

- 13 the wings of the living creatures beating against each other, the whirling wheels, the rumble of a great earthquake.
- 13 the sound of the wings of the living creatures brushing against each other and the sound of the wheels beside them, a loud rumbling sound.
- 14 The Spirit lifted me and took me away. I went bitterly and angrily. I didn't want to go. But GOD had me in his grip.
- 14 The Spirit then lifted me up and took me away, and I went in bitterness and in the anger of my spirit, with the strong hand of the LORD upon me.
- 15 I arrived among the exiles who lived near the Kebar River at Tel Aviv. I came to where they were living and sat there for seven days, appalled.
- 15 I came to the exiles who lived at Tel Abib near the Kebar River. And there, where they were living, I sat among them for seven days--overwhelmed.
- 16 At the end of the seven days, I received this Message from GOD:
- 16 At the end of seven days the word of the LORD came to me:
- 17 "Son of man, I've made you a watchman for the family of Israel. Whenever you hear me say something, warn them for me.
- 17 Son of man, I have made you a watchman for the house of Israel; so hear the word I speak and give them warning from me.
- 18 If I say to the wicked, 'You are going to die,' and you don't sound the alarm warning them that it's a matter of life or death, they will die and it will be your fault. I'll hold you responsible.
- 18 When I say to a wicked man, 'You will surely die,' and you do not warn him or speak out to dissuade him from his evil ways in order to save his life, that wicked man will die for his sin, and I will hold you accountable for his blood.
- 19 But if you warn the wicked and they keep right on sinning anyway, they'll most certainly die for their sin, but you won't die. You'll have saved your life.
- 19 But if you do warn the wicked man and he does not turn from his wickedness or from his evil ways, he will die for his sin; but you will have saved yourself.
- 20 "And if the righteous turn back from living righteously and take up with evil when I step in and put them in a hard place, they'll die. If you haven't warned them, they'll die because of their sins, and none of the

right things they've done will count for anything--and I'll hold you responsible.

20 Again, when a righteous man turns from his righteousness and does evil, and I put a stumbling block before him, he will die. Since you did not warn him, he will die for his sin. The righteous things he did will not be remembered, and I will hold you accountable for his blood.

21 But if you warn these righteous people not to sin and they listen to you, they'll live because they took the warning--and again, you'll have saved your life."

21 But if you do warn the righteous man not to sin and he does not sin, he will surely live because he took warning, and you will have saved yourself."

22 GOD grabbed me by the shoulder and said, "Get up. Go out on the plain. I want to talk with you."

22 The hand of the LORD was upon me there, and he said to me, "Get up and go out to the plain, and there I will speak to you."

23 So I got up and went out on the plain. I couldn't believe my eyes: the Glory of GOD! Right there! It was like the Glory I had seen at the Kebar River. I fell to the ground, prostrate.

23 So I got up and went out to the plain. And the glory of the LORD was standing there, like the glory I had seen by the Kebar River, and I fell facedown.

24 Then the Spirit entered me and put me on my feet. He said, "Go home and shut the door behind you."

24 Then the Spirit came into me and raised me to my feet. He spoke to me and said: "Go, shut yourself inside your house.

25 And then something odd: "Son of man: They'll tie you hand and foot with ropes so you can't leave the house.

25 And you, son of man, they will tie with ropes; you will be bound so that you cannot go out among the people.

26 I'll make your tongue stick to the roof of your mouth so you won't be able to talk and tell the people what they're doing wrong, even though they are a bunch of rebels.

26 I will make your tongue stick to the roof of your mouth so that you will be silent and unable to rebuke them, though they are a rebellious house.

27 "But then when the time is ripe, I'll free your tongue and you'll say, 'This is what GOD, the Master, says: . . .' From then on it's up to them. They can listen or not listen, whichever they like. They are a bunch of rebels!

27 But when I speak to you, I will open your mouth and you shall say to them, 'This is what the Sovereign LORD says.' Whoever will listen let him listen, and whoever will refuse let him refuse; for they are a rebellious house.

Ezekiel 4

MSG

NIV

1 "Now, son of man, take a brick and place it before you. Draw a picture of the city Jerusalem on it.

1 Now, son of man, take a clay tablet, put it in front of you and draw the city of Jerusalem on it.

2 Then make a model of a military siege against the brick: Build siege walls, construct a ramp, set up army camps, lay in battering rams around it.

2 Then lay siege to it: Erect siege works against it, build a ramp up to it, set up camps against it and put battering rams around it.

3 Then get an iron skillet and place it upright between you and the city--an iron wall. Face the model: The city shall be under siege and you shall be the besieger. This is a sign to the family of Israel.

3 Then take an iron pan, place it as an iron wall between you and the city and turn your face toward it. It will be under siege, and you shall besiege it. This will be a sign to the house of Israel.

4 "Next lie on your left side and place the sin of the family of Israel on yourself. You will bear their sin for as many days as you lie on your side.

4 Then lie on your left side and put the sin of the house of Israel upon yourself. You are to bear their sin for the number of days you lie on your side.

5 The number of days you bear their sin will match the number of years of their sin, namely, 390. For 390 days you will bear the sin of the family of Israel.

- 5 I have assigned you the same number of days as the years of their sin. So for 390 days you will bear the sin of the house of Israel.
- 6 "Then, after you have done this, turn over and lie down on your right side and bear the sin of the family of Judah. Your assignment this time is to lie there for forty days, a day for each year of their sin.
- 6 After you have finished this, lie down again, this time on your right side, and bear the sin of the house of Judah. I have assigned you 40 days, a day for each year.
- 7 Look straight at the siege of Jerusalem. Roll up your sleeve, shake your bare arm, and preach against her.
- 7 Turn your face toward the siege of Jerusalem and with bared arm prophesy against her.
- 8 "I will tie you up with ropes, tie you so you can't move or turn over until you have finished the days of the siege.
- 8 I will tie you up with ropes so that you cannot turn from one side to the other until you have finished the days of your siege.
- 9 "Next I want you to take wheat and barley, beans and lentils, dried millet and spelt, and mix them in a bowl to make a flat bread. This is your food ration for the 390 days you lie on your side.
- 9 Take wheat and barley, beans and lentils, millet and spelt; put them in a storage jar and use them to make bread for yourself. You are to eat it during the 390 days you lie on your side.
- 10 Measure out about half a pound for each day and eat it on schedule.
- 10 Weigh out twenty shekels of food to eat each day and eat it at set times.
- 11 Also measure out your daily ration of about a pint of water and drink it on schedule.
- 11 Also measure out a sixth of a hin of water and drink it at set times.
- 12 Eat the bread as you would a muffin. Bake the muffins out in the open where everyone can see you, using dried human dung for fuel."
- 12 Eat the food as you would a barley cake; bake it in the sight of the people, using human excrement for fuel."
- 13 GOD said, "This is what the people of Israel are going to do: Among the pagan nations where I will drive them, they will eat foods that are strictly taboo to a holy people."
- 13 The LORD said, "In this way the people of Israel will eat defiled food among the nations where I will drive them."

- 14 I said, "GOD, my Master! Never! I've never contaminated myself with food like that. Since my youth I've never eaten anything forbidden by law, nothing found dead or violated by wild animals. I've never taken a single bite of forbidden food."
- 14 Then I said, "Not so, Sovereign LORD! I have never defiled myself. From my youth until now I have never eaten anything found dead or torn by wild animals. No unclean meat has ever entered my mouth."
- 15 "All right," he said. "I'll let you bake your bread over cow dung instead of human dung."
- 15 Very well, he said, "I will let you bake your bread over cow manure instead of human excrement."
- 16 Then he said to me, "Son of man, I'm going to cut off all food from Jerusalem. The people will live on starvation rations, worrying where the next meal's coming from, scrounging for the next drink of water.
- 16 He then said to me: "Son of man, I will cut off the supply of food in Jerusalem. The people will eat rationed food in anxiety and drink rationed water in despair,
- 17 Famine conditions. People will look at one another, see nothing but skin and bones, and shake their heads. This is what sin does."
- 17 for food and water will be scarce. They will be appalled at the sight of each other and will waste away because of their sin.

Ezekiel 5

MSG

NIV

- 1 "Now, son of man, take a sharp sword and use it as a straight razor, shaving your head and your beard. Then, using a set of balancing scales, divide the hair into thirds.
- 1 Now, son of man, take a sharp sword and use it as a barber's razor to shave your head and your beard. Then take a set of scales and divide up the hair.
- 2 When the days of the siege are over, take one-third of the hair and burn it inside the city. Take another third, chop it into bits with the sword and sprinkle it around the city. The final third you'll throw to the wind. Then I'll go after them with a sword.

- 2 When the days of your siege come to an end, burn a third of the hair with fire inside the city. Take a third and strike it with the sword all around the city. And scatter a third to the wind. For I will pursue them with drawn sword.
- 3 "Retrieve a few of the hairs and slip them into your pocket.
- 3 But take a few strands of hair and tuck them away in the folds of your garment.
- 4 Take some of them and throw them into the fire--burn them up. From them, fire will spread to the whole family of Israel.
- 4 Again, take a few of these and throw them into the fire and burn them up. A fire will spread from there to the whole house of Israel.
- 5 "This is what GOD, the Master, says: This means Jerusalem. I set her at the center of the world, all the nations ranged around her.
- 5 This is what the Sovereign LORD says: This is Jerusalem, which I have set in the center of the nations, with countries all around her.
- 6 But she rebelled against my laws and ordinances, rebelled far worse than the nations ranged around her--sheer wickedness!--refused my guidance, ignored my directions.
- 6 Yet in her wickedness she has rebelled against my laws and decrees more than the nations and countries around her. She has rejected my laws and has not followed my decrees.
- 7 "Therefore this is what GOD, the Master, says: You've been more headstrong and willful than any of the nations around you, refusing my guidance, ignoring my directions. You've sunk to the gutter level of those around you.
- 7 Therefore this is what the Sovereign LORD says: You have been more unruly than the nations around you and have not followed my decrees or kept my laws. You have not even conformed to the standards of the nations around you.
- 8 "Therefore this is what GOD, the Master, says: I'm setting myself against you--yes, against you, Jerusalem. I'm going to punish you in full sight of the nations.
- 8 Therefore this is what the Sovereign LORD says: I myself am against you, Jerusalem, and I will inflict punishment on you in the sight of the nations.

- 9 Because of your disgusting no-god idols, I'm going to do something to you that I've never done before and will never do again:
- 9 Because of all your detestable idols, I will do to you what I have never done before and will never do again.
- 10 turn families into cannibals--parents eating children, children eating parents! Punishment indeed. And whoever's left over I'll throw to the winds.
- 10 Therefore in your midst fathers will eat their children, and children will eat their fathers. I will inflict punishment on you and will scatter all your survivors to the winds.
- 11 "Therefore, as sure as I am the living God--Decree of GOD, the Master--because you've polluted my Sanctuary with your obscenities and disgusting no-god idols, I'm pulling out. Not an ounce of pity will I show you.
- 11 Therefore as surely as I live, declares the Sovereign LORD, because you have defiled my sanctuary with all your vile images and detestable practices, I myself will withdraw my favor; I will not look on you with pity or spare you.
- 12 A third of your people will die of either disease or hunger inside the city, a third will be killed outside the city, and a third will be thrown to the winds and chased by killers.
- 12 A third of your people will die of the plague or perish by famine inside you; a third will fall by the sword outside your walls; and a third I will scatter to the winds and pursue with drawn sword.
- 13 "Only then will I calm down and let my anger cool. Then you'll know that I was serious about this all along, that I'm a jealous God and not to be trifled with.
- 13 Then my anger will cease and my wrath against them will subside, and I will be avenged. And when I have spent my wrath upon them, they will know that I the LORD have spoken in my zeal.
- 14 "When I get done with you, you'll be a pile of rubble. Nations who walk by will make coarse jokes.
- 14 I will make you a ruin and a reproach among the nations around you, in the sight of all who pass by.
- 15 When I finish my angry punishment and searing rebukes, you'll be reduced to an object of ridicule and mockery, turned into a horror story

- circulating among the surrounding nations. I, GOD, have spoken.
- 15 You will be a reproach and a taunt, a warning and an object of horror to the nations around you when I inflict punishment on you in anger and in wrath and with stinging rebuke. I the LORD have spoken.
- 16 "When I shoot my lethal famine arrows at you, I'll shoot to kill. Then I'll step up the famine and cut off food supplies.
- 16 When I shoot at you with my deadly and destructive arrows of famine, I will shoot to destroy you. I will bring more and more famine upon you and cut off your supply of food.
- 17 Famine and more famine--and then I'll send in the wild animals to finish off your children. Epidemic disease, unrestrained murder, death--and I will have sent it! I, GOD, have spoken."
- 17 I will send famine and wild beasts against you, and they will leave you childless. Plague and bloodshed will sweep through you, and I will bring the sword against you. I the LORD have spoken."

Ezekiel 6

MSG

NIV

- 1 Then the Word of GOD came to me:
- 1 The word of the LORD came to me:
- 2 "Son of man, now turn and face the mountains of Israel and preach against them
- 2 Son of man, set your face against the mountains of Israel; prophesy against them
- 3 : 'O Mountains of Israel, listen to the Message of GOD, the Master. GOD, the Master, speaks to the mountains and hills, to the ravines and the valleys: I'm about to destroy your sacred god and goddess shrines.
- 3 and say: 'O mountains of Israel, hear the word of the Sovereign LORD. This is what the Sovereign LORD says to the mountains and hills, to the ravines and valleys: I am about to bring a sword against you, and I will destroy your high places.
- 4 I'll level your altars, bust up your sun-god pillars, and kill your people as they bow down to your no-god idols.

- 4 Your altars will be demolished and your incense altars will be smashed; and I will slay your people in front of your idols.
- 5 I'll stack the dead bodies of Israelites in front of your idols and then scatter your bones around your shrines.
- 5 I will lay the dead bodies of the Israelites in front of their idols, and I will scatter your bones around your altars.
- 6 Every place where you've lived, the towns will be torn down and the pagan shrines demolished--altars busted up, idols smashed, all your custom-made sun-god pillars in ruins.
- 6 Wherever you live, the towns will be laid waste and the high places demolished, so that your altars will be laid waste and devastated, your idols smashed and ruined, your incense altars broken down, and what you have made wiped out.
- 7 Corpses everywhere you look! Then you'll know that I am GOD.
- 7 Your people will fall slain among you, and you will know that I am the LORD.
- 8 "'But I'll let a few escape the killing as you are scattered through other lands and nations.
- 8 'But I will spare some, for some of you will escape the sword when you are scattered among the lands and nations.
- 9 In the foreign countries where they're taken as prisoners of war, they'll remember me. They'll realize how devastated I was by their betrayals, by their voracious lust for gratifying themselves in their idolatries. They'll be disgusted with their evil ways, disgusting to God in the way they've lived.
- 9 Then in the nations where they have been carried captive, those who escape will remember me--how I have been grieved by their adulterous hearts, which have turned away from me, and by their eyes, which have lusted after their idols. They will loathe themselves for the evil they have done and for all their detestable practices.
- 10 They'll know that I am GOD. They'll know that my judgment against them was no empty threat.
- 10 And they will know that I am the LORD; I did not threaten in vain to bring this calamity on them.
- 11 "'This is what GOD, the Master, says: Clap your hands, stamp your feet, yell out, "No, no, no!" because of all the evil obscenities rife in Israel.

- They're going to be killed, dying of hunger, dying of disease--
- 11 'This is what the Sovereign LORD says: Strike your hands together and stamp your feet and cry out Alas!' because of all the wicked and detestable practices of the house of Israel, for they will fall by the sword, famine and plague.
- 12 death everywhere you look, people dropping like flies, people far away dying, people nearby dying, and whoever's left in the city starving to death. Why? Because I'm angry, furiously angry.
- 12 He that is far away will die of the plague, and he that is near will fall by the sword, and he that survives and is spared will die of famine. So will I spend my wrath upon them.
- 13 They'll realize that I am GOD when they see their people's corpses strewn over and around all their ruined sex-and-religion shrines on the bare hills and in the lush fertility groves, in all the places where they indulged their sensual rites.
- 13 And they will know that I am the LORD, when their people lie slain among their idols around their altars, on every high hill and on all the mountaintops, under every spreading tree and every leafy oak--places where they offered fragrant incense to all their idols.
- 14 I'll bring my hand down hard on them, demolish the country wherever they live, turn it into wasteland from one end to the other, from the wilderness to Riblah. Then they'll know that I am GOD!"
- 14 And I will stretch out my hand against them and make the land a desolate waste from the desert to Diblah--wherever they live. Then they will know that I am the LORD.' "

Ezekiel 7

MSG

NIV

- 1 GOD's Word came to me, saying,
- 1 The word of the LORD came to me:
- 2 "You, son of man--GOD, the Master, has this Message for the land of Israel: "'Endtime. The end of business as usual for everyone.
- 2 Son of man, this is what the Sovereign LORD says to the land of Israel: The end! The end has come upon the four corners of the land.

- 3 It's all over. The end is upon you. I've launched my anger against you. I've issued my verdict on the way you live. I'll make you pay for your disgusting obscenities.
- 3 The end is now upon you and I will unleash my anger against you. I will judge you according to your conduct and repay you for all your detestable practices.
- 4 I won't look the other way, I won't feel sorry for you. I'll make you pay for the way you've lived: Your disgusting obscenities will boomerang on you, and you'll realize that I am GOD.'
- 4 I will not look on you with pity or spare you; I will surely repay you for your conduct and the detestable practices among you. Then you will know that I am the LORD.
- 5 "I, GOD, the Master, say: 'Disaster after disaster! Look, it comes!
- 5 This is what the Sovereign LORD says: Disaster! An unheard-of disaster is coming.
- 6 Endtime-- the end comes. The end is ripe. Watch out, it's coming!
- 6 The end has come! The end has come! It has roused itself against you. It has come!
- 7 This is your fate, you who live in this land. Time's up. It's zero hour. No dragging of feet now, no bargaining for more time.
- 7 Doom has come upon you--you who dwell in the land. The time has come, the day is near; there is panic, not joy, upon the mountains.
- 8 Soon now I'll pour my wrath on you, pay out my anger against you, Render my verdict on the way you've lived, make you pay for your disgusting obscenities.
- 8 I am about to pour out my wrath on you and spend my anger against you; I will judge you according to your conduct and repay you for all your detestable practices.
- 9 I won't look the other way, I won't feel sorry for you. I'll make you pay for the way you've lived. Your disgusting obscenities will boomerang on you. Then you'll realize that it is I, GOD, who has hit you.
- 9 I will not look on you with pity or spare you; I will repay you in accordance with your conduct and the detestable practices among you. Then you will know that it is I the LORD who strikes the blow.
- 10 "'Judgment Day! Fate has caught up with you. The scepter outsized and pretentious, pride bursting all bounds,

- 10 The day is here! It has come! Doom has burst forth, the rod has budded, arrogance has blossomed!
- 11 Violence strutting, brandishing the evil scepter. But there's nothing to them, and nothing will be left of them.
- 11 Violence has grown into a rod to punish wickedness; none of the people will be left, none of that crowd--no wealth, nothing of value.
- 12 Time's up. Countdown: five, four, three, two . . . Buyer, don't crow; seller, don't worry: Judgment wrath has turned the world topsy-turvy.
- 12 The time has come, the day has arrived. Let not the buyer rejoice nor the seller grieve, for wrath is upon the whole crowd.
- 13 The bottom has dropped out of buying and selling. It will never be the same again. But don't fantasize an upturn in the market. The country is bankrupt because of its sins, and it's not going to get any better.
- 13 The seller will not recover the land he has sold as long as both of them live, for the vision concerning the whole crowd will not be reversed. Because of their sins, not one of them will preserve his life.
- 14 ""The trumpet signals the call to battle: "Present arms!" But no one marches into battle. My wrath has them paralyzed!
- 14 Though they blow the trumpet and get everything ready, no one will go into battle, for my wrath is upon the whole crowd.
- 15 On the open roads you're killed, or else you go home and die of hunger and disease. Either get murdered out in the country or die of sickness or hunger in town.
- 15 Outside is the sword, inside are plague and famine; those in the country will die by the sword, and those in the city will be devoured by famine and plague.
- 16 Survivors run for the hills. They moan like doves in the valleys, Each one moaning for his own sins.
- 16 All who survive and escape will be in the mountains, moaning like doves of the valleys, each because of his sins.
- 17 ""Every hand hangs limp, every knee turns to rubber.
- 17 Every hand will go limp, and every knee will become as weak as water.
- 18 They dress in rough burlap-- sorry scarecrows, Shifty and shamefaced, with their heads shaved bald.
- 18 They will put on sackcloth and be clothed with terror. Their faces will be covered with shame and their heads will be shaved.

- 19 ""They throw their money into the gutters. Their hard-earned cash stinks like garbage. They find that it won't buy a thing they either want or need on Judgment Day. They tripped on money and fell into sin.
- 19 They will throw their silver into the streets, and their gold will be an unclean thing. Their silver and gold will not be able to save them in the day of the LORD's wrath. They will not satisfy their hunger or fill their stomachs with it, for it has made them stumble into sin.
- 20 Proud and pretentious with their jewels, they deck out their vile and vulgar no-gods in finery. I'll make those god-obscenities a stench in their nostrils.
- 20 They were proud of their beautiful jewelry and used it to make their detestable idols and vile images. Therefore I will turn these into an unclean thing for them.
- 21 I'll give away their religious junk-- strangers will pick it up for free, the godless spit on it and make jokes.
- 21 I will hand it all over as plunder to foreigners and as loot to the wicked of the earth, and they will defile it.
- 22 I'll turn my face so I won't have to look as my treasured place and people are violated, As violent strangers walk in and desecrate place and people--
- 22 I will turn my face away from them, and they will desecrate my treasured place; robbers will enter it and desecrate it.
- 23 A bloody massacre, as crime and violence fill the city.
- 23 Prepare chains, because the land is full of bloodshed and the city is full of violence.
- 24 I'll bring in the dregs of humanity to move into their houses. I'll put a stop to the boasting and strutting of the high-and-mighty, And see to it that there'll be nothing holy left in their holy places.
- 24 I will bring the most wicked of the nations to take possession of their houses; I will put an end to the pride of the mighty, and their sanctuaries will be desecrated.
- 25 Catastrophe descends. They look for peace, but there's no peace to be found--
- 25 When terror comes, they will seek peace, but there will be none.
- 26 Disaster on the heels of disaster, one rumor after another. They clamor for the prophet to tell them what's up, but nobody knows anything.

- Priests don't have a clue; the elders don't know what to say.
- 26 Calamity upon calamity will come, and rumor upon rumor. They will try to get a vision from the prophet; the teaching of the law by the priest will be lost, as will the counsel of the elders.
- 27 The king holds his head in despair; the prince is devastated. The common people are paralyzed. Gripped by fear, they can't move. I'll deal with them where they are, judge them on their terms. They'll know that I am GOD."
- 27 The king will mourn, the prince will be clothed with despair, and the hands of the people of the land will tremble. I will deal with them according to their conduct, and by their own standards I will judge them. Then they will know that I am the LORD."

Ezekiel 8

MSG

NIV

- 1 In the sixth year, in the sixth month and the fifth day, while I was sitting at home meeting with the leaders of Judah, it happened that the hand of my Master, GOD, gripped me.
- 1 In the sixth year, in the sixth month on the fifth day, while I was sitting in my house and the elders of Judah were sitting before me, the hand of the Sovereign LORD came upon me there.
- 2 When I looked, I was astonished. What I saw looked like a man--from the waist down like fire and from the waist up like highly burnished bronze.
- 2 I looked, and I saw a figure like that of a man. From what appeared to be his waist down he was like fire, and from there up his appearance was as bright as glowing metal.
- 3 He reached out what looked like a hand and grabbed me by the hair. The Spirit swept me high in the air and carried me in visions of God to Jerusalem, to the entrance of the north gate of the Temple's inside court where the image of the sex goddess that makes God so angry had been set up.
- 3 He stretched out what looked like a hand and took me by the hair of my head. The Spirit lifted me up between earth and heaven and in visions of

- God he took me to Jerusalem, to the entrance to the north gate of the inner court, where the idol that provokes to jealousy stood.
- 4 Right before me was the Glory of the God of Israel, exactly like the vision I had seen out on the plain.
- 4 And there before me was the glory of the God of Israel, as in the vision I had seen in the plain.
- 5 He said to me, "Son of man, look north." I looked north and saw it: Just north of the entrance loomed the altar of the sex goddess, Asherah, that makes God so angry.
- 5 Then he said to me, "Son of man, look toward the north." So I looked, and in the entrance north of the gate of the altar I saw this idol of jealousy.
- 6 Then he said, "Son of man, do you see what they're doing? Outrageous obscenities! And doing them right here! It's enough to drive me right out of my own Temple. But you're going to see worse yet."
- 6 And he said to me, "Son of man, do you see what they are doing--the utterly detestable things the house of Israel is doing here, things that will drive me far from my sanctuary? But you will see things that are even more detestable."
- 7 He brought me to the door of the Temple court. I looked and saw a gaping hole in the wall.
- 7 Then he brought me to the entrance to the court. I looked, and I saw a hole in the wall.
- 8 He said, "Son of man, dig through the wall." I dug through the wall and came upon a door.
- 8 He said to me, "Son of man, now dig into the wall." So I dug into the wall and saw a doorway there.
- 9 He said, "Now walk through the door and take a look at the obscenities they're engaging in."
- 9 And he said to me, "Go in and see the wicked and detestable things they are doing here."
- 10 I entered and looked. I couldn't believe my eyes: Painted all over the walls were pictures of reptiles and animals and monsters--the whole pantheon of Egyptian gods and goddesses--being worshiped by Israel.
- 10 So I went in and looked, and I saw portrayed all over the walls all kinds of crawling things and detestable animals and all the idols of the house

of Israel.

11 In the middle of the room were seventy of the leaders of Israel, with Jaazaniah son of Shaphan standing in the middle. Each held his censer with the incense rising in a fragrant cloud.

11 In front of them stood seventy elders of the house of Israel, and Jaazaniah son of Shaphan was standing among them. Each had a censer in his hand, and a fragrant cloud of incense was rising.

12 He said, "Son of man, do you see what the elders are doing here in the dark, each one before his favorite god-picture? They tell themselves, 'GOD doesn't see us. GOD has forsaken the country.'"

12 He said to me, "Son of man, have you seen what the elders of the house of Israel are doing in the darkness, each at the shrine of his own idol? They say, 'The LORD does not see us; the LORD has forsaken the land.'"

13 Then he said, "You're going to see worse yet."

13 Again, he said, "You will see them doing things that are even more detestable."

14 He took me to the entrance at the north gate of the Temple of GOD. I saw women sitting there, weeping for Tammuz, the Babylonian fertility god.

14 Then he brought me to the entrance to the north gate of the house of the LORD, and I saw women sitting there, mourning for Tammuz.

15 He said, "Have you gotten an eyeful, son of man? You're going to see worse yet."

15 He said to me, "Do you see this, son of man? You will see things that are even more detestable than this."

16 Finally, he took me to the inside court of the Temple of GOD. There between the porch and the altar were about twenty-five men. Their backs were to GOD's Temple. They were facing east, bowing in worship to the sun.

16 He then brought me into the inner court of the house of the LORD, and there at the entrance to the temple, between the portico and the altar, were about twenty-five men. With their backs toward the temple of the LORD and their faces toward the east, they were bowing down to the sun in the east.

- 17 He said, "Have you seen enough, son of man? Isn't it bad enough that Judah engages in these outrageous obscenities? They fill the country with violence and now provoke me even further with their obscene gestures.
- 17 He said to me, "Have you seen this, son of man? Is it a trivial matter for the house of Judah to do the detestable things they are doing here? Must they also fill the land with violence and continually provoke me to anger? Look at them putting the branch to their nose!
- 18 That's it. They have an angry God on their hands! From now on, no mercy. They can shout all they want, but I'm not listening."
- 18 Therefore I will deal with them in anger; I will not look on them with pity or spare them. Although they shout in my ears, I will not listen to them."

Ezekiel 9

MSG

NIV

- 1 Then I heard him call out loudly, "Executioners, come! And bring your deadly weapons with you."
- 1 Then I heard him call out in a loud voice, "Bring the guards of the city here, each with a weapon in his hand."
- 2 Six men came down the road from the upper gate that faces north, each carrying his lethal weapon. With them was a man dressed in linen with a writing case slung from his shoulder. They entered and stood by the bronze altar.
- 2 And I saw six men coming from the direction of the upper gate, which faces north, each with a deadly weapon in his hand. With them was a man clothed in linen who had a writing kit at his side. They came in and stood beside the bronze altar.
- 3 The Glory of the God of Israel ascended from his usual place above the cherubim-angels, moved to the threshold of the Temple, and called to the man with the writing case who was dressed in linen:
- 3 Now the glory of the God of Israel went up from above the cherubim, where it had been, and moved to the threshold of the temple. Then the

LORD called to the man clothed in linen who had the writing kit at his side

- 4 "Go through the streets of Jerusalem and put a mark on the forehead of everyone who is in anguish over the outrageous obscenities being done in the city."
- 4 and said to him, "Go throughout the city of Jerusalem and put a mark on the foreheads of those who grieve and lament over all the detestable things that are done in it."
- 5 I listened as he went on to address the executioners: "Follow him through the city and kill. Feel sorry for no one. Show no compassion."
- 5 As I listened, he said to the others, "Follow him through the city and kill, without showing pity or compassion."
- 6 Kill old men and women, young men and women, mothers and children. But don't lay a hand on anyone with the mark. Start at my Temple." They started with the leaders in front of the Temple.
- 6 Slaughter old men, young men and maidens, women and children, but do not touch anyone who has the mark. Begin at my sanctuary." So they began with the elders who were in front of the temple.
- 7 He told the executioners, "Desecrate the Temple. Fill it with corpses. Then go out and continue the killing."
- 7 Then he said to them, "Defile the temple and fill the courts with the slain. Go!" So they went out and began killing throughout the city.
- 8 So they went out and struck the city. While the massacre went forward, I was left alone. I fell on my face in prayer: "Oh, oh, GOD, my Master! Are you going to kill everyone left in Israel in this pouring out of your anger on Jerusalem?"
- 8 While they were killing and I was left alone, I fell facedown, crying out, "Ah, Sovereign LORD! Are you going to destroy the entire remnant of Israel in this outpouring of your wrath on Jerusalem?"
- 9 He said, "The guilt of Israel and Judah is enormous. The land is swollen with murder. The city is bloated with injustice. They all say, 'GOD has forsaken the country. He doesn't see anything we do.'
- 9 He answered me, "The sin of the house of Israel and Judah is exceedingly great; the land is full of bloodshed and the city is full of injustice. They say, 'The LORD has forsaken the land; the LORD does not see.'

- 10 Well, I do see, and I'm not feeling sorry for any of them. They're going to pay for what they've done."
- 10 So I will not look on them with pity or spare them, but I will bring down on their own heads what they have done."
- 11 Just then, the man dressed in linen and carrying the writing case came back and reported, "I've done what you told me."
- 11 Then the man in linen with the writing kit at his side brought back word, saying, "I have done as you commanded."

Ezekiel 10

MSG

NIV

- 1 When I next looked, oh! Above the dome over the heads of the cherubim-angels was what looked like a throne, sky-blue, like a sapphire!
- 1 I looked, and I saw the likeness of a throne of sapphire above the expanse that was over the heads of the cherubim.
- 2 GOD said to the man dressed in linen, "Enter the place of the wheels under the cherubim-angels. Fill your hands with burning coals from beneath the cherubim and scatter them over the city." I watched as he entered.
- 2 The LORD said to the man clothed in linen, "Go in among the wheels beneath the cherubim. Fill your hands with burning coals from among the cherubim and scatter them over the city." And as I watched, he went in.
- 3 The cherubim were standing on the south side of the Temple when the man entered. A cloud filled the inside courtyard.
- 3 Now the cherubim were standing on the south side of the temple when the man went in, and a cloud filled the inner court.
- 4 Then the Glory of GOD ascended from the cherubim and moved to the threshold of the Temple. The cloud filled the Temple. Court and Temple were both filled with the blazing presence of the Glory of GOD.
- 4 Then the glory of the LORD rose from above the cherubim and moved to the threshold of the temple. The cloud filled the temple, and the court was full of the radiance of the glory of the LORD.

- 5 And the sound! The wings of the cherubim were audible all the way to the outer court--the sound of the voice was like The Strong God in thunder.
- 5 The sound of the wings of the cherubim could be heard as far away as the outer court, like the voice of God Almighty when he speaks.
- 6 When GOD commanded the man dressed in linen, "Take fire from among the wheels, from between the cherubim," he went in and stood beside a wheel.
- 6 When the LORD commanded the man in linen, "Take fire from among the wheels, from among the cherubim," the man went in and stood beside a wheel.
- 7 One of the cherubim reached into the fire, took some coals, and put them in the hands of the man dressed in linen. He took them and went out.
- 7 Then one of the cherubim reached out his hand to the fire that was among them. He took up some of it and put it into the hands of the man in linen, who took it and went out.
- 8 Something that looked like a human hand could be seen under the wings of the cherubim.
- 8 (Under the wings of the cherubim could be seen what looked like the hands of a man.)
- 9 And then I saw four wheels beside the cherubim, one beside each cherub. The wheels radiating were sparkling like diamonds in the sun.
- 9 I looked, and I saw beside the cherubim four wheels, one beside each of the cherubim; the wheels sparkled like chrysolite.
- 10 All four wheels looked alike, each like a wheel within a wheel.
- 10 As for their appearance, the four of them looked alike; each was like a wheel intersecting a wheel.
- 11 When they moved, they went in any of the four directions but in a perfectly straight line. Where the cherubim went, the wheels went straight ahead.
- 11 As they moved, they would go in any one of the four directions the cherubim faced; the wheels did not turn about as the cherubim went. The cherubim went in whatever direction the head faced, without turning as they went.
- 12 The cherubim were full of eyes in their backs, hands, and wings. The wheels likewise were full of eyes.

- 12 Their entire bodies, including their backs, their hands and their wings, were completely full of eyes, as were their four wheels.
- 13 I heard the wheels called "wheels within wheels."
- 13 I heard the wheels being called "the whirling wheels."
- 14 Each of the cherubim had four faces: the first, of an angel; the second, a human; the third, a lion; the fourth, an eagle.
- 14 Each of the cherubim had four faces: One face was that of a cherub, the second the face of a man, the third the face of a lion, and the fourth the face of an eagle.
- 15 Then the cherubim ascended. They were the same living creatures I had seen at the Kebar River.
- 15 Then the cherubim rose upward. These were the living creatures I had seen by the Kebar River.
- 16 When the cherubim moved, the wheels beside them moved. When the cherubim spread their wings to take off from the ground, the wheels stayed right with them.
- 16 When the cherubim moved, the wheels beside them moved; and when the cherubim spread their wings to rise from the ground, the wheels did not leave their side.
- 17 When the cherubim stopped, the wheels stopped. When the cherubim rose, the wheels rose, because the spirit of the living creatures was also in the wheels.
- 17 When the cherubim stood still, they also stood still; and when the cherubim rose, they rose with them, because the spirit of the living creatures was in them.
- 18 Then the Glory of GOD left the Temple entrance and hovered over the cherubim.
- 18 Then the glory of the LORD departed from over the threshold of the temple and stopped above the cherubim.
- 19 I watched as the cherubim spread their wings and left the ground, the wheels right with them. They stopped at the entrance of the east gate of the Temple. The Glory of the God of Israel was above them.
- 19 While I watched, the cherubim spread their wings and rose from the ground, and as they went, the wheels went with them. They stopped at the entrance to the east gate of the LORD's house, and the glory of the God of Israel was above them.

- 20 These were the same living creatures I had seen previously beneath the God of Israel at the Kebar River. I recognized them as cherubim.
- 20 These were the living creatures I had seen beneath the God of Israel by the Kebar River, and I realized that they were cherubim.
- 21 Each had four faces and four wings. Under their wings was what looked like human hands.
- 21 Each had four faces and four wings, and under their wings was what looked like the hands of a man.
- 22 Their faces looked exactly like those I had seen at the Kebar River. Each went straight ahead.
- 22 Their faces had the same appearance as those I had seen by the Kebar River. Each one went straight ahead.

Ezekiel 11

MSG

NIV

- 1 Then the Spirit picked me up and took me to the gate of the Temple that faces east. There were twenty-five men standing at the gate. I recognized the leaders, Jaazaniah son of Azzur and Pelatiah son of Benaiah.
- 1 Then the Spirit lifted me up and brought me to the gate of the house of the LORD that faces east. There at the entrance to the gate were twenty-five men, and I saw among them Jaazaniah son of Azzur and Pelatiah son of Benaiah, leaders of the people.
- 2 GOD said, "Son of man, these are the men who draw up blueprints for sin, who think up new programs for evil in this city.
- 2 The LORD said to me, "Son of man, these are the men who are plotting evil and giving wicked advice in this city.
- 3 They say, 'We can make anything happen here. We're the best. We're the choice pieces of meat in the soup pot.'
- 3 They say, 'Will it not soon be time to build houses? This city is a cooking pot, and we are the meat.'
- 4 "Oppose them, son of man. Preach against them."
- 4 Therefore prophesy against them; prophesy, son of man."
- 5 Then the Spirit of GOD came upon me and told me what to say: "This is what GOD says: 'That's a fine public speech, Israel, but I know what you

are thinking.

- 5 Then the Spirit of the LORD came upon me, and he told me to say: "This is what the LORD says: That is what you are saying, O house of Israel, but I know what is going through your mind.
- 6 You've murdered a lot of people in this city. The streets are piled high with corpses.'
- 6 You have killed many people in this city and filled its streets with the dead.
- 7 "Therefore this is what GOD, the Master, says: 'The corpses that you've piled in the streets are the meat and this city is the soup pot, and you're not even in the pot! I'm throwing you out!
- 7 Therefore this is what the Sovereign LORD says: The bodies you have thrown there are the meat and this city is the pot, but I will drive you out of it.
- 8 You fear war, but war is what you're going to get. I'm bringing war against you.
- 8 You fear the sword, and the sword is what I will bring against you, declares the Sovereign LORD.
- 9 I'm throwing you out of this city, giving you over to foreigners, and punishing you good.
- 9 I will drive you out of the city and hand you over to foreigners and inflict punishment on you.
- 10 You'll be killed in battle. I'll carry out judgment on you at the borders of Israel. Then you'll realize that I am GOD.
- 10 You will fall by the sword, and I will execute judgment on you at the borders of Israel. Then you will know that I am the LORD.
- 11 This city will not be your soup pot and you won't be the choice pieces of meat in it either. Hardly. I will carry out judgment on you at the borders of Israel
- 11 This city will not be a pot for you, nor will you be the meat in it; I will execute judgment on you at the borders of Israel.
- 12 and you'll realize that I am GOD, for you haven't followed my statutes and ordinances. Instead of following my ways, you've sunk to the level of the laws of the nations around you."
- 12 And you will know that I am the LORD, for you have not followed my decrees or kept my laws but have conformed to the standards of the

- nations around you."
- 13 Even while I was preaching, Pelatiah son of Benaiah died. I fell down, face to the ground, and prayed loudly, "O Master, GOD! Will you completely wipe out what's left of Israel?"
- 13 Now as I was prophesying, Pelatiah son of Benaiah died. Then I fell facedown and cried out in a loud voice, "Ah, Sovereign LORD! Will you completely destroy the remnant of Israel?"
- 14 The answer from GOD came back:
- 14 The word of the LORD came to me:
- 15 "Son of man, your brothers--I mean the whole people of Israel who are in exile with you--are the people of whom the citizens of Jerusalem are saying, 'They're in the far country, far from GOD. This land has been given to us to own.'
- 15 Son of man, your brothers--your brothers who are your blood relatives and the whole house of Israel--are those of whom the people of Jerusalem have said, 'They are far away from the LORD; this land was given to us as our possession.'
- 16 "Well, tell them this: 'This is your Message from GOD, the Master. True, I sent you to the far country and scattered you through other lands. All the same, I've provided you a temporary sanctuary in the countries where you've gone.
- 16 Therefore say: 'This is what the Sovereign LORD says: Although I sent them far away among the nations and scattered them among the countries, yet for a little while I have been a sanctuary for them in the countries where they have gone.'
- 17 I will gather you back from those countries and lands where you've been scattered and give you back the land of Israel.
- 17 Therefore say: 'This is what the Sovereign LORD says: I will gather you from the nations and bring you back from the countries where you have been scattered, and I will give you back the land of Israel again.'
- 18 You'll come back and clean house, throw out all the rotten images and obscene idols.
- 18 They will return to it and remove all its vile images and detestable idols.
- 19 I'll give you a new heart. I'll put a new spirit in you. I'll cut out your stone heart and replace it with a red-blooded, firm-muscled heart.

- 19 I will give them an undivided heart and put a new spirit in them; I will remove from them their heart of stone and give them a heart of flesh.
- 20 Then you'll obey my statutes and be careful to obey my commands. You'll be my people! I'll be your God!
- 20 Then they will follow my decrees and be careful to keep my laws. They will be my people, and I will be their God.
- 21 "'But not those who are self-willed and addicted to their rotten images and obscene idols! I'll see that they're paid in full for what they've done.' Decree of GOD, the Master."
- 21 But as for those whose hearts are devoted to their vile images and detestable idols, I will bring down on their own heads what they have done, declares the Sovereign LORD."
- 22 Then the cherubim spread their wings, with the wheels beside them and the Glory of the God of Israel hovering over them.
- 22 Then the cherubim, with the wheels beside them, spread their wings, and the glory of the God of Israel was above them.
- 23 The Glory of GOD ascended from within the city and rested on the mountain to the east of the city.
- 23 The glory of the LORD went up from within the city and stopped above the mountain east of it.
- 24 Then, still in the vision given me by the Spirit of God, the Spirit took me and carried me back to the exiles in Babylon. And then the vision left me.
- 24 The Spirit lifted me up and brought me to the exiles in Babylonia in the vision given by the Spirit of God. Then the vision I had seen went up from me,
- 25 I told the exiles everything that GOD had shown me.
- 25 and I told the exiles everything the LORD had shown me.

Ezekiel 12

MSG

NIV

1 God's Message came to me:

1 The word of the LORD came to me:

- 2 "Son of man, you're living with a bunch of rebellious people. They have eyes but don't see a thing, they have ears but don't hear a thing. They're rebels all.
- 2 Son of man, you are living among a rebellious people. They have eyes to see but do not see and ears to hear but do not hear, for they are a rebellious people.
- 3 So, son of man, pack up your exile duffel bags. Leave in broad daylight with everyone watching and go off, as if into exile. Maybe then they'll understand what's going on, rebels though they are.
- 3 Therefore, son of man, pack your belongings for exile and in the daytime, as they watch, set out and go from where you are to another place. Perhaps they will understand, though they are a rebellious house.
- 4 You'll take up your baggage while they watch, a bundle of the bare necessities of someone going into exile, and toward evening leave, just like a person going off into exile.
- 4 During the daytime, while they watch, bring out your belongings packed for exile. Then in the evening, while they are watching, go out like those who go into exile.
- 5 As they watch, dig through the wall of the house and carry your bundle through it.
- 5 While they watch, dig through the wall and take your belongings out through it.
- 6 In full sight of the people, put the bundle on your shoulder and walk out into the night. Cover your face so you won't have to look at what you'll never see again. I'm using you as a sign for the family of Israel."
- 6 Put them on your shoulder as they are watching and carry them out at dusk. Cover your face so that you cannot see the land, for I have made you a sign to the house of Israel."
- 7 I did exactly as he commanded me. I got my stuff together and brought it out in the street where everyone could see me, bundled it up the way someone being taken off into exile would, and then, as the sun went down, made a hole in the wall of the house with my hands. As it grew dark and as they watched, I left, throwing my bundle across my shoulders.
- 7 So I did as I was commanded. During the day I brought out my things packed for exile. Then in the evening I dug through the wall with my

hands. I took my belongings out at dusk, carrying them on my shoulders while they watched.

8 The next morning GOD spoke to me:

8 In the morning the word of the LORD came to me:

9 "Son of man, when anyone in Israel, that bunch of rebels, asks you, 'What are you doing?'

9 Son of man, did not that rebellious house of Israel ask you, 'What are you doing?'

10 Tell them, 'GOD, the Master, says that this Message especially concerns the prince in Jerusalem--Zedekiah--but includes all the people of Israel.'

10 Say to them, 'This is what the Sovereign LORD says: This oracle concerns the prince in Jerusalem and the whole house of Israel who are there.'

11 "Also tell them, 'I am drawing a picture for you. As I am now doing, it will be done to all the people of Israel. They will go into exile as captives.'

11 Say to them, 'I am a sign to you.' "As I have done, so it will be done to them. They will go into exile as captives.

12 "The prince will put his bundle on his shoulders in the dark and leave. He'll dig through the wall of the house, covering his face so he won't have to look at the land he'll never see again.

12 The prince among them will put his things on his shoulder at dusk and leave, and a hole will be dug in the wall for him to go through. He will cover his face so that he cannot see the land.

13 But I'll make sure he gets caught and is taken to Babylon. Blinded, he'll never see that land in which he'll die.

13 I will spread my net for him, and he will be caught in my snare; I will bring him to Babylonia, the land of the Chaldeans, but he will not see it, and there he will die.

14 I'll scatter to the four winds those who helped him escape, along with his troops, and many will die in battle.

14 I will scatter to the winds all those around him--his staff and all his troops--and I will pursue them with drawn sword.

15 They'll realize that I am GOD when I scatter them among foreign countries.

- 15 They will know that I am the LORD, when I disperse them among the nations and scatter them through the countries.
- 16 "I'll permit a few of them to escape the killing, starvation, and deadly sickness so that they can confess among the foreign countries all the disgusting obscenities they've been involved in. They will realize that I am GOD."
- 16 But I will spare a few of them from the sword, famine and plague, so that in the nations where they go they may acknowledge all their detestable practices. Then they will know that I am the LORD."
- 17 GOD's Message came to me:
- 17 The word of the LORD came to me:
- 18 "Son of man, eat your meals shaking in your boots, drink your water trembling with fear.
- 18 Son of man, tremble as you eat your food, and shudder in fear as you drink your water.
- 19 Tell the people of this land, everyone living in Jerusalem and Israel, GOD's Message: 'You'll eat your meals shaking in your boots and drink your water in terror because your land is going to be stripped bare as punishment for the brutality rampant in it.
- 19 Say to the people of the land: 'This is what the Sovereign LORD says about those living in Jerusalem and in the land of Israel: They will eat their food in anxiety and drink their water in despair, for their land will be stripped of everything in it because of the violence of all who live there.
- 20 All the cities and villages will be emptied out and the fields destroyed. Then you'll realize that I am GOD.'"
- 20 The inhabited towns will be laid waste and the land will be desolate. Then you will know that I am the LORD.' "
- 21 GOD's Message came to me:
- 21 The word of the LORD came to me:
- 22 "Son of man, what's this proverb making the rounds in the land of Israel that says, 'Everything goes on the same as ever; all the prophetic warnings are false alarms'?
- 22 Son of man, what is this proverb you have in the land of Israel: 'The days go by and every vision comes to nothing'?

- 23 "Tell them, 'GOD, the Master, says, This proverb's going to have a short life!' "Tell them, 'Time's about up. Every warning is about to come true.
- 23 Say to them, 'This is what the Sovereign LORD says: I am going to put an end to this proverb, and they will no longer quote it in Israel.' Say to them, 'The days are near when every vision will be fulfilled.
- 24 False alarms and easygoing preaching are a thing of the past in the life of Israel.
- 24 For there will be no more false visions or flattering divinations among the people of Israel.
- 25 I, GOD, am doing the speaking. What I say happens. None of what I say is on hold. What I say, I'll do--and soon, you rebels!' Decree of God the Master."
- 25 But I the LORD will speak what I will, and it shall be fulfilled without delay. For in your days, you rebellious house, I will fulfill whatever I say, declares the Sovereign LORD.' "
- 26 GOD's Message came to me:
- 26 The word of the LORD came to me:
- 27 "Son of man, do you hear what Israel is saying: that the alarm the prophet raises is for a long time off, that he's preaching about the far-off future?
- 27 Son of man, the house of Israel is saying, 'The vision he sees is for many years from now, and he prophesies about the distant future.'
- 28 Well, tell them, 'GOD, the Master, says, "Nothing of what I say is on hold. What I say happens.'" Decree of GOD, the Master."
- 28 Therefore say to them, 'This is what the Sovereign LORD says: None of my words will be delayed any longer; whatever I say will be fulfilled, declares the Sovereign LORD.'

Ezekiel 13

MSG

NIV

- 1 GOD's Message came to me:
- 1 The word of the LORD came to me:
- 2 "Son of man, preach against the prophets of Israel who are making things up out of their own heads and calling it 'prophesying.' "Preach to them

- the real thing. Tell them, 'Listen to GOD's Message!'
- 2 Son of man, prophesy against the prophets of Israel who are now prophesying. Say to those who prophesy out of their own imagination: 'Hear the word of the LORD!
 - 3 GOD, the Master, pronounces doom on the empty-headed prophets who do their own thing and know nothing of what's going on!
 - 3 This is what the Sovereign LORD says: Woe to the foolish prophets who follow their own spirit and have seen nothing!
 - 4 Your prophets, Israel, are like jackals scavenging through the ruins.
 - 4 Your prophets, O Israel, are like jackals among ruins.
 - 5 They haven't lifted a finger to repair the defenses of the city and have risked nothing to help Israel stand on GOD's Day of Judgment.
 - 5 You have not gone up to the breaks in the wall to repair it for the house of Israel so that it will stand firm in the battle on the day of the LORD.
 - 6 All they do is fantasize comforting illusions and preach lying sermons. They say 'GOD says . . .' when GOD hasn't so much as breathed in their direction. And yet they stand around thinking that something they said is going to happen.
 - 6 Their visions are false and their divinations a lie. They say, "The LORD declares," when the LORD has not sent them; yet they expect their words to be fulfilled.
 - 7 "Haven't you fantasized sheer nonsense? Aren't your sermons tissues of lies, saying 'GOD says . . .' when I've done nothing of the kind?
 - 7 Have you not seen false visions and uttered lying divinations when you say, "The LORD declares," though I have not spoken?
 - 8 Therefore--and this is the Message of GOD, the Master, remember--I'm dead set against prophets who substitute illusions for visions and use sermons to tell lies.
 - 8 'Therefore this is what the Sovereign LORD says: Because of your false words and lying visions, I am against you, declares the Sovereign LORD.
 - 9 I'm going to ban them from the council of my people, remove them from membership in Israel, and outlaw them from the land of Israel. Then you'll realize that I am GOD, the Master.
 - 9 My hand will be against the prophets who see false visions and utter lying divinations. They will not belong to the council of my people or be

- listed in the records of the house of Israel, nor will they enter the land of Israel. Then you will know that I am the Sovereign LORD.
- 10 "The fact is that they've lied to my people. They've said, 'No problem; everything's just fine,' when things are not at all fine. When people build a wall, they're right behind them slapping on whitewash.
- 10 'Because they lead my people astray, saying, 'Peace,' when there is no peace, and because, when a flimsy wall is built, they cover it with whitewash,
- 11 Tell those who are slapping on the whitewash, 'When a torrent of rain comes and the hailstones crash down and the hurricane sweeps in
- 11 therefore tell those who cover it with whitewash that it is going to fall. Rain will come in torrents, and I will send hailstones hurtling down, and violent winds will burst forth.
- 12 and the wall collapses, what's the good of the whitewash that you slapped on so liberally, making it look so good?'
- 12 When the wall collapses, will people not ask you, "Where is the whitewash you covered it with?"
- 13 "And that's exactly what will happen. I, GOD, the Master, say so: 'I'll let the hurricane of my wrath loose, a torrent of my hailstone-anger.
- 13 'Therefore this is what the Sovereign LORD says: In my wrath I will unleash a violent wind, and in my anger hailstones and torrents of rain will fall with destructive fury.
- 14 I'll make that wall you've slapped with whitewash collapse. I'll level it to the ground so that only the foundation stones will be left. And in the ruin you'll all die. You'll realize then that I am GOD.
- 14 I will tear down the wall you have covered with whitewash and will level it to the ground so that its foundation will be laid bare. When it falls, you will be destroyed in it; and you will know that I am the LORD.
- 15 "'I'll dump my wrath on that wall, all of it, and on those who plastered it with whitewash. I will say to them, There is no wall, and those who did such a good job of whitewashing it wasted their time,
- 15 So I will spend my wrath against the wall and against those who covered it with whitewash. I will say to you, "The wall is gone and so are those who whitewashed it,
- 16 those prophets of Israel who preached to Jerusalem and announced all their visions telling us things were just fine when they weren't at all fine.

Decree of GOD, the Master.'

16 those prophets of Israel who prophesied to Jerusalem and saw visions of peace for her when there was no peace, declares the Sovereign LORD." '

17 "And the women prophets--son of man, take your stand against the women prophets who make up stuff out of their own minds. Oppose them.

17 Now, son of man, set your face against the daughters of your people who prophesy out of their own imagination. Prophesy against them

18 Say 'Doom' to the women who sew magic bracelets and head scarves to suit every taste, devices to trap souls. Say, 'Will you kill the souls of my people, use living souls to make yourselves rich and popular?

18 and say, 'This is what the Sovereign LORD says: Woe to the women who sew magic charms on all their wrists and make veils of various lengths for their heads in order to ensnare people. Will you ensnare the lives of my people but preserve your own?

19 You have profaned me among my people just to get ahead yourselves, used me to make yourselves look good--killing souls who should never have died and coddling souls who shouldn't live. You've lied to people who love listening to lies.'

19 You have profaned me among my people for a few handfuls of barley and scraps of bread. By lying to my people, who listen to lies, you have killed those who should not have died and have spared those who should not live.

20 "Therefore GOD says, 'I am against all the devices and techniques you use to hunt down souls. I'll rip them out of your hands. I'll free the souls you're trying to catch.

20 'Therefore this is what the Sovereign LORD says: I am against your magic charms with which you ensnare people like birds and I will tear them from your arms; I will set free the people that you ensnare like birds.

21 I'll rip your magic bracelets and scarves to shreds and deliver my people from your influence so they'll no longer be victimized by you. That's how you'll come to realize that I am GOD.

21 I will tear off your veils and save my people from your hands, and they will no longer fall prey to your power. Then you will know that I am the LORD.

- 22 "'Because you've confounded and confused good people, unsuspecting and innocent people, with your lies, and because you've made it easy for others to persist in evil so that it wouldn't even dawn on them to turn to me so I could save them,
- 22 Because you disheartened the righteous with your lies, when I had brought them no grief, and because you encouraged the wicked not to turn from their evil ways and so save their lives,
- 23 as of now you're finished. No more delusion-mongering from you, no more sermonic lies. I'm going to rescue my people from your clutches. And you'll realize that I am GOD."
- 23 therefore you will no longer see false visions or practice divination. I will save my people from your hands. And then you will know that I am the LORD.' "

Ezekiel 14

MSG

NIV

- 1 Some of the leaders of Israel approached me and sat down with me.
- 1 Some of the elders of Israel came to me and sat down in front of me.
- 2 GOD's Message came to me:
- 2 Then the word of the LORD came to me:
- 3 "Son of Man, these people have installed idols in their hearts. They have embraced the wickedness that will ruin them. Why should I even bother with their prayers?
- 3 Son of man, these men have set up idols in their hearts and put wicked stumbling blocks before their faces. Should I let them inquire of me at all?
- 4 Therefore tell them, 'The Message of GOD, the Master: All in Israel who install idols in their hearts and embrace the wickedness that will ruin them and still have the gall to come to a prophet, be on notice: I, GOD, will step in and personally answer them as they come dragging along their mob of idols.
- 4 Therefore speak to them and tell them, 'This is what the Sovereign LORD says: When any Israelite sets up idols in his heart and puts a wicked

- stumbling block before his face and then goes to a prophet, I the LORD will answer him myself in keeping with his great idolatry.
- 5 I am ready to go to work on the hearts of the house of Israel, all of whom have left me for their idols.'
- 5 I will do this to recapture the hearts of the people of Israel, who have all deserted me for their idols.'
- 6 "Therefore, say to the house of Israel: 'GOD, the Master, says, Repent! Turn your backs on your no-god idols. Turn your backs on all your outrageous obscenities.
- 6 Therefore say to the house of Israel, 'This is what the Sovereign LORD says: Repent! Turn from your idols and renounce all your detestable practices!
- 7 To every last person from the house of Israel, including any of the resident aliens who live in Israel--all who turn their backs on me and embrace idols, who install the wickedness that will ruin them at the center of their lives and then have the gall to go to the prophet to ask me questions--I, GOD, will step in and give the answer myself.
- 7 'When any Israelite or any alien living in Israel separates himself from me and sets up idols in his heart and puts a wicked stumbling block before his face and then goes to a prophet to inquire of me, I the LORD will answer him myself.
- 8 I'll oppose those people to their faces, make an example of them--a warning lesson--and get rid of them so you will realize that I am GOD.
- 8 I will set my face against that man and make him an example and a byword. I will cut him off from my people. Then you will know that I am the LORD.
- 9 "'If a prophet is deceived and tells these idolaters the lies they want to hear, I, GOD, get blamed for those lies. He won't get by with it. I'll grab him by the scruff of the neck and get him out of there.
- 9 'And if the prophet is enticed to utter a prophecy, I the LORD have enticed that prophet, and I will stretch out my hand against him and destroy him from among my people Israel.
- 10 They'll be equally guilty, the prophet and the one who goes to the prophet,
- 10 They will bear their guilt--the prophet will be as guilty as the one who consults him.

- 11 so that the house of Israel will never again wander off my paths and make themselves filthy in their rebellions, but will rather be my people, just as I am their God. Decree of GOD, the Master."
- 11 Then the people of Israel will no longer stray from me, nor will they defile themselves anymore with all their sins. They will be my people, and I will be their God, declares the Sovereign LORD.' "
- 12 GOD's Message came to me:
- 12 The word of the LORD came to me:
- 13 "Son of man, when a country sins against me by living faithlessly and I reach out and destroy its food supply by bringing on a famine, wiping out humans and animals alike,
- 13 Son of man, if a country sins against me by being unfaithful and I stretch out my hand against it to cut off its food supply and send famine upon it and kill its men and their animals,
- 14 even if Noah, Daniel, and Job--the Big Three--were alive at the time, it wouldn't do the population any good. Their righteousness would only save their own lives." Decree of GOD, the Master.
- 14 even if these three men--Noah, Daniel and Job--were in it, they could save only themselves by their righteousness, declares the Sovereign LORD.
- 15 "Or, if I make wild animals go through the country so that everyone has to leave and the country becomes wilderness and no one dares enter it anymore because of the wild animals,
- 15 Or if I send wild beasts through that country and they leave it childless and it becomes desolate so that no one can pass through it because of the beasts,
- 16 even if these three men were living there, as sure as I am the living God, neither their sons nor daughters would be rescued, but only those three, and the country would revert to wilderness.
- 16 as surely as I live, declares the Sovereign LORD, even if these three men were in it, they could not save their own sons or daughters. They alone would be saved, but the land would be desolate.
- 17 "Or, if I bring war on that country and give the order, 'Let the killing begin!' leaving both people and animals dead,
- 17 Or if I bring a sword against that country and say, 'Let the sword pass throughout the land,' and I kill its men and their animals,

- 18 even if those three men were alive at the time, as sure as I am the living God, neither sons nor daughters would be rescued, but only these three.
- 18 as surely as I live, declares the Sovereign LORD, even if these three men were in it, they could not save their own sons or daughters. They alone would be saved.
- 19 "Or, if I visit a deadly disease on that country, pouring out my lethal anger, killing both people and animals,
- 19 Or if I send a plague into that land and pour out my wrath upon it through bloodshed, killing its men and their animals,
- 20 and Noah, Daniel, and Job happened to be alive at the time, as sure as I am the living God, not a son, not a daughter, would be rescued. Only these three would be delivered because of their righteousness.
- 20 as surely as I live, declares the Sovereign LORD, even if Noah, Daniel and Job were in it, they could save neither son nor daughter. They would save only themselves by their righteousness.
- 21 "Now then, that's the picture," says GOD, the Master, "once I've sent my four catastrophic judgments on Jerusalem--war, famine, wild animals, disease--to kill off people and animals alike. But look!
- 21 For this is what the Sovereign LORD says: How much worse will it be when I send against Jerusalem my four dreadful judgments--sword and famine and wild beasts and plague--to kill its men and their animals!
- 22 Believe it or not, there'll be survivors. Some of their sons and daughters will be brought out. When they come out to you and their salvation is right in your face, you'll see for yourself the life they've been saved from. You'll know that this severe judgment I brought on Jerusalem was worth it, that it had to be.
- 22 Yet there will be some survivors--sons and daughters who will be brought out of it. They will come to you, and when you see their conduct and their actions, you will be consoled regarding the disaster I have brought upon Jerusalem--every disaster I have brought upon it.
- 23 Yes, when you see in detail the kind of lives they've been living, you'll feel much better. You'll see the reason behind all that I've done in Jerusalem." Decree of GOD, the Master.
- 23 You will be consoled when you see their conduct and their actions, for you will know that I have done nothing in it without cause, declares the Sovereign LORD."

Ezekiel 15

MSG

NIV

- 1 GOD's Message came to me:
- 1 The word of the LORD came to me:
- 2 "Son of man, how would you compare the wood of a vine with the branches of any tree you'd find in the forest?
- 2 Son of man, how is the wood of a vine better than that of a branch on any of the trees in the forest?
- 3 Is vine wood ever used to make anything? Is it used to make pegs to hang things from?
- 3 Is wood ever taken from it to make anything useful? Do they make pegs from it to hang things on?
- 4 "I don't think so. At best it's good for fuel. Look at it: a flimsy piece of vine, thrown in the fire and then rescued--the ends burned off and the middle charred. Now is it good for anything?
- 4 And after it is thrown on the fire as fuel and the fire burns both ends and chars the middle, is it then useful for anything?
- 5 "Hardly. When it was whole it wasn't good for anything. Half-burned is no improvement. What's it good for?
- 5 If it was not useful for anything when it was whole, how much less can it be made into something useful when the fire has burned it and it is charred?
- 6 "So here's the Message of GOD, the Master: Like the wood of the vine I selected from among the trees of the forest and used as fuel for the fire, just so I'll treat those who live in Jerusalem.
- 6 Therefore this is what the Sovereign LORD says: As I have given the wood of the vine among the trees of the forest as fuel for the fire, so will I treat the people living in Jerusalem.
- 7 I am dead set against them. Even though at one time they got out of the fire charred, the fire's going to burn them up. When I take my stand against them, you'll realize that I am GOD.
- 7 I will set my face against them. Although they have come out of the fire, the fire will yet consume them. And when I set my face against them, you will know that I am the LORD.

- 8 I'll turn this country into a wilderness because they've been faithless."
Decree of GOD, the Master.
- 8 I will make the land desolate because they have been unfaithful, declares
the Sovereign LORD."

Ezekiel 16

MSG

NIV

- 1 GOD's Message came to me:
- 1 The word of the LORD came to me:
- 2 "Son of man, confront Jerusalem with her outrageous violations.
- 2 Son of man, confront Jerusalem with her detestable practices
- 3 Say this: 'The Message of GOD, the Master, to Jerusalem: You were born
and bred among Canaanites. Your father was an Amorite and your
mother a Hittite.
- 3 and say, 'This is what the Sovereign LORD says to Jerusalem: Your
ancestry and birth were in the land of the Canaanites; your father was an
Amorite and your mother a Hittite.
- 4 "'On the day you were born your umbilical cord was not cut, you weren't
bathed and cleaned up, you weren't rubbed with salt, you weren't
wrapped in a baby blanket.
- 4 On the day you were born your cord was not cut, nor were you washed
with water to make you clean, nor were you rubbed with salt or wrapped
in cloths.
- 5 No one cared a fig for you. No one did one thing to care for you tenderly
in these ways. You were thrown out into a vacant lot and left there, dirty
and unwashed--a newborn nobody wanted.
- 5 No one looked on you with pity or had compassion enough to do any of
these things for you. Rather, you were thrown out into the open field, for
on the day you were born you were despised.
- 6 "'And then I came by. I saw you all miserable and bloody. Yes, I said to
you, lying there helpless and filthy, "Live!
- 6 "Then I passed by and saw you kicking about in your blood, and as you
lay there in your blood I said to you, Live!"

- 7 Grow up like a plant in the field!" And you did. You grew up. You grew tall and matured as a woman, full-breasted, with flowing hair. But you were naked and vulnerable, fragile and exposed.
- 7 I made you grow like a plant of the field. You grew up and developed and became the most beautiful of jewels. Your breasts were formed and your hair grew, you who were naked and bare.
- 8 "I came by again and saw you, saw that you were ready for love and a lover. I took care of you, dressed you and protected you. I promised you my love and entered the covenant of marriage with you. I, GOD, the Master, gave my word. You became mine.
- 8 'Later I passed by, and when I looked at you and saw that you were old enough for love, I spread the corner of my garment over you and covered your nakedness. I gave you my solemn oath and entered into a covenant with you, declares the Sovereign LORD, and you became mine.
- 9 I gave you a good bath, washing off all that old blood, and anointed you with aromatic oils.
- 9 'I bathed you with water and washed the blood from you and put ointments on you.
- 10 I dressed you in a colorful gown and put leather sandals on your feet. I gave you linen blouses and a fashionable wardrobe of expensive clothing.
- 10 I clothed you with an embroidered dress and put leather sandals on you. I dressed you in fine linen and covered you with costly garments.
- 11 I adorned you with jewelry: I placed bracelets on your wrists, fitted you out with a necklace,
- 11 I adorned you with jewelry: I put bracelets on your arms and a necklace around your neck,
- 12 emerald rings, sapphire earrings, and a diamond tiara.
- 12 and I put a ring on your nose, earrings on your ears and a beautiful crown on your head.
- 13 You were provided with everything precious and beautiful: with exquisite clothes and elegant food, garnished with honey and oil. You were absolutely stunning. You were a queen!
- 13 So you were adorned with gold and silver; your clothes were of fine linen and costly fabric and embroidered cloth. Your food was fine flour, honey and olive oil. You became very beautiful and rose to be a queen.

- 14 You became world-famous, a legendary beauty brought to perfection by my adornments. Decree of GOD, the Master.
- 14 And your fame spread among the nations on account of your beauty, because the splendor I had given you made your beauty perfect, declares the Sovereign LORD.
- 15 "But your beauty went to your head and you became a common whore, grabbing anyone coming down the street and taking him into your bed.
- 15 'But you trusted in your beauty and used your fame to become a prostitute. You lavished your favors on anyone who passed by and your beauty became his.
- 16 You took your fine dresses and made "tents" of them, using them as brothels in which you practiced your trade. This kind of thing should never happen, never.
- 16 You took some of your garments to make gaudy high places, where you carried on your prostitution. Such things should not happen, nor should they ever occur.
- 17 "And then you took all that fine jewelry I gave you, my gold and my silver, and made pornographic images of them for your brothels.
- 17 You also took the fine jewelry I gave you, the jewelry made of my gold and silver, and you made for yourself male idols and engaged in prostitution with them.
- 18 You decorated your beds with fashionable silks and cottons, and perfumed them with my aromatic oils and incense.
- 18 And you took your embroidered clothes to put on them, and you offered my oil and incense before them.
- 19 And then you set out the wonderful foods I provided--the fresh breads and fruits, with fine herbs and spices, which were my gifts to you--and you served them as delicacies in your whorehouses. That's what happened, says GOD, the Master.
- 19 Also the food I provided for you--the fine flour, olive oil and honey I gave you to eat--you offered as fragrant incense before them. That is what happened, declares the Sovereign LORD.
- 20 "And then you took your sons and your daughters, whom you had given birth to as my children, and you killed them, sacrificing them to idols. Wasn't it bad enough that you had become a whore?

- 20 'And you took your sons and daughters whom you bore to me and sacrificed them as food to the idols. Was your prostitution not enough?
- 21 And now you're a murderer, killing my children and sacrificing them to idols.
- 21 You slaughtered my children and sacrificed them to the idols.
- 22 "'Not once during these years of outrageous obscenities and whorings did you remember your infancy, when you were naked and exposed, a blood-smeared newborn.
- 22 In all your detestable practices and your prostitution you did not remember the days of your youth, when you were naked and bare, kicking about in your blood.
- 23 "'And then to top off all your evil acts, you built your bold brothels in every town square. Doom! Doom to you, says GOD, the Master!
- 23 'Woe! Woe to you, declares the Sovereign LORD. In addition to all your other wickedness,
- 24 At every major intersection you built your bold brothels and exposed your sluttish sex, spreading your legs for everyone who passed by.
- 24 you built a mound for yourself and made a lofty shrine in every public square.
- 25 "'And then you went international with your whoring.
- 25 At the head of every street you built your lofty shrines and degraded your beauty, offering your body with increasing promiscuity to anyone who passed by.
- 26 You fornicated with the Egyptians, seeking them out in their sex orgies. The more promiscuous you became, the angrier I got.
- 26 You engaged in prostitution with the Egyptians, your lustful neighbors, and provoked me to anger with your increasing promiscuity.
- 27 Finally, I intervened, reduced your borders and turned you over to the rapacity of your enemies. Even the Philistine women--can you believe it?--were shocked at your sluttish life.
- 27 So I stretched out my hand against you and reduced your territory; I gave you over to the greed of your enemies, the daughters of the Philistines, who were shocked by your lewd conduct.
- 28 "'You went on to fornicate with the Assyrians. Your appetite was insatiable. But still you weren't satisfied.

- 28 You engaged in prostitution with the Assyrians too, because you were insatiable; and even after that, you still were not satisfied.
- 29 You took on the Babylonians, a country of businessmen, and still you weren't satisfied.
- 29 Then you increased your promiscuity to include Babylonia, a land of merchants, but even with this you were not satisfied.
- 30 "'What a sick soul! Doing all this stuff--the champion whore!
- 30 'How weak-willed you are, declares the Sovereign LORD, when you do all these things, acting like a brazen prostitute!
- 31 You built your bold brothels at every major intersection, opened up your whorehouses in every neighborhood, but you were different from regular whores in that you wouldn't accept a fee.
- 31 When you built your mounds at the head of every street and made your lofty shrines in every public square, you were unlike a prostitute, because you scorned payment.
- 32 "'Wives who are unfaithful to their husbands accept gifts from their lovers.
- 32 'You adulterous wife! You prefer strangers to your own husband!
- 33 And men commonly pay their whores. But you pay your lovers! You bribe men from all over to come to bed with you!
- 33 Every prostitute receives a fee, but you give gifts to all your lovers, bribing them to come to you from everywhere for your illicit favors.
- 34 You're just the opposite of the regular whores who get paid for sex. Instead, you pay men for their favors! You even pervert whoredom!
- 34 So in your prostitution you are the opposite of others; no one runs after you for your favors. You are the very opposite, for you give payment and none is given to you.
- 35 "'Therefore, whore, listen to GOD's Message:
- 35 'Therefore, you prostitute, hear the word of the LORD!
- 36 I, GOD, the Master, say, Because you've been unrestrained in your promiscuity, stripped down for every lover, flaunting your sex, and because of your pornographic idols and all the slaughtered children you offered to them,
- 36 This is what the Sovereign LORD says: Because you poured out your wealth and exposed your nakedness in your promiscuity with your

- lovers, and because of all your detestable idols, and because you gave them your children's blood,
- 37 therefore, because of all this, I'm going to get all your lovers together, all those you've used for your own pleasure, the ones you loved and the ones you loathed. I'll assemble them as a courtroom of spectators around you. In broad daylight I'll strip you naked before them--they'll see what you really look like.
- 37 therefore I am going to gather all your lovers, with whom you found pleasure, those you loved as well as those you hated. I will gather them against you from all around and will strip you in front of them, and they will see all your nakedness.
- 38 Then I'll sentence you to the punishment for an adulterous woman and a murderous woman. I'll give you a taste of my wrath!
- 38 I will sentence you to the punishment of women who commit adultery and who shed blood; I will bring upon you the blood vengeance of my wrath and jealous anger.
- 39 "'I'll gather all your lovers around you and turn you over to them. They'll tear down your bold brothels and sex shrines. They'll rip off your clothes, take your jewels, and leave you naked and exposed. Then
- 39 Then I will hand you over to your lovers, and they will tear down your mounds and destroy your lofty shrines. They will strip you of your clothes and take your fine jewelry and leave you naked and bare.
- 40 they'll call for a mass meeting. The mob will stone you and hack you to pieces with their swords.
- 40 They will bring a mob against you, who will stone you and hack you to pieces with their swords.
- 41 They'll burn down your houses. A massive judgment--with all the women watching! "'I'll have put a full stop to your whoring life--no more paying lovers to come to your bed!
- 41 They will burn down your houses and inflict punishment on you in the sight of many women. I will put a stop to your prostitution, and you will no longer pay your lovers.
- 42 By then my anger will be played out. My jealousy will subside.
- 42 Then my wrath against you will subside and my jealous anger will turn away from you; I will be calm and no longer angry.

- 43 ""Because you didn't remember what happened when you were young but made me angry with all this behavior, I'll make you pay for your waywardness. Didn't you just exponentially compound your outrageous obscenities with all your sluttish ways?
- 43 'Because you did not remember the days of your youth but enraged me with all these things, I will surely bring down on your head what you have done, declares the Sovereign LORD. Did you not add lewdness to all your other detestable practices?
- 44 ""Everyone who likes to use proverbs will use this one: "Like mother, like daughter."
- 44 'Everyone who quotes proverbs will quote this proverb about you: Like mother, like daughter."
- 45 You're the daughter of your mother, who couldn't stand her husband and children. And you're a true sister of your sisters, who couldn't stand their husbands and children. Your mother was a Hittite and your father an Amorite.
- 45 You are a true daughter of your mother, who despised her husband and her children; and you are a true sister of your sisters, who despised their husbands and their children. Your mother was a Hittite and your father an Amorite.
- 46 ""Your older sister is Samaria. She lived to the north of you with her daughters. Your younger sister is Sodom, who lived to the south of you with her daughters.
- 46 Your older sister was Samaria, who lived to the north of you with her daughters; and your younger sister, who lived to the south of you with her daughters, was Sodom.
- 47 Haven't you lived just like they did? Haven't you engaged in outrageous obscenities just like they did? In fact, it didn't take you long to catch up and pass them!
- 47 You not only walked in their ways and copied their detestable practices, but in all your ways you soon became more depraved than they.
- 48 As sure as I am the living God!--Decree of GOD, the Master--your sister Sodom and her daughters never even came close to what you and your daughters have done.
- 48 As surely as I live, declares the Sovereign LORD, your sister Sodom and her daughters never did what you and your daughters have done.

49 "'The sin of your sister Sodom was this: She lived with her daughters in the lap of luxury--proud, gluttonous, and lazy. They ignored the oppressed and the poor.

49 'Now this was the sin of your sister Sodom: She and her daughters were arrogant, overfed and unconcerned; they did not help the poor and needy.

50 They put on airs and lived obscene lives. And you know what happened: I did away with them.

50 They were haughty and did detestable things before me. Therefore I did away with them as you have seen.

51 "'And Samaria. Samaria didn't sin half as much as you. You've committed far more obscenities than she ever did. Why, you make your two sisters look good in comparison with what you've done!

51 Samaria did not commit half the sins you did. You have done more detestable things than they, and have made your sisters seem righteous by all these things you have done.

52 Face it, your sisters look mighty good compared with you. Because you've outsinned them so completely, you've actually made them look righteous. Aren't you ashamed? But you're going to have to live with it. What a reputation to carry into history: outsinning your two sisters!

52 Bear your disgrace, for you have furnished some justification for your sisters. Because your sins were more vile than theirs, they appear more righteous than you. So then, be ashamed and bear your disgrace, for you have made your sisters appear righteous.

53 "'But I'm going to reverse their fortunes, the fortunes of Sodom and her daughters and the fortunes of Samaria and her daughters. And--get this--your fortunes right along with them!

53 'However, I will restore the fortunes of Sodom and her daughters and of Samaria and her daughters, and your fortunes along with them,

54 Still, you're going to have to live with your shame. And by facing and accepting your shame, you're going to provide some comfort to your two sisters.

54 so that you may bear your disgrace and be ashamed of all you have done in giving them comfort.

55 Your sisters, Sodom with her daughters and Samaria with her daughters, will become what they were before, and you will become what you were before.

55 And your sisters, Sodom with her daughters and Samaria with her daughters, will return to what they were before; and you and your daughters will return to what you were before.

56 Remember the days when you were putting on airs, acting so high and mighty, looking down on sister Sodom?

56 You would not even mention your sister Sodom in the day of your pride,

57 That was before your evil ways were exposed. And now you're the butt of contempt, despised by the Edomite women, the Philistine women, and everybody else around.

57 before your wickedness was uncovered. Even so, you are now scorned by the daughters of Edom and all her neighbors and the daughters of the Philistines--all those around you who despise you.

58 But you have to face it, to accept the shame of your obscene and vile life. Decree of GOD, the Master.

58 You will bear the consequences of your lewdness and your detestable practices, declares the LORD.

59 "GOD, the Master, says, I'll do to you just as you have already done, you who have treated my oath with contempt and broken the covenant.

59 'This is what the Sovereign LORD says: I will deal with you as you deserve, because you have despised my oath by breaking the covenant.

60 All the same, I'll remember the covenant I made with you when you were young and I'll make a new covenant with you that will last forever.

60 Yet I will remember the covenant I made with you in the days of your youth, and I will establish an everlasting covenant with you.

61 You'll remember your sorry past and be properly contrite when you receive back your sisters, both the older and the younger. I'll give them to you as daughters, but not as participants in your covenant.

61 Then you will remember your ways and be ashamed when you receive your sisters, both those who are older than you and those who are younger. I will give them to you as daughters, but not on the basis of my covenant with you.

62 I'll firmly establish my covenant with you and you'll know that I am GOD.

62 So I will establish my covenant with you, and you will know that I am the LORD.

- 63 You'll remember your past life and face the shame of it, but when I make atonement for you, make everything right after all you've done, it will leave you speechless.'" Decree of GOD, the Master.
- 63 Then, when I make atonement for you for all you have done, you will remember and be ashamed and never again open your mouth because of your humiliation, declares the Sovereign LORD.' "

Ezekiel 17

MSG

NIV

- 1 GOD's Message came to me:
- 1 The word of the LORD came to me:
- 2 "Son of man, make a riddle for the house of Israel. Tell them a story.
- 2 Son of man, set forth an allegory and tell the house of Israel a parable.
- 3 Say, 'GOD, the Master, says: "'A great eagle with a huge wingspan and long feathers, In full plumage and bright colors, came to Lebanon And took the top off a cedar,
- 3 Say to them, 'This is what the Sovereign LORD says: A great eagle with powerful wings, long feathers and full plumage of varied colors came to Lebanon. Taking hold of the top of a cedar,
- 4 broke off the top branch, Took it to a land of traders, and set it down in a city of shopkeepers.
- 4 he broke off its topmost shoot and carried it away to a land of merchants, where he planted it in a city of traders.
- 5 Then he took a cutting from the land and planted it in good, well-watered soil, like a willow on a riverbank.
- 5 'He took some of the seed of your land and put it in fertile soil. He planted it like a willow by abundant water,
- 6 It sprouted into a flourishing vine, low to the ground. Its branches grew toward the eagle and the roots became established-- A vine putting out shoots, developing branches.
- 6 and it sprouted and became a low, spreading vine. Its branches turned toward him, but its roots remained under it. So it became a vine and produced branches and put out leafy boughs.

- 7 ""There was another great eagle with a huge wingspan and thickly feathered. This vine sent out its roots toward him from the place where it was planted. Its branches reached out to him so he could water it from a long distance.
- 7 'But there was another great eagle with powerful wings and full plumage. The vine now sent out its roots toward him from the plot where it was planted and stretched out its branches to him for water.
- 8 It had been planted in good, well-watered soil, And it put out branches and bore fruit, and became a noble vine.
- 8 It had been planted in good soil by abundant water so that it would produce branches, bear fruit and become a splendid vine.'
- 9 ""GOD, the Master, says, Will it thrive? Won't he just pull it up by the roots and leave the grapes to rot And the branches to shrivel up, a withered, dead vine? It won't take much strength or many hands to pull it up.
- 9 Say to them, 'This is what the Sovereign LORD says: Will it thrive? Will it not be uprooted and stripped of its fruit so that it withers? All its new growth will wither. It will not take a strong arm or many people to pull it up by the roots.
- 10 Even if it's transplanted, will it thrive? When the hot east wind strikes it, won't it shrivel up? Won't it dry up and blow away from the place where it was planted?""
- 10 Even if it is transplanted, will it thrive? Will it not wither completely when the east wind strikes it--wither away in the plot where it grew?" "
- 11 GOD's Message came to me:
- 11 Then the word of the LORD came to me:
- 12 "Tell this house of rebels, 'Do you get it? Do you know what this means?' "Tell them, 'The king of Babylon came to Jerusalem and took its king and its leaders back to Babylon.
- 12 Say to this rebellious house, 'Do you not know what these things mean?' Say to them: 'The king of Babylon went to Jerusalem and carried off her king and her nobles, bringing them back with him to Babylon.
- 13 He took one of the royal family and made a covenant with him, making him swear his loyalty. The king of Babylon took all the top leaders into exile

- 13 Then he took a member of the royal family and made a treaty with him, putting him under oath. He also carried away the leading men of the land,
- 14 to make sure that this kingdom stayed weak--didn't get any big ideas of itself--and kept the covenant with him so that it would have a future.
- 14 so that the kingdom would be brought low, unable to rise again, surviving only by keeping his treaty.
- 15 ""But he rebelled and sent emissaries to Egypt to recruit horses and a big army. Do you think that's going to work? Are they going to get by with this? Does anyone break a covenant and get off scot-free?
- 15 But the king rebelled against him by sending his envoys to Egypt to get horses and a large army. Will he succeed? Will he who does such things escape? Will he break the treaty and yet escape?
- 16 ""As sure as I am the living God, this king who broke his pledge of loyalty and his covenant will die in that country, in Babylon.
- 16 'As surely as I live, declares the Sovereign LORD, he shall die in Babylon, in the land of the king who put him on the throne, whose oath he despised and whose treaty he broke.
- 17 Pharaoh with his big army--all those soldiers!--won't lift a finger to fight for him when Babylon sets siege to the city and kills everyone inside.
- 17 Pharaoh with his mighty army and great horde will be of no help to him in war, when ramps are built and siege works erected to destroy many lives.
- 18 Because he broke his word and broke the covenant, even though he gave his solemn promise, because he went ahead and did all these things anyway, he won't escape.
- 18 He despised the oath by breaking the covenant. Because he had given his hand in pledge and yet did all these things, he shall not escape.
- 19 ""Therefore, GOD, the Master, says, As sure as I am the living God, because the king despised my oath and broke my covenant, I'll bring the consequences crashing down on his head.
- 19 'Therefore this is what the Sovereign LORD says: As surely as I live, I will bring down on his head my oath that he despised and my covenant that he broke.
- 20 I'll send out a search party and catch him. I'll take him to Babylon and have him brought to trial because of his total disregard for me.

- 20 I will spread my net for him, and he will be caught in my snare. I will bring him to Babylon and execute judgment upon him there because he was unfaithful to me.
- 21 All his elite soldiers, along with the rest of the army, will be killed in battle, and whoever is left will be scattered to the four winds. Then you'll realize that I, GOD, have spoken.
- 21 All his fleeing troops will fall by the sword, and the survivors will be scattered to the winds. Then you will know that I the LORD have spoken.
- 22 "'GOD, the Master, says, I personally will take a shoot from the top of the towering cedar, a cutting from the crown of the tree, and plant it on a high and towering mountain,
- 22 'This is what the Sovereign LORD says: I myself will take a shoot from the very top of a cedar and plant it; I will break off a tender sprig from its topmost shoots and plant it on a high and lofty mountain.
- 23 on the high mountain of Israel. It will grow, putting out branches and fruit--a majestic cedar. Birds of every sort and kind will live under it. They'll build nests in the shade of its branches.
- 23 On the mountain heights of Israel I will plant it; it will produce branches and bear fruit and become a splendid cedar. Birds of every kind will nest in it; they will find shelter in the shade of its branches.
- 24 All the trees of the field will recognize that I, GOD, made the great tree small and the small tree great, made the green tree turn dry and the dry tree sprout green branches. I, GOD, said it--and I did it."
- 24 All the trees of the field will know that I the LORD bring down the tall tree and make the low tree grow tall. I dry up the green tree and make the dry tree flourish. " 'I the LORD have spoken, and I will do it.' "

Ezekiel 18

MSG

NIV

- 1 GOD's Message to me:
- 1 The word of the LORD came to me:
- 2 "What do you people mean by going around the country repeating the saying, The parents ate green apples, The children got stomachache?

- 2 What do you people mean by quoting this proverb about the land of Israel: 'The fathers eat sour grapes, and the children's teeth are set on edge'?
- 3 "As sure as I'm the living God, you're not going to repeat this saying in Israel any longer.
- 3 As surely as I live, declares the Sovereign LORD, you will no longer quote this proverb in Israel.
- 4 Every soul--man, woman, child--belongs to me, parent and child alike. You die for your own sin, not another's.
- 4 For every living soul belongs to me, the father as well as the son--both alike belong to me. The soul who sins is the one who will die.
- 5 "Imagine a person who lives well, treating others fairly, keeping good relationships--
- 5 Suppose there is a righteous man who does what is just and right.
- 6 doesn't eat at the pagan shrines, doesn't worship the idols so popular in Israel, doesn't seduce a neighbor's spouse, doesn't indulge in casual sex,
- 6 He does not eat at the mountain shrines or look to the idols of the house of Israel. He does not defile his neighbor's wife or lie with a woman during her period.
- 7 doesn't bully anyone, doesn't pile up bad debts, doesn't steal, doesn't refuse food to the hungry, doesn't refuse clothing to the ill-clad,
- 7 He does not oppress anyone, but returns what he took in pledge for a loan. He does not commit robbery but gives his food to the hungry and provides clothing for the naked.
- 8 doesn't exploit the poor, doesn't live by impulse and greed, doesn't treat one person better than another,
- 8 He does not lend at usury or take excessive interest. He withholds his hand from doing wrong and judges fairly between man and man.
- 9 But lives by my statutes and faithfully honors and obeys my laws. This person who lives upright and well shall live a full and true life. Decree of GOD, the Master.
- 9 He follows my decrees and faithfully keeps my laws. That man is righteous; he will surely live, declares the Sovereign LORD.
- 10 "But if this person has a child who turns violent and murders and goes off and does any of these things,

- 10 Suppose he has a violent son, who sheds blood or does any of these other things
- 11 even though the parent has done none of them-- eats at the pagan shrines, seduces his neighbor's spouse,
- 11 (though the father has done none of them): "He eats at the mountain shrines. He defiles his neighbor's wife.
- 12 bullies the weak, steals, piles up bad debts, admires idols, commits outrageous obscenities,
- 12 He oppresses the poor and needy. He commits robbery. He does not return what he took in pledge. He looks to the idols. He does detestable things.
- 13 exploits the poor "--do you think this person, the child, will live? Not a chance! Because he's done all these vile things, he'll die. And his death will be his own fault.
- 13 He lends at usury and takes excessive interest. Will such a man live? He will not! Because he has done all these detestable things, he will surely be put to death and his blood will be on his own head.
- 14 "Now look: Suppose that this child has a child who sees all the sins done by his parent. The child sees them, but doesn't follow in the parent's footsteps--
- 14 But suppose this son has a son who sees all the sins his father commits, and though he sees them, he does not do such things:
- 15 doesn't eat at the pagan shrines, doesn't worship the popular idols of Israel, doesn't seduce his neighbor's spouse,
- 15 He does not eat at the mountain shrines or look to the idols of the house of Israel. He does not defile his neighbor's wife.
- 16 doesn't bully anyone, doesn't refuse to loan money, doesn't steal, doesn't refuse food to the hungry, doesn't refuse to give clothes to the ill-clad,
- 16 He does not oppress anyone or require a pledge for a loan. He does not commit robbery but gives his food to the hungry and provides clothing for the naked.
- 17 doesn't live by impulse and greed, doesn't exploit the poor. He does what I say; he performs my laws and lives by my statutes. "This person will not die for the sins of the parent; he will live truly and well.
- 17 He withholds his hand from sin and takes no usury or excessive interest. He keeps my laws and follows my decrees. He will not die for his

father's sin; he will surely live.

18 But the parent will die for what the parent did, for the sins of--oppressing the weak, robbing brothers and sisters, doing what is dead wrong in the community.

18 But his father will die for his own sin, because he practiced extortion, robbed his brother and did what was wrong among his people.

19 "Do you need to ask, 'So why does the child not share the guilt of the parent?' 'Isn't it plain? It's because the child did what is fair and right. Since the child was careful to do what is lawful and right, the child will live truly and well.

19 Yet you ask, 'Why does the son not share the guilt of his father?' Since the son has done what is just and right and has been careful to keep all my decrees, he will surely live.

20 The soul that sins is the soul that dies. The child does not share the guilt of the parent, nor the parent the guilt of the child. If you live upright and well, you get the credit; if you live a wicked life, you're guilty as charged.

20 The soul who sins is the one who will die. The son will not share the guilt of the father, nor will the father share the guilt of the son. The righteousness of the righteous man will be credited to him, and the wickedness of the wicked will be charged against him.

21 "But a wicked person who turns his back on that life of sin and keeps all my statutes, living a just and righteous life, he'll live, really live. He won't die.

21 But if a wicked man turns away from all the sins he has committed and keeps all my decrees and does what is just and right, he will surely live; he will not die.

22 I won't keep a list of all the things he did wrong. He will live.

22 None of the offenses he has committed will be remembered against him. Because of the righteous things he has done, he will live.

23 Do you think I take any pleasure in the death of wicked men and women? Isn't it my pleasure that they turn around, no longer living wrong but living right--really living?

23 Do I take any pleasure in the death of the wicked? declares the Sovereign LORD. Rather, am I not pleased when they turn from their ways and live?

- 24 "The same thing goes for a good person who turns his back on an upright life and starts sinning, plunging into the same vile obscenities that the wicked person practices. Will this person live? I don't keep a list of all the things this person did right, like money in the bank he can draw on. Because of his defection, because he accumulates sin, he'll die.
- 24 But if a righteous man turns from his righteousness and commits sin and does the same detestable things the wicked man does, will he live? None of the righteous things he has done will be remembered. Because of the unfaithfulness he is guilty of and because of the sins he has committed, he will die.
- 25 "Do I hear you saying, 'That's not fair! God's not fair!?' "Listen, Israel. I'm not fair? You're the ones who aren't fair!
- 25 Yet you say, 'The way of the Lord is not just.' Hear, O house of Israel: Is my way unjust? Is it not your ways that are unjust?
- 26 If a good person turns away from his good life and takes up sinning, he'll die for it. He'll die for his own sin.
- 26 If a righteous man turns from his righteousness and commits sin, he will die for it; because of the sin he has committed he will die.
- 27 Likewise, if a bad person turns away from his bad life and starts living a good life, a fair life, he will save his life.
- 27 But if a wicked man turns away from the wickedness he has committed and does what is just and right, he will save his life.
- 28 Because he faces up to all the wrongs he's committed and puts them behind him, he will live, really live. He won't die.
- 28 Because he considers all the offenses he has committed and turns away from them, he will surely live; he will not die.
- 29 "And yet Israel keeps on whining, 'That's not fair! God's not fair.' "I'm not fair, Israel? You're the ones who aren't fair.
- 29 Yet the house of Israel says, 'The way of the Lord is not just.' Are my ways unjust, O house of Israel? Is it not your ways that are unjust?
- 30 "The upshot is this, Israel: I'll judge each of you according to the way you live. So turn around! Turn your backs on your rebellious living so that sin won't drag you down.
- 30 Therefore, O house of Israel, I will judge you, each one according to his ways, declares the Sovereign LORD. Repent! Turn away from all your offenses; then sin will not be your downfall.

- 31 Clean house. No more rebellions, please. Get a new heart! Get a new spirit! Why would you choose to die, Israel?
- 31 Rid yourselves of all the offenses you have committed, and get a new heart and a new spirit. Why will you die, O house of Israel?
- 32 I take no pleasure in anyone's death. Decree of GOD, the Master. "Make a clean break! Live!"
- 32 For I take no pleasure in the death of anyone, declares the Sovereign LORD. Repent and live!

Ezekiel 19

MSG

NIV

- 1 Sing the blues over the princes of Israel.
- 1 Take up a lament concerning the princes of Israel
- 2 Say: What a lioness was your mother among lions! She crouched in a pride of young lions. Her cubs grew large.
- 2 and say: " 'What a lioness was your mother among the lions! She lay down among the young lions and reared her cubs.
- 3 She reared one of her cubs to maturity, a robust young lion. He learned to hunt. He ate men.
- 3 She brought up one of her cubs, and he became a strong lion. He learned to tear the prey and he devoured men.
- 4 Nations sounded the alarm. He was caught in a trap. They took him with hooks and dragged him to Egypt.
- 4 The nations heard about him, and he was trapped in their pit. They led him with hooks to the land of Egypt.
- 5 When the lioness saw she was luckless, that her hope for that cub was gone, She took her other cub and made him a strong young lion.
- 5 'When she saw her hope unfulfilled, her expectation gone, she took another of her cubs and made him a strong lion.
- 6 He prowled with the lions, a robust young lion. He learned to hunt. He ate men.
- 6 He prowled among the lions, for he was now a strong lion. He learned to tear the prey and he devoured men.

- 7 He rampaged through their defenses, left their cities in ruins. The country and everyone in it was terrorized by the roars of the lion.
- 7 He broke down their strongholds and devastated their towns. The land and all who were in it were terrified by his roaring.
- 8 The nations got together to hunt him. Everyone joined the hunt. They set out their traps and caught him.
- 8 Then the nations came against him, those from regions round about. They spread their net for him, and he was trapped in their pit.
- 9 They put a wooden collar on him and took him to the king of Babylon. No more would that voice be heard disturbing the peace in the mountains of Israel!
- 9 With hooks they pulled him into a cage and brought him to the king of Babylon. They put him in prison, so his roar was heard no longer on the mountains of Israel.
- 10 Here's another way to put it: Your mother was like a vine in a vineyard, transplanted alongside streams of water, Luxurious in branches and grapes because of the ample water.
- 10 'Your mother was like a vine in your vineyard planted by the water; it was fruitful and full of branches because of abundant water.
- 11 It grew sturdy branches fit to be carved into a royal scepter. It grew high, reaching into the clouds. Its branches filled the horizon, and everyone could see it.
- 11 Its branches were strong, fit for a ruler's scepter. It towered high above the thick foliage, conspicuous for its height and for its many branches.
- 12 Then it was ripped up in a rage and thrown to the ground. The hot east wind shriveled it up and stripped its fruit. The sturdy branches dried out, fit for nothing but kindling.
- 12 But it was uprooted in fury and thrown to the ground. The east wind made it shrivel, it was stripped of its fruit; its strong branches withered and fire consumed them.
- 13 Now it's a stick stuck out in the desert, a bare stick in a desert of death,
- 13 Now it is planted in the desert, in a dry and thirsty land.
- 14 Good for nothing but making fires, campfires in the desert. Not a hint now of those sturdy branches fit for use as a royal scepter! (This is a sad song, a text for singing the blues.)

- 14 Fire spread from one of its main branches and consumed its fruit. No strong branch is left on it fit for a ruler's scepter.' This is a lament and is to be used as a lament."

Ezekiel 20

MSG

NIV

- 1 In the seventh year, the fifth month, on the tenth day of the month, some of the leaders of Israel came to ask for guidance from GOD. They sat down before me.
- 1 In the seventh year, in the fifth month on the tenth day, some of the elders of Israel came to inquire of the LORD, and they sat down in front of me.
- 2 Then GOD's Message came to me:
- 2 Then the word of the LORD came to me:
- 3 "Son of man, talk with the leaders of Israel. Tell them, 'GOD, the Master, says, "Have you come to ask me questions? As sure as I am the living God, I'll not put up with questions from you. Decree of GOD, the Master.'"
- 3 Son of man, speak to the elders of Israel and say to them, 'This is what the Sovereign LORD says: Have you come to inquire of me? As surely as I live, I will not let you inquire of me, declares the Sovereign LORD.'
- 4 "Son of man, why don't you do it? Yes, go ahead. Hold them accountable. Confront them with the outrageous obscenities of their parents.
- 4 Will you judge them? Will you judge them, son of man? Then confront them with the detestable practices of their fathers
- 5 Tell them that GOD, the Master, says: "'On the day I chose Israel, I revealed myself to them in the country of Egypt, raising my hand in a solemn oath to the people of Jacob, in which I said, "I am GOD, your personal God."
- 5 and say to them: 'This is what the Sovereign LORD says: On the day I chose Israel, I swore with uplifted hand to the descendants of the house of Jacob and revealed myself to them in Egypt. With uplifted hand I said to them, "I am the LORD your God."
- 6 On the same day that I raised my hand in the solemn oath, I promised them that I would take them out of the country of Egypt and bring them

- into a country that I had searched out just for them, a country flowing with milk and honey, a jewel of a country.
- 6 On that day I swore to them that I would bring them out of Egypt into a land I had searched out for them, a land flowing with milk and honey, the most beautiful of all lands.
- 7 "At that time I told them, "Get rid of all the vile things that you've become addicted to. Don't make yourselves filthy with the Egyptian no-god idols. I alone am GOD, your God."
- 7 And I said to them, "Each of you, get rid of the vile images you have set your eyes on, and do not defile yourselves with the idols of Egypt. I am the LORD your God."
- 8 "But they rebelled against me, wouldn't listen to a word I said. None got rid of the vile things they were addicted to. They held on to the no-gods of Egypt as if for dear life. I seriously considered inflicting my anger on them in force right there in Egypt.
- 8 'But they rebelled against me and would not listen to me; they did not get rid of the vile images they had set their eyes on, nor did they forsake the idols of Egypt. So I said I would pour out my wrath on them and spend my anger against them in Egypt.
- 9 Then I thought better of it. I acted out of who I was, not by how I felt. And I acted in a way that would evoke honor, not blasphemy, from the nations around them, nations who had seen me reveal myself by promising to lead my people out of Egypt.
- 9 But for the sake of my name I did what would keep it from being profaned in the eyes of the nations they lived among and in whose sight I had revealed myself to the Israelites by bringing them out of Egypt.
- 10 And then I did it: I led them out of Egypt into the desert.
- 10 Therefore I led them out of Egypt and brought them into the desert.
- 11 "I gave them laws for living, showed them how to live well and obediently before me.
- 11 I gave them my decrees and made known to them my laws, for the man who obeys them will live by them.
- 12 I also gave them my weekly holy rest days, my "Sabbaths," a kind of signpost erected between me and them to show them that I, GOD, am in the business of making them holy.

- 12 Also I gave them my Sabbaths as a sign between us, so they would know that I the LORD made them holy.
- 13 ""But Israel rebelled against me in the desert. They didn't follow my statutes. They despised my laws for living well and obediently in the ways I had set out. And they totally desecrated my holy Sabbaths. I seriously considered unleashing my anger on them right there in the desert.
- 13 'Yet the people of Israel rebelled against me in the desert. They did not follow my decrees but rejected my laws--although the man who obeys them will live by them--and they utterly desecrated my Sabbaths. So I said I would pour out my wrath on them and destroy them in the desert.
- 14 But I thought better of it and acted out of who I was, not by what I felt, so that I might be honored and not blasphemed by the nations who had seen me bring them out.
- 14 But for the sake of my name I did what would keep it from being profaned in the eyes of the nations in whose sight I had brought them out.
- 15 But I did lift my hand in a solemn oath there in the desert and promise them that I would not bring them into the country flowing with milk and honey that I had chosen for them, that jewel among all lands.
- 15 Also with uplifted hand I swore to them in the desert that I would not bring them into the land I had given them--a land flowing with milk and honey, most beautiful of all lands--
- 16 I canceled my promise because they despised my laws for living obediently, wouldn't follow my statutes, and went ahead and desecrated my holy Sabbaths. They preferred living by their no-god idols.
- 16 because they rejected my laws and did not follow my decrees and desecrated my Sabbaths. For their hearts were devoted to their idols.
- 17 But I didn't go all the way: I didn't wipe them out, didn't finish them off in the desert.
- 17 Yet I looked on them with pity and did not destroy them or put an end to them in the desert.
- 18 ""Then I addressed myself to their children in the desert: "Don't do what your parents did. Don't take up their practices. Don't make yourselves filthy with their no-god idols.

- 18 I said to their children in the desert, "Do not follow the statutes of your fathers or keep their laws or defile yourselves with their idols.
- 19 I myself am GOD, your God: Keep my statutes and live by my laws.
- 19 I am the LORD your God; follow my decrees and be careful to keep my laws.
- 20 Keep my Sabbaths as holy rest days, signposts between me and you, signaling that I am GOD, your God."
- 20 Keep my Sabbaths holy, that they may be a sign between us. Then you will know that I am the LORD your God."
- 21 "'But the children also rebelled against me. They neither followed my statutes nor kept my laws for living upright and well. And they desecrated my Sabbaths. I seriously considered dumping my anger on them, right there in the desert.
- 21 'But the children rebelled against me: They did not follow my decrees, they were not careful to keep my laws--although the man who obeys them will live by them--and they desecrated my Sabbaths. So I said I would pour out my wrath on them and spend my anger against them in the desert.
- 22 But I thought better of it and acted out of who I was, not by what I felt, so that I might be honored and not blasphemed by the nations who had seen me bring them out.
- 22 But I withheld my hand, and for the sake of my name I did what would keep it from being profaned in the eyes of the nations in whose sight I had brought them out.
- 23 "'But I did lift my hand in solemn oath there in the desert, and swore that I would scatter them all over the world, disperse them every which way
- 23 Also with uplifted hand I swore to them in the desert that I would disperse them among the nations and scatter them through the countries,
- 24 because they didn't keep my laws nor live by my statutes. They desecrated my Sabbaths and remained addicted to the no-god idols of their parents.
- 24 because they had not obeyed my laws but had rejected my decrees and desecrated my Sabbaths, and their eyes lusted after their fathers' idols.
- 25 Since they were determined to live bad lives, I myself gave them statutes that could not produce goodness and laws that did not produce

life.

25 I also gave them over to statutes that were not good and laws they could not live by;

26 I abandoned them. Filthy in the gutter, they perversely sacrificed their firstborn children in the fire. The very horror should have shocked them into recognizing that I am GOD.'

26 I let them become defiled through their gifts--the sacrifice of every firstborn--that I might fill them with horror so they would know that I am the LORD.'

27 "Therefore, speak to Israel, son of man. Tell them that GOD says, 'As if that wasn't enough, your parents further insulted me by betraying me.

27 Therefore, son of man, speak to the people of Israel and say to them, 'This is what the Sovereign LORD says: In this also your fathers blasphemed me by forsaking me:

28 When I brought them into that land that I had solemnly promised with my upraised hand to give them, every time they saw a hill with a sex-and-religion shrine on it or a grove of trees where the sacred whores practiced, they were there, buying into the whole pagan system.

28 When I brought them into the land I had sworn to give them and they saw any high hill or any leafy tree, there they offered their sacrifices, made offerings that provoked me to anger, presented their fragrant incense and poured out their drink offerings.

29 I said to them, "What hill do you go to?" (It's still called "Whore Hills.")

29 Then I said to them: What is this high place you go to?' " (It is called Bamah to this day.)

30 "Therefore, say to Israel, 'The Message of GOD, the Master: You're making your lives filthy by copying the ways of your parents. In repeating their vile practices, you've become whores yourselves.

30 Therefore say to the house of Israel: 'This is what the Sovereign LORD says: Will you defile yourselves the way your fathers did and lust after their vile images?

31 In burning your children as sacrifices, you've become as filthy as your no-god idols--as recently as today! "Am I going to put up with questions from people like you, Israel? As sure as I am the living God, I, GOD, the Master, refuse to be called into question by you!

- 31 When you offer your gifts-- the sacrifice of your sons in the fire--you continue to defile yourselves with all your idols to this day. Am I to let you inquire of me, O house of Israel? As surely as I live, declares the Sovereign LORD, I will not let you inquire of me.
- 32 "'What you're secretly thinking is never going to happen. You're thinking, "We're going to be like everybody else, just like the other nations. We're going to worship gods we can make and control."
- 32 'You say, We want to be like the nations, like the peoples of the world, who serve wood and stone." But what you have in mind will never happen.
- 33 "'As sure as I am the living God, says GOD, the Master, think again! With a mighty show of strength and a terrifying rush of anger, I will be King over you!
- 33 As surely as I live, declares the Sovereign LORD, I will rule over you with a mighty hand and an outstretched arm and with outpoured wrath.
- 34 I'll bring you back from the nations, collect you out of the countries to which you've been scattered, with a mighty show of strength and a terrifying rush of anger.
- 34 I will bring you from the nations and gather you from the countries where you have been scattered--with a mighty hand and an outstretched arm and with outpoured wrath.
- 35 I'll bring you to the desert of nations and haul you into court, where you'll be face to face with judgment.
- 35 I will bring you into the desert of the nations and there, face to face, I will execute judgment upon you.
- 36 "'As I faced your parents with judgment in the desert of Egypt, so I'll face you with judgment.
- 36 As I judged your fathers in the desert of the land of Egypt, so I will judge you, declares the Sovereign LORD.
- 37 I'll scrutinize and search every person as you arrive, and I'll bring you under the bond of the covenant.
- 37 I will take note of you as you pass under my rod, and I will bring you into the bond of the covenant.
- 38 I'll cull out the rebels and traitors. I'll lead them out of their exile, but I won't bring them back to Israel. "'Then you'll realize that I am GOD.

- 38 I will purge you of those who revolt and rebel against me. Although I will bring them out of the land where they are living, yet they will not enter the land of Israel. Then you will know that I am the LORD.
- 39 "'But you, people of Israel, this is the Message of GOD, the Master, to you: Go ahead, serve your no-god idols! But later, you'll think better of it and quit throwing filth and mud on me with your pagan offerings and no-god idols.
- 39 'As for you, O house of Israel, this is what the Sovereign LORD says: Go and serve your idols, every one of you! But afterward you will surely listen to me and no longer profane my holy name with your gifts and idols.
- 40 For on my holy mountain, the high mountain of Israel, I, GOD, the Master, tell you that the entire people of Israel will worship me. I'll receive them there with open arms. I'll demand your best gifts and offerings, all your holy sacrifices.
- 40 For on my holy mountain, the high mountain of Israel, declares the Sovereign LORD, there in the land the entire house of Israel will serve me, and there I will accept them. There I will require your offerings and your choice gifts, along with all your holy sacrifices.
- 41 What's more, I'll receive you as the best kind of offerings when I bring you back from all the lands and countries in which you've been scattered. I'll demonstrate in the eyes of the world that I am The Holy.
- 41 I will accept you as fragrant incense when I bring you out from the nations and gather you from the countries where you have been scattered, and I will show myself holy among you in the sight of the nations.
- 42 When I return you to the land of Israel, the land that I solemnly promised with upraised arm to give to your parents, you'll realize that I am GOD.
- 42 Then you will know that I am the LORD, when I bring you into the land of Israel, the land I had sworn with uplifted hand to give to your fathers.
- 43 Then and there you'll remember all that you've done, the way you've lived that has made you so filthy--and you'll loathe yourselves.
- 43 There you will remember your conduct and all the actions by which you have defiled yourselves, and you will loathe yourselves for all the evil you have done.

- 44 "'But, dear Israel, you'll also realize that I am GOD when I respond to you out of who I am, not by what I feel about the evil lives you've lived, the corrupt history you've compiled. Decree of GOD, the Master.'"
- 44 You will know that I am the LORD, when I deal with you for my name's sake and not according to your evil ways and your corrupt practices, O house of Israel, declares the Sovereign LORD.' "
- 45 GOD's Message came to me:
- 45 The word of the LORD came to me:
- 46 "Son of man, face south. Let the Message roll out against the south. Prophecy against the wilderness forest of the south.
- 46 Son of man, set your face toward the south; preach against the south and prophecy against the forest of the southland.
- 47 "Tell the forest of the south, 'Listen to the Message of GOD! GOD, the Master, says, I'll set a fire in you that will burn up every tree, dead trees and live trees alike. Nobody will put out the fire. The whole country from south to north will be blackened by it.
- 47 Say to the southern forest: 'Hear the word of the LORD. This is what the Sovereign LORD says: I am about to set fire to you, and it will consume all your trees, both green and dry. The blazing flame will not be quenched, and every face from south to north will be scorched by it.
- 48 Everyone is going to see that I, GOD, started the fire and that it's not going to be put out.'"
- 48 Everyone will see that I the LORD have kindled it; it will not be quenched.' "
- 49 And I said, "O GOD, everyone is saying of me, 'He just makes up stories.'"
- 49 Then I said, "Ah, Sovereign LORD! They are saying of me, 'Isn't he just telling parables?' "

Ezekiel 21

MSG

NIV

- 1 GOD's Message came to me:
- 1 The word of the LORD came to me:

- 2 "Son of man, now face Jerusalem and let the Message roll out against the Sanctuary. Prophecy against the land of Israel.
- 2 Son of man, set your face against Jerusalem and preach against the sanctuary. Prophecy against the land of Israel
- 3 Say, 'GOD's Message: I'm against you. I'm pulling my sword from its sheath and killing both the wicked and the righteous.
- 3 and say to her: 'This is what the LORD says: I am against you. I will draw my sword from its scabbard and cut off from you both the righteous and the wicked.
- 4 Because I'm treating everyone the same, good and bad, everyone from south to north is going to feel my sword!
- 4 Because I am going to cut off the righteous and the wicked, my sword will be unsheathed against everyone from south to north.
- 5 Everyone will know that I mean business.'
- 5 Then all people will know that I the LORD have drawn my sword from its scabbard; it will not return again.'
- 6 "So, son of man, groan! Double up in pain. Make a scene!
- 6 Therefore groan, son of man! Groan before them with broken heart and bitter grief.
- 7 "When they ask you, 'Why all this groaning, this carrying on?' say, 'Because of the news that's coming. It'll knock the breath out of everyone. Hearts will stop cold, knees turn to rubber. Yes, it's coming. No stopping it. Decree of GOD, the Master.'"
- 7 And when they ask you, 'Why are you groaning?' you shall say, 'Because of the news that is coming. Every heart will melt and every hand go limp; every spirit will become faint and every knee become as weak as water.' It is coming! It will surely take place, declares the Sovereign LORD."
- 8 GOD's Message to me:
- 8 The word of the LORD came to me:
- 9 "Son of man, prophesy. Tell them, 'The Master says: "'A sword! A sword! razor-sharp and polished,
- 9 Son of man, prophesy and say, 'This is what the Lord says: 'A sword, a sword, sharpened and polished--
- 10 Sharpened to kill, polished to flash like lightning! "'My child, you've despised the scepter of Judah by worshiping every tree-idol.

- 10 sharpened for the slaughter, polished to flash like lightning! " 'Shall we rejoice in the scepter of my son Judah? The sword despises every such stick.
- 11 "'The sword is made to glisten, to be held and brandished. It's sharpened and polished, ready to be brandished by the killer.'
- 11 'The sword is appointed to be polished, to be grasped with the hand; it is sharpened and polished, made ready for the hand of the slayer.
- 12 "Yell out and wail, son of man. The sword is against my people! The princes of Israel and my people--abandoned to the sword! Wring your hands! Tear out your hair!
- 12 Cry out and wail, son of man, for it is against my people; it is against all the princes of Israel. They are thrown to the sword along with my people. Therefore beat your breast.
- 13 "'Testing comes. Why have you despised discipline? You can't get around it. Decree of GOD, the Master.'
- 13 'Testing will surely come. And what if the scepter of Judah, which the sword despises, does not continue? declares the Sovereign LORD.'
- 14 "So, prophesy, son of man! Clap your hands. Get their attention. Tell them that the sword's coming down once, twice, three times. It's a sword to kill, a sword for a massacre, A sword relentless, a sword inescapable--
- 14 So then, son of man, prophesy and strike your hands together. Let the sword strike twice, even three times. It is a sword for slaughter-- a sword for great slaughter, closing in on them from every side.
- 15 People collapsing right and left, going down like dominoes. I've stationed a murderous sword at every gate in the city, Flashing like lightning, brandished murderously.
- 15 So that hearts may melt and the fallen be many, I have stationed the sword for slaughter at all their gates. Oh! It is made to flash like lightning, it is grasped for slaughter.
- 16 Cut to the right, thrust to the left, murderous, sharp-edged sword!
- 16 O sword, slash to the right, then to the left, wherever your blade is turned.
- 17 Then I'll clap my hands, a signal that my anger is spent. I, GOD, have spoken."
- 17 I too will strike my hands together, and my wrath will subside. I the LORD have spoken."

- 18 GOD's Message came to me:
- 18 The word of the LORD came to me:
- 19 "Son of man, lay out two roads for the sword of the king of Babylon to take. Start them from the same place. Place a signpost at the beginning of each road.
- 19 Son of man, mark out two roads for the sword of the king of Babylon to take, both starting from the same country. Make a signpost where the road branches off to the city.
- 20 Post one sign to mark the road of the sword to Rabbah of the Ammonites. Post the other to mark the road to Judah and Fort Jerusalem.
- 20 Mark out one road for the sword to come against Rabbah of the Ammonites and another against Judah and fortified Jerusalem.
- 21 The king of Babylon stands at the fork in the road and he decides by divination which of the two roads to take. He draws straws, he throws god-dice, he examines a goat liver.
- 21 For the king of Babylon will stop at the fork in the road, at the junction of the two roads, to seek an omen: He will cast lots with arrows, he will consult his idols, he will examine the liver.
- 22 He opens his right hand: The omen says, 'Head for Jerusalem!' So he's on his way with battering rams, roused to kill, sounding the battle cry, pounding down city gates, building siege works.
- 22 Into his right hand will come the lot for Jerusalem, where he is to set up battering rams, to give the command to slaughter, to sound the battle cry, to set battering rams against the gates, to build a ramp and to erect siege works.
- 23 "To the Judah leaders, who themselves have sworn oaths, it will seem like a false divination, but he will remind them of their guilt, and so they'll be captured.
- 23 It will seem like a false omen to those who have sworn allegiance to him, but he will remind them of their guilt and take them captive.
- 24 "So this is what GOD, the Master, says: 'Because your sin is now out in the open so everyone can see what you've been doing, you'll be taken captive.
- 24 Therefore this is what the Sovereign LORD says: 'Because you people have brought to mind your guilt by your open rebellion, revealing your

sins in all that you do--because you have done this, you will be taken captive.

25 "'O Zedekiah, blasphemous and evil prince of Israel: Time's up. It's "punishment payday."

25 'O profane and wicked prince of Israel, whose day has come, whose time of punishment has reached its climax,

26 GOD says, Take your royal crown off your head. No more "business as usual." The underdog will be promoted and the top dog will be demoted.

26 this is what the Sovereign LORD says: Take off the turban, remove the crown. It will not be as it was: The lowly will be exalted and the exalted will be brought low.

27 Ruins, ruins, ruins! I'll turn the whole place into ruins. And ruins it will remain until the one comes who has a right to it. Then I'll give it to him.'

27 A ruin! A ruin! I will make it a ruin! It will not be restored until he comes to whom it rightfully belongs; to him I will give it.'

28 "But, son of man, your job is to prophesy. Tell them, 'This is the Message from GOD, the Master, against the Ammonites and against their cruel taunts: "'A sword! A sword! Bared to kill, Sharp as a razor, flashing like lightning.

28 And you, son of man, prophesy and say, 'This is what the Sovereign LORD says about the Ammonites and their insults: 'A sword, a sword, drawn for the slaughter, polished to consume and to flash like lightning!

29 Despite false sword propaganda circulated in Ammon, The sword will sever Ammonite necks, for whom it's punishment payday.

29 Despite false visions concerning you and lying divinations about you, it will be laid on the necks of the wicked who are to be slain, whose day has come, whose time of punishment has reached its climax.

30 Return the sword to the sheath! I'll judge you in your home country, in the land where you grew up.

30 Return the sword to its scabbard. In the place where you were created, in the land of your ancestry, I will judge you.

31 I'll empty out my wrath on you, breathe hot anger down your neck. I'll give you to vicious men skilled in torture.

31 I will pour out my wrath upon you and breathe out my fiery anger against you; I will hand you over to brutal men, men skilled in destruction.

32 You'll end up as stove-wood. Corpses will litter your land. Not so much as a memory will be left of you. I, GOD, have said so."

32 You will be fuel for the fire, your blood will be shed in your land, you will be remembered no more; for I the LORD have spoken.' "

Ezekiel 22

MSG

NIV

1 GOD's Message came to me:

1 The word of the LORD came to me:

2 "Son of man, are you going to judge this bloody city or not? Come now, are you going to judge her? Do it! Face her with all her outrageous obscenities.

2 Son of man, will you judge her? Will you judge this city of bloodshed? Then confront her with all her detestable practices

3 Tell her, 'This is what GOD, the Master, says: You're a city murderous at the core, just asking for punishment. You're a city obsessed with no-god idols, making yourself filthy.

3 and say: 'This is what the Sovereign LORD says: O city that brings on herself doom by shedding blood in her midst and defiles herself by making idols,

4 In all your killing, you've piled up guilt. In all your idol-making, you've become filthy. You've forced a premature end to your existence. I'll put you on exhibit as the scarecrow of the nations, the world's worst joke.

4 you have become guilty because of the blood you have shed and have become defiled by the idols you have made. You have brought your days to a close, and the end of your years has come. Therefore I will make you an object of scorn to the nations and a laughingstock to all the countries.

5 From far and near they'll deride you as infamous in filth, notorious for chaos.

5 Those who are near and those who are far away will mock you, O infamous city, full of turmoil.

6 "'Your leaders, the princes of Israel among you, compete in crime.

- 6 'See how each of the princes of Israel who are in you uses his power to shed blood.
- 7 You're a community that's insolent to parents, abusive to outsiders, oppressive against orphans and widows.
- 7 In you they have treated father and mother with contempt; in you they have oppressed the alien and mistreated the fatherless and the widow.
- 8 You treat my holy things with contempt and desecrate my Sabbaths.
- 8 You have despised my holy things and desecrated my Sabbaths.
- 9 You have people spreading lies and spilling blood, flocking to the hills to the sex shrines and fornicating unrestrained.
- 9 In you are slanderous men bent on shedding blood; in you are those who eat at the mountain shrines and commit lewd acts.
- 10 Incest is common. Men force themselves on women regardless of whether they're ready or willing.
- 10 In you are those who dishonor their fathers' bed; in you are those who violate women during their period, when they are ceremonially unclean.
- 11 Sex is now anarchy. Anyone is fair game: neighbor, daughter-in-law, sister.
- 11 In you one man commits a detestable offense with his neighbor's wife, another shamefully defiles his daughter-in-law, and another violates his sister, his own father's daughter.
- 12 Murder is for hire, usury is rampant, extortion is commonplace. "'And you've forgotten me. Decree of GOD, the Master.
- 12 In you men accept bribes to shed blood; you take usury and excessive interest and make unjust gain from your neighbors by extortion. And you have forgotten me, declares the Sovereign LORD.
- 13 "'Now look! I've clapped my hands, calling everyone's attention to your rapacious greed and your bloody brutalities.
- 13 'I will surely strike my hands together at the unjust gain you have made and at the blood you have shed in your midst.
- 14 Can you stick with it? Will you be able to keep at this once I start dealing with you? "'I, GOD, have spoken. I'll put an end to this.
- 14 Will your courage endure or your hands be strong in the day I deal with you? I the LORD have spoken, and I will do it.
- 15 I'll throw you to the four winds. I'll scatter you all over the world. I'll put a full stop to your filthy living.

- 15 I will disperse you among the nations and scatter you through the countries; and I will put an end to your uncleanness.
- 16 You will be defiled, spattered with your own mud in the eyes of the nations. And you'll recognize that I am GOD."
- 16 When you have been defiled in the eyes of the nations, you will know that I am the LORD.' "
- 17 GOD's Message came to me:
- 17 Then the word of the LORD came to me:
- 18 "Son of man, the people of Israel are slag to me, the useless byproduct of refined copper, tin, iron, and lead left at the smelter--a worthless slag heap.
- 18 Son of man, the house of Israel has become dross to me; all of them are the copper, tin, iron and lead left inside a furnace. They are but the dross of silver.
- 19 So tell them, 'GOD, the Master, has spoken: Because you've all become worthless slag, you're on notice: I'll assemble you in Jerusalem.
- 19 Therefore this is what the Sovereign LORD says: 'Because you have all become dross, I will gather you into Jerusalem.
- 20 As men gather silver, copper, iron, lead, and tin into a furnace and blow fire on it to melt it down, so in my wrath I'll gather you and melt you down.
- 20 As men gather silver, copper, iron, lead and tin into a furnace to melt it with a fiery blast, so will I gather you in my anger and my wrath and put you inside the city and melt you.
- 21 I'll blow on you with the fire of my wrath to melt you down in the furnace.
- 21 I will gather you and I will blow on you with my fiery wrath, and you will be melted inside her.
- 22 As silver is melted down, you'll be melted down. That should get through to you. Then you'll recognize that I, GOD, have let my wrath loose on you."
- 22 As silver is melted in a furnace, so you will be melted inside her, and you will know that I the LORD have poured out my wrath upon you.' "
- 23 GOD's Message came to me:
- 23 Again the word of the LORD came to me:

- 24 "Son of man, tell her, 'You're a land that during the time I was angry with you got no rain, not so much as a spring shower.
- 24 Son of man, say to the land, 'You are a land that has had no rain or showers in the day of wrath.'
- 25 The leaders among you became desperate, like roaring, ravaging lions killing indiscriminately. They grabbed and looted, leaving widows in their wake.
- 25 There is a conspiracy of her princes within her like a roaring lion tearing its prey; they devour people, take treasures and precious things and make many widows within her.
- 26 ""Your priests violated my law and desecrated my holy things. They can't tell the difference between sacred and secular. They tell people there's no difference between right and wrong. They're contemptuous of my holy Sabbaths, profaning me by trying to pull me down to their level.
- 26 Her priests do violence to my law and profane my holy things; they do not distinguish between the holy and the common; they teach that there is no difference between the unclean and the clean; and they shut their eyes to the keeping of my Sabbaths, so that I am profaned among them.
- 27 Your politicians are like wolves prowling and killing and rapaciously taking whatever they want.
- 27 Her officials within her are like wolves tearing their prey; they shed blood and kill people to make unjust gain.
- 28 Your preachers cover up for the politicians by pretending to have received visions and special revelations. They say, "This is what GOD, the Master, says . . ." when GOD hasn't said so much as one word.
- 28 Her prophets whitewash these deeds for them by false visions and lying divinations. They say, 'This is what the Sovereign LORD says'--when the LORD has not spoken.
- 29 Extortion is rife, robbery is epidemic, the poor and needy are abused, outsiders are kicked around at will, with no access to justice.'
- 29 The people of the land practice extortion and commit robbery; they oppress the poor and needy and mistreat the alien, denying them justice.
- 30 "I looked for someone to stand up for me against all this, to repair the defenses of the city, to take a stand for me and stand in the gap to protect this land so I wouldn't have to destroy it. I couldn't find anyone. Not one.

- 30 I looked for a man among them who would build up the wall and stand before me in the gap on behalf of the land so I would not have to destroy it, but I found none.
- 31 So I'll empty out my wrath on them, burn them to a crisp with my hot anger, serve them with the consequences of all they've done. Decree of GOD, the Master."
- 31 So I will pour out my wrath on them and consume them with my fiery anger, bringing down on their own heads all they have done, declares the Sovereign LORD."

Ezekiel 23

MSG

NIV

- 1 GOD's Message came to me:
- 1 The word of the LORD came to me:
- 2 "Son of man, there were two women, daughters of the same mother.
- 2 Son of man, there were two women, daughters of the same mother.
- 3 They became whores in Egypt, whores from a young age. Their breasts were fondled, their young bosoms caressed.
- 3 They became prostitutes in Egypt, engaging in prostitution from their youth. In that land their breasts were fondled and their virgin bosoms caressed.
- 4 The older sister was named Oholah, the younger was Oholibah. They were my daughters, and they gave birth to sons and daughters. "Oholah is Samaria and Oholibah is Jerusalem.
- 4 The older was named Oholah, and her sister was Oholibah. They were mine and gave birth to sons and daughters. Oholah is Samaria, and Oholibah is Jerusalem.
- 5 "Oholah started whoring while she was still mine. She lusted after Assyrians as lovers: military men
- 5 Oholah engaged in prostitution while she was still mine; and she lusted after her lovers, the Assyrians--warriors
- 6 smartly uniformed in blue, ambassadors and governors, good-looking young men mounted on fine horses.

- 6 clothed in blue, governors and commanders, all of them handsome young men, and mounted horsemen.
- 7 Her lust was unrestrained. She was a whore to the Assyrian elite. She compounded her filth with the idols of those to whom she gave herself in lust.
- 7 She gave herself as a prostitute to all the elite of the Assyrians and defiled herself with all the idols of everyone she lusted after.
- 8 She never slowed down. The whoring she began while young in Egypt she continued, sleeping with men who played with her breasts and spent their lust on her.
- 8 She did not give up the prostitution she began in Egypt, when during her youth men slept with her, caressed her virgin bosom and poured out their lust upon her.
- 9 "So I left her to her Assyrian lovers, for whom she was so obsessed with lust.
- 9 Therefore I handed her over to her lovers, the Assyrians, for whom she lusted.
- 10 They ripped off her clothes, took away her children, and then, the final indignity, killed her. Among women her name became Shame--history's judgment on her.
- 10 They stripped her naked, took away her sons and daughters and killed her with the sword. She became a byword among women, and punishment was inflicted on her.
- 11 "Her sister Oholibah saw all this, but she became even worse than her sister in lust and whoring, if you can believe it.
- 11 Her sister Oholibah saw this, yet in her lust and prostitution she was more depraved than her sister.
- 12 She also went crazy with lust for Assyrians: ambassadors and governors, military men smartly dressed and mounted on fine horses--the Assyrian elite.
- 12 She too lusted after the Assyrians--governors and commanders, warriors in full dress, mounted horsemen, all handsome young men.
- 13 And I saw that she also had become incredibly filthy. Both women followed the same path.
- 13 I saw that she too defiled herself; both of them went the same way.

- 14 But Oholibah surpassed her sister. When she saw figures of Babylonians carved in relief on the walls and painted red,
- 14 But she carried her prostitution still further. She saw men portrayed on a wall, figures of Chaldeans portrayed in red,
- 15 fancy belts around their waists, elaborate turbans on their heads, all of them looking important--famous Babylonians!--
- 15 with belts around their waists and flowing turbans on their heads; all of them looked like Babylonian chariot officers, natives of Chaldea.
- 16 she went wild with lust and sent invitations to them in Babylon.
- 16 As soon as she saw them, she lusted after them and sent messengers to them in Chaldea.
- 17 The Babylonians came on the run, fornicated with her, made her dirty inside and out. When they had thoroughly debased her, she lost interest in them.
- 17 Then the Babylonians came to her, to the bed of love, and in their lust they defiled her. After she had been defiled by them, she turned away from them in disgust.
- 18 Then she went public with her fornication. She exhibited her sex to the world. "I turned my back on her just as I had on her sister.
- 18 When she carried on her prostitution openly and exposed her nakedness, I turned away from her in disgust, just as I had turned away from her sister.
- 19 But that didn't slow her down. She went at her whoring harder than ever. She remembered when she was young, just starting out as a whore in Egypt.
- 19 Yet she became more and more promiscuous as she recalled the days of her youth, when she was a prostitute in Egypt.
- 20 That whetted her appetite for more virile, vulgar, and violent lovers--stallions obsessive in their lust.
- 20 There she lusted after her lovers, whose genitals were like those of donkeys and whose emission was like that of horses.
- 21 She longed for the sexual prowess of her youth back in Egypt, where her firm young breasts were caressed and fondled.
- 21 So you longed for the lewdness of your youth, when in Egypt your bosom was caressed and your young breasts fondled.

- 22 ""Therefore, Oholibah, this is the Message from GOD, the Master: I will incite your old lovers against you, lovers you got tired of and left in disgust. I'll bring them against you from every direction,
- 22 Therefore, Oholibah, this is what the Sovereign LORD says: I will stir up your lovers against you, those you turned away from in disgust, and I will bring them against you from every side--
- 23 Babylonians and all the Chaldeans, Pekod, Shoa, and Koa, and all Assyrians--good-looking young men, ambassadors and governors, elite officers and celebrities--all of them mounted on fine, spirited horses.
- 23 the Babylonians and all the Chaldeans, the men of Pekod and Shoa and Koa, and all the Assyrians with them, handsome young men, all of them governors and commanders, chariot officers and men of high rank, all mounted on horses.
- 24 They'll come down on you out of the north, armed to the teeth, bringing chariots and troops from all sides. I'll turn over the task of judgment to them. They'll punish you according to their rules.
- 24 They will come against you with weapons, chariots and wagons and with a throng of people; they will take up positions against you on every side with large and small shields and with helmets. I will turn you over to them for punishment, and they will punish you according to their standards.
- 25 I'll stand totally and relentlessly against you as they rip into you furiously. They'll mutilate you, cutting off your ears and nose, killing at random. They'll enslave your children--and anybody left over will be burned.
- 25 I will direct my jealous anger against you, and they will deal with you in fury. They will cut off your noses and your ears, and those of you who are left will fall by the sword. They will take away your sons and daughters, and those of you who are left will be consumed by fire.
- 26 They'll rip off your clothes and steal your jewelry.
- 26 They will also strip you of your clothes and take your fine jewelry.
- 27 I'll put a stop to your sluttish sex, the whoring life you began in Egypt. You won't look on whoring with fondness anymore. You won't think back on Egypt with stars in your eyes.
- 27 So I will put a stop to the lewdness and prostitution you began in Egypt. You will not look on these things with longing or remember Egypt

anymore.

28 "'A Message from GOD, the Master: I'm at the point of abandoning you to those you hate, to those by whom you're repulsed.

28 For this is what the Sovereign LORD says: I am about to hand you over to those you hate, to those you turned away from in disgust.

29 They'll treat you hatefully, leave you publicly naked, your whore's body exposed in the cruel glare of the sun. Your sluttish lust

29 They will deal with you in hatred and take away everything you have worked for. They will leave you naked and bare, and the shame of your prostitution will be exposed. Your lewdness and promiscuity

30 will be exposed. Your lust has brought you to this condition because you whored with pagan nations and made yourself filthy with their no-god idols.

30 have brought this upon you, because you lusted after the nations and defiled yourself with their idols.

31 "'You copied the life of your sister. Now I'll let you drink the cup she drank.

31 You have gone the way of your sister; so I will put her cup into your hand.

32 "'This is the Message of GOD, the Master: "'You'll drink your sister's cup, a cup canyon-deep and ocean-wide. You'll be shunned and taunted as you drink from that cup, full to the brim.

32 This is what the Sovereign LORD says: You will drink your sister's cup, a cup large and deep; it will bring scorn and derision, for it holds so much.

33 You'll be falling-down-drunk and the tears will flow as you drink from that cup titanic with terror: It's the cup of your sister Samaria.

33 You will be filled with drunkenness and sorrow, the cup of ruin and desolation, the cup of your sister Samaria.

34 You'll drink it dry, then smash it to bits and eat the pieces, and end up tearing at your breasts. I've given the word-- Decree of GOD, the Master.

34 You will drink it and drain it dry; you will dash it to pieces and tear your breasts. I have spoken, declares the Sovereign LORD.

35 "'Therefore GOD, the Master, says, Because you've forgotten all about me, pushing me into the background, you now must pay for what you've done--pay for your sluttish sex and whoring life."

35 Therefore this is what the Sovereign LORD says: Since you have forgotten me and thrust me behind your back, you must bear the consequences of your lewdness and prostitution.

36 Then GOD said to me, "Son of man, will you confront Oholah and Oholibah with what they've done? Make them face their outrageous obscenities,

36 The LORD said to me: "Son of man, will you judge Oholah and Oholibah? Then confront them with their detestable practices,

37 obscenities ranging from adultery to murder. They committed adultery with their no-god idols, sacrificed the children they bore me in order to feed their idols!

37 for they have committed adultery and blood is on their hands. They committed adultery with their idols; they even sacrificed their children, whom they bore to me, as food for them.

38 And there is also this: They've defiled my holy Sanctuary and desecrated my holy Sabbaths.

38 They have also done this to me: At that same time they defiled my sanctuary and desecrated my Sabbaths.

39 The same day that they sacrificed their children to their idols, they walked into my Sanctuary and defiled it. That's what they did--in my house!

39 On the very day they sacrificed their children to their idols, they entered my sanctuary and desecrated it. That is what they did in my house.

40 "Furthermore, they even sent out invitations by special messenger to men far away--and, sure enough, they came. They bathed themselves, put on makeup and provocative lingerie.

40 They even sent messengers for men who came from far away, and when they arrived you bathed yourself for them, painted your eyes and put on your jewelry.

41 They reclined on a sumptuous bed, aromatic with incense and oils--my incense and oils!

41 You sat on an elegant couch, with a table spread before it on which you had placed the incense and oil that belonged to me.

42 The crowd gathered, jostling and pushing, a drunken rabble. They adorned the sisters with bracelets on their arms and tiaras on their heads.

42 The noise of a carefree crowd was around her; Sabeans were brought from the desert along with men from the rabble, and they put bracelets on the arms of the woman and her sister and beautiful crowns on their heads.

43 "I said, 'She's burned out on sex!' but that didn't stop them. They kept banging on her doors night and day

43 Then I said about the one worn out by adultery, 'Now let them use her as a prostitute, for that is all she is.'

44 as men do when they're after a whore. That's how they used Oholah and Oholibah, the worn-out whores.

44 And they slept with her. As men sleep with a prostitute, so they slept with those lewd women, Oholah and Oholibah.

45 "Righteous men will pronounce judgment on them, giving out sentences for adultery and murder. That was their lifework: adultery and murder."

45 But righteous men will sentence them to the punishment of women who commit adultery and shed blood, because they are adulterous and blood is on their hands.

46 "GOD says, 'Let a mob loose on them: Terror! Plunder!

46 This is what the Sovereign LORD says: Bring a mob against them and give them over to terror and plunder.

47 Let the mob stone them and hack them to pieces--kill all their children, burn down their houses!

47 The mob will stone them and cut them down with their swords; they will kill their sons and daughters and burn down their houses.

48 "'I'll put an end to sluttish sex in this country so that all women will be well warned and not copy you.

48 So I will put an end to lewdness in the land, that all women may take warning and not imitate you.

49 You'll pay the price for all your obsessive sex. You'll pay in full for your promiscuous affairs with idols. And you'll realize that I am GOD, the Master."

49 You will suffer the penalty for your lewdness and bear the consequences of your sins of idolatry. Then you will know that I am the Sovereign LORD."

Ezekiel 24

MSG

NIV

- 1 The Message of GOD came to me in the ninth year, the tenth month, and the tenth day of the month:
- 1 In the ninth year, in the tenth month on the tenth day, the word of the LORD came to me:
- 2 "Son of man, write down this date. The king of Babylon has laid siege to Jerusalem this very day.
- 2 Son of man, record this date, this very date, because the king of Babylon has laid siege to Jerusalem this very day.
- 3 Tell this company of rebels a story: "'Put on the soup pot. Fill it with water.
- 3 Tell this rebellious house a parable and say to them: 'This is what the Sovereign LORD says: "'Put on the cooking pot; put it on and pour water into it.
- 4 Put chunks of meat into it, all the choice pieces--loin and brisket. Pick out the best soup bones
- 4 Put into it the pieces of meat, all the choice pieces--the leg and the shoulder. Fill it with the best of these bones;
- 5 from the best of the sheep in the flock. Pile wood beneath the pot. Bring it to a boil and cook the soup.
- 5 take the pick of the flock. Pile wood beneath it for the bones; bring it to a boil and cook the bones in it.
- 6 "'GOD, the Master, says: "'Doom to the city of murder, to the pot thick with scum, thick with a filth that can't be scoured. Empty the pot piece by piece; don't bother who gets what.
- 6 'For this is what the Sovereign LORD says: 'Woe to the city of bloodshed, to the pot now encrusted, whose deposit will not go away! Empty it piece by piece without casting lots for them.
- 7 "'The blood from murders has stained the whole city; Blood runs bold on the street stones, with no one bothering to wash it off--
- 7 'For the blood she shed is in her midst: She poured it on the bare rock; she did not pour it on the ground, where the dust would cover it.

- 8 Blood out in the open to public view to provoke my wrath, to trigger my vengeance.
- 8 To stir up wrath and take revenge I put her blood on the bare rock, so that it would not be covered.
- 9 "'Therefore, this is what GOD, the Master, says: "'Doom to the city of murder! I, too, will pile on the wood.
- 9 'Therefore this is what the Sovereign LORD says: 'Woe to the city of bloodshed! I, too, will pile the wood high.
- 10 Stack the wood high, light the match, Cook the meat, spice it well, pour out the broth, and then burn the bones.
- 10 So heap on the wood and kindle the fire. Cook the meat well, mixing in the spices; and let the bones be charred.
- 11 Then I'll set the empty pot on the coals and heat it red-hot so the bronze glows, So the germs are killed and the corruption is burned off.
- 11 Then set the empty pot on the coals till it becomes hot and its copper glows so its impurities may be melted and its deposit burned away.
- 12 But it's hopeless. It's too far gone. The filth is too thick.
- 12 It has frustrated all efforts; its heavy deposit has not been removed, not even by fire.
- 13 "'Your encrusted filth is your filthy sex. I wanted to clean you up, but you wouldn't let me. I'll make no more attempts at cleaning you up until my anger quiets down.
- 13 'Now your impurity is lewdness. Because I tried to cleanse you but you would not be cleansed from your impurity, you will not be clean again until my wrath against you has subsided.
- 14 I, GOD, have said it, and I'll do it. I'm not holding back. I've run out of compassion. I'm not changing my mind. You're getting exactly what's coming to you. Decree of GOD, the Master."
- 14 'I the LORD have spoken. The time has come for me to act. I will not hold back; I will not have pity, nor will I relent. You will be judged according to your conduct and your actions, declares the Sovereign LORD.'
- 15 GOD's Message came to me:
- 15 The word of the LORD came to me:
- 16 "Son of man, I'm about to take from you the delight of your life--a real blow, I know. But, please, no tears.

- 16 Son of man, with one blow I am about to take away from you the delight of your eyes. Yet do not lament or weep or shed any tears.
- 17 Keep your grief to yourself. No public mourning. Get dressed as usual and go about your work--none of the usual funeral rituals."
- 17 Groan quietly; do not mourn for the dead. Keep your turban fastened and your sandals on your feet; do not cover the lower part of your face or eat the customary food of mourners."
- 18 I preached to the people in the morning. That evening my wife died. The next morning I did as I'd been told.
- 18 So I spoke to the people in the morning, and in the evening my wife died. The next morning I did as I had been commanded.
- 19 The people came to me, saying, "Tell us why you're acting like this. What does it mean, anyway?"
- 19 Then the people asked me, "Won't you tell us what these things have to do with us?"
- 20 So I told them, "GOD's Word came to me, saying,
- 20 So I said to them, "The word of the LORD came to me:
- 21 'Tell the family of Israel, This is what GOD, the Master, says: I will desecrate my Sanctuary, your proud impregnable fort, the delight of your life, your heart's desire. The children you left behind will be killed.
- 21 Say to the house of Israel, 'This is what the Sovereign LORD says: I am about to desecrate my sanctuary--the stronghold in which you take pride, the delight of your eyes, the object of your affection. The sons and daughters you left behind will fall by the sword.
- 22 "'Then you'll do exactly as I've done. You'll perform none of the usual funeral rituals.
- 22 And you will do as I have done. You will not cover the lower part of your face or eat the customary food of mourners.
- 23 You'll get dressed as usual and go about your work. No tears. But your sins will eat away at you from within and you'll groan among yourselves.
- 23 You will keep your turbans on your heads and your sandals on your feet. You will not mourn or weep but will waste away because of your sins and groan among yourselves.
- 24 Ezekiel will be your example. The way he did it is the way you'll do it. "'When this happens you'll recognize that I am GOD, the Master.'"

- 24 Ezekiel will be a sign to you; you will do just as he has done. When this happens, you will know that I am the Sovereign LORD.'
- 25 "And you, son of man: The day I take away the people's refuge, their great joy, the delight of their life, what they've most longed for, along with all their children--
- 25 And you, son of man, on the day I take away their stronghold, their joy and glory, the delight of their eyes, their heart's desire, and their sons and daughters as well--
- 26 on that very day a survivor will arrive and tell you what happened to the city.
- 26 on that day a fugitive will come to tell you the news.
- 27 You'll break your silence and start talking again, talking to the survivor. Again, you'll be an example for them. And they'll recognize that I am GOD."
- 27 At that time your mouth will be opened; you will speak with him and will no longer be silent. So you will be a sign to them, and they will know that I am the LORD."

Ezekiel 25

MSG

NIV

- 1 GOD's Message came to me:
- 1 The word of the LORD came to me:
- 2 "Son of man, face Ammon and preach against the people:
- 2 Son of man, set your face against the Ammonites and prophesy against them.
- 3 Listen to the Message of GOD, the Master. This is what GOD has to say: Because you cheered when my Sanctuary was desecrated and the land of Judah was devastated and the people of Israel were taken into exile,
- 3 Say to them, 'Hear the word of the Sovereign LORD. This is what the Sovereign LORD says: Because you said "Aha!" over my sanctuary when it was desecrated and over the land of Israel when it was laid waste and over the people of Judah when they went into exile,
- 4 I'm giving you over to the people of the east. They'll move in and make themselves at home, eating the food right off your tables and drinking your milk.
- 4 therefore I am going to give you to the people of the East as a possession. They will set up their camps and pitch their tents among you; they will eat your fruit and drink your milk.
- 5 I'll turn your capital, Rabbah, into pasture for camels and all your villages into corrals for flocks. Then you'll realize that I am GOD.
- 5 I will turn Rabbah into a pasture for camels and Ammon into a resting place for sheep. Then you will know that I am the LORD.
- 6 "GOD, the Master, says, Because you clapped and cheered, venting all your malicious contempt against the land of Israel,
- 6 For this is what the Sovereign LORD says: Because you have clapped your hands and stamped your feet, rejoicing with all the malice of your heart against the land of Israel,
- 7 I'll step in and hand you out as loot--first come, first served. I'll cross you off the roster of nations. There'll be nothing left of you. And you'll realize that I am GOD."

- 7 therefore I will stretch out my hand against you and give you as plunder to the nations. I will cut you off from the nations and exterminate you from the countries. I will destroy you, and you will know that I am the LORD.' "
- 8 "GOD, the Master, says: Because Moab said, 'Look, Judah's nothing special,'
- 8 This is what the Sovereign LORD says: 'Because Moab and Seir said, Look, the house of Judah has become like all the other nations,"
- 9 I'll lay wide open the flank of Moab by exposing its lovely frontier villages to attack: Beth-jeshimoth, Baal-meon, and Kiriathaim.
- 9 therefore I will expose the flank of Moab, beginning at its frontier towns--Beth Jeshimoth, Baal Meon and Kiriathaim--the glory of that land.
- 10 I'll lump Moab in with Ammon and give them to the people of the east for the taking. Ammon won't be heard from again.
- 10 I will give Moab along with the Ammonites to the people of the East as a possession, so that the Ammonites will not be remembered among the nations;
- 11 I'll punish Moab severely. And they'll realize that I am GOD."
- 11 and I will inflict punishment on Moab. Then they will know that I am the LORD.' "
- 12 "GOD, the Master, says: Because Edom reacted against the people of Judah in spiteful revenge and was so criminally vengeful against them,
- 12 This is what the Sovereign LORD says: 'Because Edom took revenge on the house of Judah and became very guilty by doing so,
- 13 therefore I, GOD, the Master, will oppose Edom and kill the lot of them, people and animals both. I'll waste it--corpses stretched from Teman to Dedan.
- 13 therefore this is what the Sovereign LORD says: I will stretch out my hand against Edom and kill its men and their animals. I will lay it waste, and from Teman to Dedan they will fall by the sword.
- 14 I'll use my people Israel to bring my vengeance down on Edom. My wrath will fuel their action. And they'll realize it's my vengeance. Decree of GOD the Master."
- 14 I will take vengeance on Edom by the hand of my people Israel, and they will deal with Edom in accordance with my anger and my wrath; they will know my vengeance, declares the Sovereign LORD.' "

- 15 "GOD, the Master, says: Because the Philistines were so spitefully
vengeful--all those centuries of stored-up malice!--and did their best to
destroy Judah,
- 15 This is what the Sovereign LORD says: 'Because the Philistines acted in
vengeance and took revenge with malice in their hearts, and with ancient
hostility sought to destroy Judah,
- 16 therefore I, GOD, the Master, will oppose the Philistines and cut down
the Cretans and anybody else left along the seacoast.
- 16 therefore this is what the Sovereign LORD says: I am about to stretch
out my hand against the Philistines, and I will cut off the Kerethites and
destroy those remaining along the coast.
- 17 Huge acts of vengeance, massive punishments! When I bring
vengeance, they'll realize that I am GOD."
- 17 I will carry out great vengeance on them and punish them in my wrath.
Then they will know that I am the LORD, when I take vengeance on
them.' "

Ezekiel 26

MSG

NIV

- 1 In the eleventh year, on the first day of the month, God's Message came
to me:
- 1 In the eleventh year, on the first day of the month, the word of the LORD
came to me:
- 2 "Son of man, Tyre cheered when they got the news of Jerusalem,
exclaiming, "'Good! The gateway city is smashed! Now all her business
comes my way. She's in ruins and I'm in clover.'
- 2 Son of man, because Tyre has said of Jerusalem, 'Aha! The gate to the
nations is broken, and its doors have swung open to me; now that she
lies in ruins I will prosper,'
- 3 "Therefore, GOD, the Master, has this to say: "'I'm against you, Tyre, and
I'll bring many nations surging against you, as the waves of the sea
surging against the shore.
- 3 therefore this is what the Sovereign LORD says: I am against you, O
Tyre, and I will bring many nations against you, like the sea casting up

its waves.

- 4 They'll smash the city walls of Tyre and break down her towers. I'll wash away the soil and leave nothing but bare rock.
- 4 They will destroy the walls of Tyre and pull down her towers; I will scrape away her rubble and make her a bare rock.
- 5 She'll be an island of bare rock in the ocean, good for nothing but drying fishnets. Yes, I've said so.' Decree of GOD, the Master. 'She'll be loot, free pickings for the nations!
- 5 Out in the sea she will become a place to spread fishnets, for I have spoken, declares the Sovereign LORD. She will become plunder for the nations,
- 6 Her surrounding villages will be butchered. Then they'll realize that I am GOD.'
- 6 and her settlements on the mainland will be ravaged by the sword. Then they will know that I am the LORD.
- 7 "GOD, the Master, says: Look! Out of the north I'm bringing Nebuchadnezzar king of Babylon, a king's king, down on Tyre. He'll come with chariots and horses and riders--a huge army.
- 7 For this is what the Sovereign LORD says: From the north I am going to bring against Tyre Nebuchadnezzar king of Babylon, king of kings, with horses and chariots, with horsemen and a great army.
- 8 He'll massacre your surrounding villages and lay siege to you. He'll build siege ramps against your walls. A forest of shields will advance against you!
- 8 He will ravage your settlements on the mainland with the sword; he will set up siege works against you, build a ramp up to your walls and raise his shields against you.
- 9 He'll pummel your walls with his battering rams and shatter your towers with his iron weapons.
- 9 He will direct the blows of his battering rams against your walls and demolish your towers with his weapons.
- 10 You'll be covered with dust from his horde of horses--a thundering herd of war horses pouring through the breaches, pulling chariots. Oh, it will be an earthquake of an army and a city in shock!
- 10 His horses will be so many that they will cover you with dust. Your walls will tremble at the noise of the war horses, wagons and chariots

when he enters your gates as men enter a city whose walls have been broken through.

11 Horses will stampede through the streets. Your people will be slaughtered and your huge pillars strewn like matchsticks.

11 The hoofs of his horses will trample all your streets; he will kill your people with the sword, and your strong pillars will fall to the ground.

12 The invaders will steal and loot--all that wealth, all that stuff! They'll knock down your fine houses and dump the stone and timber rubble into the sea.

12 They will plunder your wealth and loot your merchandise; they will break down your walls and demolish your fine houses and throw your stones, timber and rubble into the sea.

13 And your parties, your famous good-time parties, will be no more. No more songs, no more lutes.

13 I will put an end to your noisy songs, and the music of your harps will be heard no more.

14 I'll reduce you to an island of bare rock, good for nothing but drying fishnets. You'll never be rebuilt. I, GOD, have said so. Decree of GOD, the Master.

14 I will make you a bare rock, and you will become a place to spread fishnets. You will never be rebuilt, for I the LORD have spoken, declares the Sovereign LORD.

15 "This is the Message of GOD, the Master, to Tyre: Won't the ocean islands shake at the crash of your collapse, at the groans of your wounded, at your mayhem and massacre?

15 This is what the Sovereign LORD says to Tyre: Will not the coastlands tremble at the sound of your fall, when the wounded groan and the slaughter takes place in you?

16 "All up and down the coast, the princes will come down from their thrones, take off their royal robes and fancy clothes, and wrap themselves in sheer terror. They'll sit on the ground, shaken to the core, horrified at you.

16 Then all the princes of the coast will step down from their thrones and lay aside their robes and take off their embroidered garments. Clothed with terror, they will sit on the ground, trembling every moment, appalled at you.

- 17 Then they'll begin chanting a funeral song over you: "'Sunk! Sunk to the bottom of the sea, famous city on the sea! Power of the seas, you and your people, Intimidating everyone who lived in your shadows.
- 17 Then they will take up a lament concerning you and say to you: " 'How you are destroyed, O city of renown, peopled by men of the sea! You were a power on the seas, you and your citizens; you put your terror on all who lived there.
- 18 But now the islands are shaking at the sound of your crash, Ocean islands in tremors from the impact of your fall.'
- 18 Now the coastlands tremble on the day of your fall; the islands in the sea are terrified at your collapse.'
- 19 "The Message of GOD, the Master: 'When I turn you into a wasted city, a city empty of people, a ghost town, and when I bring up the great ocean deeps and cover you,
- 19 This is what the Sovereign LORD says: When I make you a desolate city, like cities no longer inhabited, and when I bring the ocean depths over you and its vast waters cover you,
- 20 then I'll push you down among those who go to the grave, the long, long dead. I'll make you live there, in the grave in old ruins, with the buried dead. You'll never see the land of the living again.
- 20 then I will bring you down with those who go down to the pit, to the people of long ago. I will make you dwell in the earth below, as in ancient ruins, with those who go down to the pit, and you will not return or take your place in the land of the living.
- 21 I'll introduce you to the terrors of death and that'll be the end of you. They'll send out search parties for you, but you'll never be found. Decree of GOD, the Master."
- 21 I will bring you to a horrible end and you will be no more. You will be sought, but you will never again be found, declares the Sovereign LORD."

Ezekiel 27

MSG

NIV

1 GOD's Message came to me:

- 1 The word of the LORD came to me:
- 2 "You, son of man, raise a funeral song over Tyre.
- 2 Son of man, take up a lament concerning Tyre.
- 3 Tell Tyre, gateway to the sea, merchant to the world, trader among the far-off islands, "This is what GOD, the Master, says: "'You boast, Tyre: "I'm the perfect ship--stately, handsome."
- 3 Say to Tyre, situated at the gateway to the sea, merchant of peoples on many coasts, "This is what the Sovereign LORD says: " 'You say, O Tyre, "I am perfect in beauty."
- 4 You ruled the high seas from a real beauty, crafted to perfection.
- 4 Your domain was on the high seas; your builders brought your beauty to perfection.
- 5 Your planking came from Mount Hermon junipers. A Lebanon cedar supplied your mast.
- 5 They made all your timbers of pine trees from Senir; they took a cedar from Lebanon to make a mast for you.
- 6 They made your oars from sturdy Bashan oaks. Cypress from Cyprus inlaid with ivory was used for the decks.
- 6 Of oaks from Bashan they made your oars; of cypress wood from the coasts of Cyprus they made your deck, inlaid with ivory.
- 7 Your sail and flag were of colorful embroidered linen from Egypt. Your purple deck awnings also came from Cyprus.
- 7 Fine embroidered linen from Egypt was your sail and served as your banner; your awnings were of blue and purple from the coasts of Elishah.
- 8 Men of Sidon and Arvad pulled the oars. Your seasoned seamen, O Tyre, were the crew.
- 8 Men of Sidon and Arvad were your oarsmen; your skilled men, O Tyre, were aboard as your seamen.
- 9 Ship's carpenters were old salts from Byblos. All the ships of the sea and their sailors clustered around you to barter for your goods.
- 9 Veteran craftsmen of Gebal were on board as shipwrights to caulk your seams. All the ships of the sea and their sailors came alongside to trade for your wares.
- 10 "'Your army was composed of soldiers from Paras, Lud, and Put, Elite troops in uniformed splendor. They put you on the map!

- 10 'Men of Persia, Lydia and Put served as soldiers in your army. They hung their shields and helmets on your walls, bringing you splendor.
- 11 Your city police were imported from Arvad, Helech, and Gammad. They hung their shields from the city walls, a final, perfect touch to your beauty.
- 11 Men of Arvad and Helech manned your walls on every side; men of Gammad were in your towers. They hung their shields around your walls; they brought your beauty to perfection.
- 12 "'Tarshish carried on business with you because of your great wealth. They worked for you, trading in silver, iron, tin, and lead for your products.
- 12 'Tarshish did business with you because of your great wealth of goods; they exchanged silver, iron, tin and lead for your merchandise.
- 13 "'Greece, Tubal, and Meshech did business with you, trading slaves and bronze for your products.
- 13 'Greece, Tubal and Meshech traded with you; they exchanged slaves and articles of bronze for your wares.
- 14 "'Beth-togarmah traded work horses, war horses, and mules for your products.
- 14 'Men of Beth Togarmah exchanged work horses, war horses and mules for your merchandise.
- 15 "'The people of Rhodes did business with you. Many far-off islands traded with you in ivory and ebony.
- 15 'The men of Rhodes traded with you, and many coastlands were your customers; they paid you with ivory tusks and ebony.
- 16 "'Edom did business with you because of all your goods. They traded for your products with agate, purple textiles, embroidered cloth, fine linen, coral, and rubies.
- 16 'Aram did business with you because of your many products; they exchanged turquoise, purple fabric, embroidered work, fine linen, coral and rubies for your merchandise.
- 17 "'Judah and Israel did business with you. They traded for your products with premium wheat, millet, honey, oil, and balm.
- 17 'Judah and Israel traded with you; they exchanged wheat from Minnith and confections, honey, oil and balm for your wares.

- 18 ""Damascus, attracted by your vast array of products and well-stocked warehouses, carried on business with you, trading in wine from Helbon and wool from Zahar.
- 18 'Damascus, because of your many products and great wealth of goods, did business with you in wine from Helbon and wool from Zahar.
- 19 ""Danites and Greeks from Uzal traded with you, using wrought iron, cinnamon, and spices.
- 19 'Danites and Greeks from Uzal bought your merchandise; they exchanged wrought iron, cassia and calamus for your wares.
- 20 ""Dedan traded with you for saddle blankets.
- 20 'Dedan traded in saddle blankets with you.
- 21 ""Arabia and all the Bedouin sheiks of Kedar traded lambs, rams, and goats with you.
- 21 'Arabia and all the princes of Kedar were your customers; they did business with you in lambs, rams and goats.
- 22 ""Traders from Sheba and Raamah in South Arabia carried on business with you in premium spices, precious stones, and gold.
- 22 'The merchants of Sheba and Raamah traded with you; for your merchandise they exchanged the finest of all kinds of spices and precious stones, and gold.
- 23 ""Haran, Canneh, and Eden from the east in Assyria and Media traded with you,
- 23 'Haran, Canneh and Eden and merchants of Sheba, Asshur and Kilmad traded with you.
- 24 bringing elegant clothes, dyed textiles, and elaborate carpets to your bazaars.
- 24 In your marketplace they traded with you beautiful garments, blue fabric, embroidered work and multicolored rugs with cords twisted and tightly knotted.
- 25 ""The great Tarshish ships were your freighters, importing and exporting. Oh, it was big business for you, trafficking the seaways!
- 25 'The ships of Tarshish serve as carriers for your wares. You are filled with heavy cargo in the heart of the sea.
- 26 ""Your sailors row mightily, taking you into the high seas. Then a storm out of the east shatters your ship in the ocean deep.

- 26 Your oarsmen take you out to the high seas. But the east wind will break you to pieces in the heart of the sea.
- 27 Everything sinks--your rich goods and products, sailors and crew, ship's carpenters and soldiers, Sink to the bottom of the sea. Total shipwreck.
- 27 Your wealth, merchandise and wares, your mariners, seamen and shipwrights, your merchants and all your soldiers, and everyone else on board will sink into the heart of the sea on the day of your shipwreck.
- 28 The cries of your sailors reverberate on shore.
- 28 The shorelands will quake when your seamen cry out.
- 29 Sailors everywhere abandon ship. Veteran seamen swim for dry land.
- 29 All who handle the oars will abandon their ships; the mariners and all the seamen will stand on the shore.
- 30 They cry out in grief, a choir of bitter lament over you. They smear their faces with ashes,
- 30 They will raise their voice and cry bitterly over you; they will sprinkle dust on their heads and roll in ashes.
- 31 shave their heads, Wear rough burlap, wildly keening their loss.
- 31 They will shave their heads because of you and will put on sackcloth. They will weep over you with anguish of soul and with bitter mourning.
- 32 They raise their funeral song: "Who on the high seas is like Tyre!"
- 32 As they wail and mourn over you, they will take up a lament concerning you: "Who was ever silenced like Tyre, surrounded by the sea?"
- 33 "As you crisscrossed the seas with your products, you satisfied many peoples. Your worldwide trade made earth's kings rich.
- 33 When your merchandise went out on the seas, you satisfied many nations; with your great wealth and your wares you enriched the kings of the earth.
- 34 And now you're battered to bits by the waves, sunk to the bottom of the sea, And everything you've bought and sold has sunk to the bottom with you.
- 34 Now you are shattered by the sea in the depths of the waters; your wares and all your company have gone down with you.
- 35 Everyone on shore looks on in terror. The hair of kings stands on end, their faces drawn and haggard!
- 35 All who live in the coastlands are appalled at you; their kings shudder with horror and their faces are distorted with fear.

36 The buyers and sellers of the world throw up their hands: This horror can't happen! Oh, this has happened!"

36 The merchants among the nations hiss at you; you have come to a horrible end and will be no more.' "

Ezekiel 28

MSG

NIV

- 1 GOD's Message came to me,
- 1 The word of the LORD came to me:
- 2 "Son of man, tell the prince of Tyre, 'This is what GOD, the Master, says: "'Your heart is proud, going around saying, "I'm a god. I sit on God's divine throne, ruling the sea"-- You, a mere mortal, not even close to being a god, A mere mortal trying to be a god.
- 2 Son of man, say to the ruler of Tyre, 'This is what the Sovereign LORD says: 'In the pride of your heart you say, "I am a god; I sit on the throne of a god in the heart of the seas." But you are a man and not a god, though you think you are as wise as a god.
- 3 Look, you think you're smarter than Daniel. No enigmas can stump you.
- 3 Are you wiser than Daniel? Is no secret hidden from you?
- 4 Your sharp intelligence made you world-wealthy. You piled up gold and silver in your banks.
- 4 By your wisdom and understanding you have gained wealth for yourself and amassed gold and silver in your treasuries.
- 5 You used your head well, worked good deals, made a lot of money. But the money has gone to your head, swelled your head--what a big head!
- 5 By your great skill in trading you have increased your wealth, and because of your wealth your heart has grown proud.
- 6 "'Therefore, GOD, the Master, says: "'Because you're acting like a god, pretending to be a god,
- 6 'Therefore this is what the Sovereign LORD says: 'Because you think you are wise, as wise as a god,
- 7 I'm giving fair warning: I'm bringing strangers down on you, the most vicious of all nations. They'll pull their swords and make hash of your

reputation for knowing it all. They'll puncture the balloon of your god-pretensions.

- 7 I am going to bring foreigners against you, the most ruthless of nations; they will draw their swords against your beauty and wisdom and pierce your shining splendor.
- 8 They'll bring you down from your self-made pedestal and bury you in the deep blue sea.
- 8 They will bring you down to the pit, and you will die a violent death in the heart of the seas.
- 9 Will you protest to your assassins, "You can't do that! I'm a god"? To them you're a mere mortal. They're killing a man, not a god.
- 9 Will you then say, "I am a god," in the presence of those who kill you? You will be but a man, not a god, in the hands of those who slay you.
- 10 You'll die like a stray dog, killed by strangers--
- 10 You will die the death of the uncircumcised at the hands of foreigners. I have spoken, declares the Sovereign LORD.' "
- 11 Because I said so. Decree of GOD, the Master.'" GOD's Message came to me:
- 11 The word of the LORD came to me:
- 12 "Son of man, raise a funeral song over the king of Tyre. Tell him, A Message from GOD, the Master: "You had everything going for you.
- 12 Son of man, take up a lament concerning the king of Tyre and say to him: 'This is what the Sovereign LORD says: 'You were the model of perfection, full of wisdom and perfect in beauty.
- 13 You were in Eden, God's garden. You were dressed in splendor, your robe studded with jewels: Carnelian, peridot, and moonstone, beryl, onyx, and jasper, Sapphire, turquoise, and emerald, all in settings of engraved gold. A robe was prepared for you the same day you were created.
- 13 You were in Eden, the garden of God; every precious stone adorned you: ruby, topaz and emerald, chrysolite, onyx and jasper, sapphire, turquoise and beryl. Your settings and mountings were made of gold; on the day you were created they were prepared.
- 14 You were the anointed cherub. I placed you on the mountain of God. You strolled in magnificence among the stones of fire.

- 14 You were anointed as a guardian cherub, for so I ordained you. You were on the holy mount of God; you walked among the fiery stones.
- 15 From the day of your creation you were sheer perfection . . . and then imperfection--evil!--was detected in you.
- 15 You were blameless in your ways from the day you were created till wickedness was found in you.
- 16 In much buying and selling you turned violent, you sinned! I threw you, disgraced, off the mountain of God. I threw you out--you, the anointed angel-cherub. No more strolling among the gems of fire for you!
- 16 Through your widespread trade you were filled with violence, and you sinned. So I drove you in disgrace from the mount of God, and I expelled you, O guardian cherub, from among the fiery stones.
- 17 Your beauty went to your head. You corrupted wisdom by using it to get worldly fame. I threw you to the ground, sent you sprawling before an audience of kings and let them gloat over your demise.
- 17 Your heart became proud on account of your beauty, and you corrupted your wisdom because of your splendor. So I threw you to the earth; I made a spectacle of you before kings.
- 18 By sin after sin after sin, by your corrupt ways of doing business, you defiled your holy places of worship. So I set a fire around and within you. It burned you up. I reduced you to ashes. All anyone sees now when they look for you is ashes, a pitiful mound of ashes.
- 18 By your many sins and dishonest trade you have desecrated your sanctuaries. So I made a fire come out from you, and it consumed you, and I reduced you to ashes on the ground in the sight of all who were watching.
- 19 All who once knew you now throw up their hands: 'This can't have happened! This has happened!'
- 19 All the nations who knew you are appalled at you; you have come to a horrible end and will be no more.' "
- 20 GOD's Message came to me
- 20 The word of the LORD came to me:
- 21 : "Son of man, confront Sidon. Preach against it.
- 21 Son of man, set your face against Sidon; prophesy against her
- 22 Say, 'Message from GOD, the Master: "'Look! I'm against you, Sidon. I intend to be known for who I truly am among you.' They'll know that I

- am GOD when I set things right and reveal my holy presence.
- 22 and say: 'This is what the Sovereign LORD says: " 'I am against you, O Sidon, and I will gain glory within you. They will know that I am the LORD, when I inflict punishment on her and show myself holy within her.
- 23 I'll order an epidemic of disease there, along with murder and mayhem in the streets. People will drop dead right and left, as war presses in from every side. Then they'll realize that I mean business, that I am GOD.
- 23 I will send a plague upon her and make blood flow in her streets. The slain will fall within her, with the sword against her on every side. Then they will know that I am the LORD.
- 24 "No longer will Israel have to put up with their thistle-and-thorn neighbors Who have treated them so contemptuously. And they also will realize that I am GOD."
- 24 'No longer will the people of Israel have malicious neighbors who are painful briars and sharp thorns. Then they will know that I am the Sovereign LORD.
- 25 GOD, the Master, says, "When I gather Israel from the peoples among whom they've been scattered and put my holiness on display among them with all the nations looking on, then they'll live in their own land that I gave to my servant Jacob.
- 25 'This is what the Sovereign LORD says: When I gather the people of Israel from the nations where they have been scattered, I will show myself holy among them in the sight of the nations. Then they will live in their own land, which I gave to my servant Jacob.
- 26 They'll live there in safety. They'll build houses. They'll plant vineyards, living in safety. Meanwhile, I'll bring judgment on all the neighbors who have treated them with such contempt. And they'll realize that I am GOD."
- 26 They will live there in safety and will build houses and plant vineyards; they will live in safety when I inflict punishment on all their neighbors who maligned them. Then they will know that I am the LORD their God.' "

Ezekiel 29

MSG

NIV

- 1 In the tenth year, in the tenth month, on the twelfth day, GOD's Message came to me:
- 1 In the tenth year, in the tenth month on the twelfth day, the word of the LORD came to me:
- 2 "Son of man, confront Pharaoh king of Egypt. Preach against him and all the Egyptians.
- 2 Son of man, set your face against Pharaoh king of Egypt and prophesy against him and against all Egypt.
- 3 Tell him, 'GOD, the Master, says: "'Watch yourself, Pharaoh, king of Egypt. I'm dead set against you, You lumbering old dragon, lolling and flaccid in the Nile, Saying, "It's my Nile. I made it. It's mine."
- 3 Speak to him and say: 'This is what the Sovereign LORD says: " 'I am against you, Pharaoh king of Egypt, you great monster lying among your streams. You say, "The Nile is mine; I made it for myself."
- 4 I'll set hooks in your jaw; I'll make the fish of the Nile stick to your scales. I'll pull you out of the Nile, with all the fish stuck to your scales.
- 4 But I will put hooks in your jaws and make the fish of your streams stick to your scales. I will pull you out from among your streams, with all the fish sticking to your scales.
- 5 Then I'll drag you out into the desert, you and all the Nile fish sticking to your scales. You'll lie there in the open, rotting in the sun, meat to the wild animals and carrion birds.
- 5 I will leave you in the desert, you and all the fish of your streams. You will fall on the open field and not be gathered or picked up. I will give you as food to the beasts of the earth and the birds of the air.
- 6 Everybody living in Egypt will realize that I am GOD. "'Because you've been a flimsy reed crutch to Israel
- 6 Then all who live in Egypt will know that I am the LORD. " 'You have been a staff of reed for the house of Israel.
- 7 so that when they gripped you, you splintered and cut their hand, and when they leaned on you, you broke and sent them sprawling--
- 7 When they grasped you with their hands, you splintered and you tore open their shoulders; when they leaned on you, you broke and their backs were wrenched.

- 8 Message of GOD, the Master--I'll bring war against you, do away with people and animals alike,
- 8 'Therefore this is what the Sovereign LORD says: I will bring a sword against you and kill your men and their animals.
- 9 and turn the country into an empty desert so they'll realize that I am GOD. "'Because you said, "It's my Nile. I made it. It's all mine,"
- 9 Egypt will become a desolate wasteland. Then they will know that I am the LORD. " 'Because you said, "The Nile is mine; I made it,"
- 10 therefore I am against you and your rivers. I'll reduce Egypt to an empty, desolate wasteland all the way from Migdol in the north to Syene and the border of Ethiopia in the south.
- 10 therefore I am against you and against your streams, and I will make the land of Egypt a ruin and a desolate waste from Migdol to Aswan, as far as the border of Cush.
- 11 Not a human will be seen in it, nor will an animal move through it. It'll be just empty desert, empty for forty years.
- 11 No foot of man or animal will pass through it; no one will live there for forty years.
- 12 "'I'll make Egypt the most desolate of all desolations. For forty years I'll make her cities the most wasted of all wasted cities. I'll scatter Egyptians to the four winds, send them off every which way into exile.
- 12 I will make the land of Egypt desolate among devastated lands, and her cities will lie desolate forty years among ruined cities. And I will disperse the Egyptians among the nations and scatter them through the countries.
- 13 "'But,' says GOD, the Master, 'that's not the end of it. After the forty years, I'll gather up the Egyptians from all the places where they've been scattered.
- 13 'Yet this is what the Sovereign LORD says: At the end of forty years I will gather the Egyptians from the nations where they were scattered.
- 14 I'll put things back together again for Egypt. I'll bring her back to Pathros where she got her start long ago. There she'll start over again from scratch.
- 14 I will bring them back from captivity and return them to Upper Egypt, the land of their ancestry. There they will be a lowly kingdom.

- 15 She'll take her place at the bottom of the ladder and there she'll stay, never to climb that ladder again, never to be a world power again.
- 15 It will be the lowliest of kingdoms and will never again exalt itself above the other nations. I will make it so weak that it will never again rule over the nations.
- 16 Never again will Israel be tempted to rely on Egypt. All she'll be to Israel is a reminder of old sin. Then Egypt will realize that I am GOD, the Master."
- 16 Egypt will no longer be a source of confidence for the people of Israel but will be a reminder of their sin in turning to her for help. Then they will know that I am the Sovereign LORD.' "
- 17 In the twenty-seventh year, in the first month, on the first day of the month, GOD's Message came to me:
- 17 In the twenty-seventh year, in the first month on the first day, the word of the LORD came to me:
- 18 "Son of man, Nebuchadnezzar, king of Babylon, has worn out his army against Tyre. They've worked their fingers to the bone and have nothing to show for it.
- 18 Son of man, Nebuchadnezzar king of Babylon drove his army in a hard campaign against Tyre; every head was rubbed bare and every shoulder made raw. Yet he and his army got no reward from the campaign he led against Tyre.
- 19 "Therefore, GOD, the Master, says, 'I'm giving Egypt to Nebuchadnezzar king of Babylon. He'll haul away its wealth, pick the place clean. He'll pay his army with Egyptian plunder.
- 19 Therefore this is what the Sovereign LORD says: I am going to give Egypt to Nebuchadnezzar king of Babylon, and he will carry off its wealth. He will loot and plunder the land as pay for his army.
- 20 He's been working for me all these years without pay. This is his pay: Egypt. Decree of GOD, the Master.
- 20 I have given him Egypt as a reward for his efforts because he and his army did it for me, declares the Sovereign LORD.
- 21 "'And then I'll stir up fresh hope in Israel--the dawn of deliverance!--and I'll give you, Ezekiel, bold and confident words to speak. And they'll realize that I am GOD.'"

- 21 On that day I will make a horn grow for the house of Israel, and I will open your mouth among them. Then they will know that I am the LORD.

Ezekiel 30

MSG

NIV

- 1 GOD, the Master, spoke to me:
- 1 The word of the LORD came to me:
- 2 "Son of man, preach. Give them the Message of GOD, the Master. Wail:
- 2 Son of man, prophesy and say: 'This is what the Sovereign LORD says: 'Wail and say, "Alas for that day!"
- 3 "'Doomsday!' Time's up! GOD's big day of judgment is near. Thick clouds are rolling in. It's doomsday for the nations.
- 3 For the day is near, the day of the LORD is near-- a day of clouds, a time of doom for the nations.
- 4 Death will rain down on Egypt. Terror will paralyze Ethiopia When they see the Egyptians killed, their wealth hauled off, their foundations demolished,
- 4 A sword will come against Egypt, and anguish will come upon Cush. When the slain fall in Egypt, her wealth will be carried away and her foundations torn down.
- 5 And Ethiopia, Put, Lud, Arabia, Libya --all of Egypt's old allies-- killed right along with them.
- 5 Cush and Put, Lydia and all Arabia, Libya and the people of the covenant land will fall by the sword along with Egypt.
- 6 "'GOD says: "'Egypt's allies will fall and her proud strength will collapse-- From Migdol in the north to Syene in the south, a great slaughter in Egypt! Decree of GOD, the Master.
- 6 'This is what the LORD says: 'The allies of Egypt will fall and her proud strength will fail. From Migdol to Aswan they will fall by the sword within her, declares the Sovereign LORD.
- 7 Egypt, most desolate of the desolate, her cities wasted beyond wasting,
- 7 'They will be desolate among desolate lands, and their cities will lie among ruined cities.

- 8 Will realize that I am GOD when I burn her down and her helpers are knocked flat.
- 8 Then they will know that I am the LORD, when I set fire to Egypt and all her helpers are crushed.
- 9 "'When that happens, I'll send out messengers by ship to sound the alarm among the easygoing Ethiopians. They'll be terrorized. Egypt's doomed! Judgment's coming!
- 9 'On that day messengers will go out from me in ships to frighten Cush out of her complacency. Anguish will take hold of them on the day of Egypt's doom, for it is sure to come.
- 10 "'GOD, the Master, says: "'I'll put a stop to Egypt's arrogance. I'll use Nebuchadnezzar king of Babylon to do it.
- 10 'This is what the Sovereign LORD says: 'I will put an end to the hordes of Egypt by the hand of Nebuchadnezzar king of Babylon.
- 11 He and his army, the most brutal of nations, shall be used to destroy the country. They'll brandish their swords and fill Egypt with corpses.
- 11 He and his army--the most ruthless of nations-- will be brought in to destroy the land. They will draw their swords against Egypt and fill the land with the slain.
- 12 I'll dry up the Nile and sell off the land to a bunch of crooks. I'll hire outsiders to come in and waste the country, strip it clean. I, GOD, have said so.
- 12 I will dry up the streams of the Nile and sell the land to evil men; by the hand of foreigners I will lay waste the land and everything in it. I the LORD have spoken.
- 13 "'And now this is what GOD, the Master, says: "'I'll smash all the no-god idols; I'll topple all those huge statues in Memphis. The prince of Egypt will be gone for good, and in his place I'll put fear--fear throughout Egypt!
- 13 'This is what the Sovereign LORD says: 'I will destroy the idols and put an end to the images in Memphis. No longer will there be a prince in Egypt, and I will spread fear throughout the land.
- 14 I'll demolish Pathros, burn Zoan to the ground, and punish Thebes,
- 14 I will lay waste Upper Egypt, set fire to Zoan and inflict punishment on Thebes.

- 15 Pour my wrath on Pelusium, Egypt's fort, and knock Thebes off its proud pedestal.
- 15 I will pour out my wrath on Pelusium, the stronghold of Egypt, and cut off the hordes of Thebes.
- 16 I'll set Egypt on fire: Pelusium will writhe in pain, Thebes blown away, Memphis raped.
- 16 I will set fire to Egypt; Pelusium will writhe in agony. Thebes will be taken by storm; Memphis will be in constant distress.
- 17 The young warriors of On and Pi-beseth will be killed and the cities exiled.
- 17 The young men of Heliopolis and Bubastis will fall by the sword, and the cities themselves will go into captivity.
- 18 A dark day for Tahpanhes when I shatter Egypt, When I break Egyptian power and put an end to her arrogant oppression! She'll disappear in a cloud of dust, her cities hauled off as exiles.
- 18 Dark will be the day at Tahpanhes when I break the yoke of Egypt; there her proud strength will come to an end. She will be covered with clouds, and her villages will go into captivity.
- 19 That's how I'll punish Egypt, and that's how she'll realize that I am GOD."
- 19 So I will inflict punishment on Egypt, and they will know that I am the LORD.' "
- 20 In the eleventh year, on the seventh day of the first month, GOD's Message came to me:
- 20 In the eleventh year, in the first month on the seventh day, the word of the LORD came to me:
- 21 "Son of man, I've broken the arm of Pharaoh king of Egypt. And look! It hasn't been set. No splint has been put on it so the bones can knit and heal, so he can use a sword again.
- 21 Son of man, I have broken the arm of Pharaoh king of Egypt. It has not been bound up for healing or put in a splint so as to become strong enough to hold a sword.
- 22 "Therefore, GOD, the Master, says, I am dead set against Pharaoh king of Egypt and will go ahead and break his other arm--both arms broken! There's no way he'll ever swing a sword again.

- 22 Therefore this is what the Sovereign LORD says: I am against Pharaoh king of Egypt. I will break both his arms, the good arm as well as the broken one, and make the sword fall from his hand.
- 23 I'll scatter Egyptians all over the world.
- 23 I will disperse the Egyptians among the nations and scatter them through the countries.
- 24 I'll make the arms of the king of Babylon strong and put my sword in his hand, but I'll break the arms of Pharaoh and he'll groan like one who is mortally wounded.
- 24 I will strengthen the arms of the king of Babylon and put my sword in his hand, but I will break the arms of Pharaoh, and he will groan before him like a mortally wounded man.
- 25 I'll make the arms of the king of Babylon strong, but the arms of Pharaoh shall go limp. The Egyptians will realize that I am GOD when I place my sword in the hand of the king of Babylon. He'll wield it against Egypt
- 25 I will strengthen the arms of the king of Babylon, but the arms of Pharaoh will fall limp. Then they will know that I am the LORD, when I put my sword into the hand of the king of Babylon and he brandishes it against Egypt.
- 26 and I'll scatter Egyptians all over the world. Then they'll realize that I am GOD."
- 26 I will disperse the Egyptians among the nations and scatter them through the countries. Then they will know that I am the LORD."

Ezekiel 31

MSG

NIV

- 1 In the eleventh year, on the first day of the third month, GOD's Message came to me:
- 1 In the eleventh year, in the third month on the first day, the word of the LORD came to me:
- 2 "Son of man, tell Pharaoh king of Egypt, that pompous old goat: "'Who do you, astride the world, think you really are?"

- 2 Son of man, say to Pharaoh king of Egypt and to his hordes: 'Who can be compared with you in majesty?
- 3 Look! Assyria was a Big Tree, huge as a Lebanon cedar, beautiful limbs offering cool shade, Skyscraper high, piercing the clouds.
- 3 Consider Assyria, once a cedar in Lebanon, with beautiful branches overshadowing the forest; it towered on high, its top above the thick foliage.
- 4 The waters gave it drink, the primordial deep lifted it high, Gushing out rivers around the place where it was planted, And then branching out in streams to all the trees in the forest.
- 4 The waters nourished it, deep springs made it grow tall; their streams flowed all around its base and sent their channels to all the trees of the field.
- 5 It was immense, dwarfing all the trees in the forest-- Thick boughs, long limbs, roots delving deep into earth's waters.
- 5 So it towered higher than all the trees of the field; its boughs increased and its branches grew long, spreading because of abundant waters.
- 6 All the birds of the air nested in its boughs. All the wild animals gave birth under its branches. All the mighty nations lived in its shade.
- 6 All the birds of the air nested in its boughs, all the beasts of the field gave birth under its branches; all the great nations lived in its shade.
- 7 It was stunning in its majesty-- the reach of its branches! the depth of its water-seeking roots!
- 7 It was majestic in beauty, with its spreading boughs, for its roots went down to abundant waters.
- 8 Not a cedar in God's garden came close to it. No pine tree was anything like it. Mighty oaks looked like bushes growing alongside it. Not a tree in God's garden was in the same class of beauty.
- 8 The cedars in the garden of God could not rival it, nor could the pine trees equal its boughs, nor could the plane trees compare with its branches-- no tree in the garden of God could match its beauty.
- 9 I made it beautiful, a work of art in limbs and leaves, The envy of every tree in Eden, every last tree in God's garden."
- 9 I made it beautiful with abundant branches, the envy of all the trees of Eden in the garden of God.

- 10 Therefore, GOD, the Master, says, "Because it skyscrapered upwards, piercing the clouds, swaggering and proud of its stature,
- 10 'Therefore this is what the Sovereign LORD says: Because it towered on high, lifting its top above the thick foliage, and because it was proud of its height,
- 11 I turned it over to a world-famous leader to call its evil to account. I'd had enough.
- 11 I handed it over to the ruler of the nations, for him to deal with according to its wickedness. I cast it aside,
- 12 Outsiders, unbelievably brutal, felled it across the mountain ranges. Its branches were strewn through all the valleys, its leafy boughs clogging all the streams and rivers. Because its shade was gone, everybody walked off. No longer a tree--just a log.
- 12 and the most ruthless of foreign nations cut it down and left it. Its boughs fell on the mountains and in all the valleys; its branches lay broken in all the ravines of the land. All the nations of the earth came out from under its shade and left it.
- 13 On that dead log birds perch. Wild animals burrow under it.
- 13 All the birds of the air settled on the fallen tree, and all the beasts of the field were among its branches.
- 14 "'That marks the end of the "big tree" nations. No more trees nourished from the great deep, no more cloud-piercing trees, no more earth-born trees taking over. They're all slated for death--back to earth, right along with men and women, for whom it's "dust to dust."
- 14 Therefore no other trees by the waters are ever to tower proudly on high, lifting their tops above the thick foliage. No other trees so well-watered are ever to reach such a height; they are all destined for death, for the earth below, among mortal men, with those who go down to the pit.
- 15 "'The Message of GOD, the Master: On the day of the funeral of the Big Tree, I threw the great deep into mourning. I stopped the flow of its rivers, held back great seas, and wrapped the Lebanon mountains in black. All the trees of the forest fainted and fell.
- 15 'This is what the Sovereign LORD says: On the day it was brought down to the grave I covered the deep springs with mourning for it; I held

- back its streams, and its abundant waters were restrained. Because of it I clothed Lebanon with gloom, and all the trees of the field withered away.
- 16 I made the whole world quake when it crashed, and threw it into the underworld to take its place with all else that gets buried. All the trees of Eden and the finest and best trees of Lebanon, well-watered, were relieved--
- 16 I made the nations tremble at the sound of its fall when I brought it down to the grave with those who go down to the pit. Then all the trees of Eden, the choicest and best of Lebanon, all the trees that were well-watered, were consoled in the earth below.
- 17 they had descended to the underworld with it--along with everyone who had lived in its shade and all who had been killed.
- 17 Those who lived in its shade, its allies among the nations, had also gone down to the grave with it, joining those killed by the sword.
- 18 "'Which of the trees of Eden came anywhere close to you in splendor and size? But you're slated to be cut down to take your place in the underworld with the trees of Eden, to be a dead log stacked with all the other dead logs, among the other uncircumcised who are dead and buried. "'This means Pharaoh, the pompous old goat. "'Decree of GOD, the Master."
- 18 'Which of the trees of Eden can be compared with you in splendor and majesty? Yet you, too, will be brought down with the trees of Eden to the earth below; you will lie among the uncircumcised, with those killed by the sword. 'This is Pharaoh and all his hordes, declares the Sovereign LORD.' "

Ezekiel 32

MSG

NIV

- 1 In the twelfth year, on the first day of the twelfth month, GOD's Message came to me:
- 1 In the twelfth year, in the twelfth month on the first day, the word of the LORD came to me:
- 2 "Son of man, sing a funeral lament over Pharaoh king of Egypt. Tell him:
"'You think you're a young lion prowling through the nations. You're

- more like a dragon in the ocean, snorting and thrashing about.
- 2 Son of man, take up a lament concerning Pharaoh king of Egypt and say to him: 'You are like a lion among the nations; you are like a monster in the seas thrashing about in your streams, churning the water with your feet and muddying the streams.
- 3 "'GOD, the Master, says: "'I'm going to throw my net over you --many nations will get in on this operation-- and haul you out with my dragnet.
- 3 'This is what the Sovereign LORD says: 'With a great throng of people I will cast my net over you, and they will haul you up in my net.
- 4 I'll dump you on the ground out in an open field And bring in all the crows and vultures for a sumptuous carrion lunch. I'll invite wild animals from all over the world to gorge on your guts.
- 4 I will throw you on the land and hurl you on the open field. I will let all the birds of the air settle on you and all the beasts of the earth gorge themselves on you.
- 5 I'll scatter hunks of your meat in the mountains and strew your bones in the valleys.
- 5 I will spread your flesh on the mountains and fill the valleys with your remains.
- 6 The country, right up to the mountains, will be drenched with your blood, your blood filling every ditch and channel.
- 6 I will drench the land with your flowing blood all the way to the mountains, and the ravines will be filled with your flesh.
- 7 When I blot you out, I'll pull the curtain on the skies and shut out the stars. I'll throw a cloud across the sun and turn off the moonlight.
- 7 When I snuff you out, I will cover the heavens and darken their stars; I will cover the sun with a cloud, and the moon will not give its light.
- 8 I'll turn out every light in the sky above you and put your land in the dark. Decree of GOD, the Master.
- 8 All the shining lights in the heavens I will darken over you; I will bring darkness over your land, declares the Sovereign LORD.
- 9 I'll shake up everyone worldwide when I take you off captive to strange and far-off countries.
- 9 I will trouble the hearts of many peoples when I bring about your destruction among the nations, among lands you have not known.

- 10 I'll shock people with you. Kings will take one look and shudder. I'll shake my sword and they'll shake in their boots. On the day you crash, they'll tremble, thinking, "That could be me!"
- 10 I will cause many peoples to be appalled at you, and their kings will shudder with horror because of you when I brandish my sword before them. On the day of your downfall each of them will tremble every moment for his life.
- 11 "GOD, the Master, says: "The sword of the king of Babylon is coming against you.
- 11 'For this is what the Sovereign LORD says: 'The sword of the king of Babylon will come against you.
- 12 I'll use the swords of champions to lay your pride low, Use the most brutal of nations to knock Egypt off her high horse, to puncture that hot-air pomposity.
- 12 I will cause your hordes to fall by the swords of mighty men-- the most ruthless of all nations. They will shatter the pride of Egypt, and all her hordes will be overthrown.
- 13 I'll destroy all their livestock that graze along the river. Neither human foot nor animal hoof will muddy those waters anymore.
- 13 I will destroy all her cattle from beside abundant waters no longer to be stirred by the foot of man or muddied by the hoofs of cattle.
- 14 I'll clear their springs and streams, make their rivers flow clean and smooth. Decree of GOD, the Master.
- 14 Then I will let her waters settle and make her streams flow like oil, declares the Sovereign LORD.
- 15 When I turn Egypt back to the wild and strip her clean of all her abundant produce, When I strike dead all who live there, then they'll realize that I am GOD.'
- 15 When I make Egypt desolate and strip the land of everything in it, when I strike down all who live there, then they will know that I am the LORD.'
- 16 "This is a funeral song. Chant it. Daughters of the nations, chant it. Chant it over Egypt for the death of its pomp." Decree of GOD, the Master.
- 16 This is the lament they will chant for her. The daughters of the nations will chant it; for Egypt and all her hordes they will chant it, declares the

Sovereign LORD.

- 17 In the twelfth year, on the fifteenth day of the first month, GOD's Message came to me:
- 17 In the twelfth year, on the fifteenth day of the month, the word of the LORD came to me:
- 18 "Son of man, lament over Egypt's pompous ways. Send her on her way. Dispatch Egypt and her proud daughter nations To the underworld, down to the country of the dead and buried.
- 18 Son of man, wail for the hordes of Egypt and consign to the earth below both her and the daughters of mighty nations, with those who go down to the pit.
- 19 Say, 'You think you're so high and mighty? Down! Take your place with the heathen in that unhallowed grave!'
- 19 Say to them, 'Are you more favored than others? Go down and be laid among the uncircumcised.'
- 20 "She'll be dumped in with those killed in battle. The sword is bared. Drag her off in all her proud pomp!
- 20 They will fall among those killed by the sword. The sword is drawn; let her be dragged off with all her hordes.
- 21 All the big men and their helpers down among the dead and buried will greet them: 'Welcome to the grave of the heathen! Join the ranks of the victims of war!'
- 21 From within the grave the mighty leaders will say of Egypt and her allies, 'They have come down and they lie with the uncircumcised, with those killed by the sword.'
- 22 "Assyria is there and its congregation, the whole nation a cemetery.
- 22 Assyria is there with her whole army; she is surrounded by the graves of all her slain, all who have fallen by the sword.
- 23 Their graves are in the deepest part of the underworld, a congregation of graves, all killed in battle, these people who terrorized the land of the living.
- 23 Their graves are in the depths of the pit and her army lies around her grave. All who had spread terror in the land of the living are slain, fallen by the sword.
- 24 "Elam is there in all her pride, a cemetery--all killed in battle, dumped in her heathen grave with the dead and buried, these people who

- terrorized the land of the living. They carry their shame with them, along with the others in the grave.
- 24 Elam is there, with all her hordes around her grave. All of them are slain, fallen by the sword. All who had spread terror in the land of the living went down uncircumcised to the earth below. They bear their shame with those who go down to the pit.
- 25 They turned Elam into a resort for the pompous dead, landscaped with heathen graves, slaughtered in battle. They once terrorized the land of the living. Now they carry their shame down with the others in deep earth. They're in the section set aside for the slain in battle.
- 25 A bed is made for her among the slain, with all her hordes around her grave. All of them are uncircumcised, killed by the sword. Because their terror had spread in the land of the living, they bear their shame with those who go down to the pit; they are laid among the slain.
- 26 "Meshech-tubal is there in all her pride, a cemetery in uncircumcised ground, dumped in with those slaughtered in battle--just deserts for terrorizing the land of the living. Now they carry their shame down with the others in deep earth. They're in the section set aside for the slain.
- 26 Meshech and Tubal are there, with all their hordes around their graves. All of them are uncircumcised, killed by the sword because they spread their terror in the land of the living.
- 27 They're segregated from the heroes, the old-time giants who entered the grave in full battle dress, their swords placed under their heads and their shields covering their bones, those heroes who spread terror through the land of the living.
- 27 Do they not lie with the other uncircumcised warriors who have fallen, who went down to the grave with their weapons of war, whose swords were placed under their heads? The punishment for their sins rested on their bones, though the terror of these warriors had stalked through the land of the living.
- 28 "And you, Egypt, will be dumped in a heathen grave, along with all the rest, in the section set aside for the slain.
- 28 You too, O Pharaoh, will be broken and will lie among the uncircumcised, with those killed by the sword.
- 29 "Edom is there, with her kings and princes. In spite of her vaunted greatness, she is dumped in a heathen grave with the others headed for

- the grave.
- 29 Edom is there, her kings and all her princes; despite their power, they are laid with those killed by the sword. They lie with the uncircumcised, with those who go down to the pit.
- 30 "The princes of the north are there, the whole lot of them, and all the Sidonians who carry their shame to their graves--all that terror they spread with their brute power!--dumped in unhallowed ground with those killed in battle, carrying their shame with the others headed for deep earth.
- 30 All the princes of the north and all the Sidonians are there; they went down with the slain in disgrace despite the terror caused by their power. They lie uncircumcised with those killed by the sword and bear their shame with those who go down to the pit.
- 31 "Pharaoh will see them all and, pompous old goat that he is, take comfort in the company he'll keep--Pharaoh and his slaughtered army. Decree of GOD, the Master.
- 31 Pharaoh--he and all his army--will see them and he will be consoled for all his hordes that were killed by the sword, declares the Sovereign LORD.
- 32 "I used him to spread terror in the land of the living and now I'm dumping him in heathen ground with those killed by the sword--Pharaoh and all his pomp. Decree of GOD, the Master."
- 32 Although I had him spread terror in the land of the living, Pharaoh and all his hordes will be laid among the uncircumcised, with those killed by the sword, declares the Sovereign LORD."

Ezekiel 33

MSG

NIV

- 1 GOD's Message came to me:
- 1 The word of the LORD came to me:
- 2 "Son of man, speak to your people. Tell them: 'If I bring war on this land and the people take one of their citizens and make him their watchman,
- 2 Son of man, speak to your countrymen and say to them: 'When I bring the sword against a land, and the people of the land choose one of their

- men and make him their watchman,
- 3 and if the watchman sees war coming and blows the trumpet, warning the people,
- 3 and he sees the sword coming against the land and blows the trumpet to warn the people,
- 4 then if anyone hears the sound of the trumpet and ignores it and war comes and takes him off, it's his own fault.
- 4 then if anyone hears the trumpet but does not take warning and the sword comes and takes his life, his blood will be on his own head.
- 5 He heard the alarm, he ignored it--it's his own fault. If he had listened, he would have saved his life.
- 5 Since he heard the sound of the trumpet but did not take warning, his blood will be on his own head. If he had taken warning, he would have saved himself.
- 6 "'But if the watchman sees war coming and doesn't blow the trumpet, warning the people, and war comes and takes anyone off, I'll hold the watchman responsible for the bloodshed of any unwarned sinner.'
- 6 But if the watchman sees the sword coming and does not blow the trumpet to warn the people and the sword comes and takes the life of one of them, that man will be taken away because of his sin, but I will hold the watchman accountable for his blood.'
- 7 "You, son of man, are the watchman. I've made you a watchman for Israel. The minute you hear a message from me, warn them.
- 7 Son of man, I have made you a watchman for the house of Israel; so hear the word I speak and give them warning from me.
- 8 If I say to the wicked, 'Wicked man, wicked woman, you're on the fast track to death!' and you don't speak up and warn the wicked to change their ways, the wicked will die unwarned in their sins and I'll hold you responsible for their bloodshed.
- 8 When I say to the wicked, 'O wicked man, you will surely die,' and you do not speak out to dissuade him from his ways, that wicked man will die for his sin, and I will hold you accountable for his blood.
- 9 But if you warn the wicked to change their ways and they don't do it, they'll die in their sins well-warned and at least you will have saved your own life.

- 9 But if you do warn the wicked man to turn from his ways and he does not do so, he will die for his sin, but you will have saved yourself.
- 10 "Son of man, speak to Israel. Tell them: 'You've said, "Our rebellions and sins are weighing us down. We're wasting away. How can we go on living?"'
- 10 Son of man, say to the house of Israel, 'This is what you are saying: Our offenses and sins weigh us down, and we are wasting away because of them. How then can we live?' '
- 11 "Tell them, 'As sure as I am the living God, I take no pleasure from the death of the wicked. I want the wicked to change their ways and live. Turn your life around! Reverse your evil ways! Why die, Israel?'
- 11 Say to them, 'As surely as I live, declares the Sovereign LORD, I take no pleasure in the death of the wicked, but rather that they turn from their ways and live. Turn! Turn from your evil ways! Why will you die, O house of Israel?'
- 12 "There's more, son of man. Tell your people: 'A good person's good life won't save him when he decides to rebel, and a bad person's bad life won't prevent him from repenting of his rebellion. A good person who sins can't expect to live when he chooses to sin.
- 12 Therefore, son of man, say to your countrymen, 'The righteousness of the righteous man will not save him when he disobeys, and the wickedness of the wicked man will not cause him to fall when he turns from it. The righteous man, if he sins, will not be allowed to live because of his former righteousness.'
- 13 It's true that I tell good people, "Live! Be alive!" But if they trust in their good deeds and turn to evil, that good life won't amount to a hill of beans. They'll die for their evil life.
- 13 If I tell the righteous man that he will surely live, but then he trusts in his righteousness and does evil, none of the righteous things he has done will be remembered; he will die for the evil he has done.
- 14 "'On the other hand, if I tell a wicked person, "You'll die for your wicked life," and he repents of his sin and starts living a righteous and just life--
- 14 And if I say to the wicked man, 'You will surely die,' but he then turns away from his sin and does what is just and right--

- 15 being generous to the down-and-out, restoring what he had stolen, cultivating life-nourishing ways that don't hurt others--he'll live. He won't die.
- 15 if he gives back what he took in pledge for a loan, returns what he has stolen, follows the decrees that give life, and does no evil, he will surely live; he will not die.
- 16 None of his sins will be kept on the books. He's doing what's right, living a good life. He'll live.
- 16 None of the sins he has committed will be remembered against him. He has done what is just and right; he will surely live.
- 17 "'Your people say, 'The Master's way isn't fair.' But it's the way they're living that isn't fair.
- 17 Yet your countrymen say, 'The way of the Lord is not just.' But it is their way that is not just.
- 18 When good people turn back from living good lives and plunge into sin, they'll die for it.
- 18 If a righteous man turns from his righteousness and does evil, he will die for it.
- 19 And when a wicked person turns away from his wicked life and starts living a just and righteous life, he'll come alive.
- 19 And if a wicked man turns away from his wickedness and does what is just and right, he will live by doing so.
- 20 "'Still, you keep on saying, 'The Master's way isn't fair.' We'll see, Israel. I'll decide on each of you exactly according to how you live.'"
- 20 Yet, O house of Israel, you say, 'The way of the Lord is not just.' But I will judge each of you according to his own ways."
- 21 In the twelfth year of our exile, on the fifth day of the tenth month, a survivor from Jerusalem came to me and said, "The city's fallen."
- 21 In the twelfth year of our exile, in the tenth month on the fifth day, a man who had escaped from Jerusalem came to me and said, "The city has fallen!"
- 22 The evening before the survivor arrived, the hand of GOD had been on me and restored my speech. By the time he arrived in the morning I was able to speak. I could talk again.
- 22 Now the evening before the man arrived, the hand of the LORD was upon me, and he opened my mouth before the man came to me in the

- morning. So my mouth was opened and I was no longer silent.
- 23 GOD's Message came to me:
- 23 Then the word of the LORD came to me:
- 24 "Son of man, those who are living in the ruins back in Israel are saying, 'Abraham was only one man and he owned the whole country. But there are lots of us. Our ownership is even more certain.'
- 24 Son of man, the people living in those ruins in the land of Israel are saying, 'Abraham was only one man, yet he possessed the land. But we are many; surely the land has been given to us as our possession.'
- 25 "So tell them, 'GOD the Master says, You eat flesh that contains blood, you worship no-god idols, you murder at will--and you expect to own this land?
- 25 Therefore say to them, 'This is what the Sovereign LORD says: Since you eat meat with the blood still in it and look to your idols and shed blood, should you then possess the land?
- 26 You rely on the sword, you engage in obscenities, you indulge in sex at random--anyone, anytime. And you still expect to own this land?'
- 26 You rely on your sword, you do detestable things, and each of you defiles his neighbor's wife. Should you then possess the land?'
- 27 "Tell them this, Ezekiel: 'The Message of GOD, the Master. As sure as I am the living God, those who are still alive in the ruins will be killed. Anyone out in the field I'll give to wild animals for food. Anyone hiding out in mountain forts and caves will die of disease.
- 27 Say this to them: 'This is what the Sovereign LORD says: As surely as I live, those who are left in the ruins will fall by the sword, those out in the country I will give to the wild animals to be devoured, and those in strongholds and caves will die of a plague.
- 28 I'll make this country an empty wasteland--no more arrogant bullying! Israel's mountains will become dangerously desolate. No one will dare pass through them.'
- 28 I will make the land a desolate waste, and her proud strength will come to an end, and the mountains of Israel will become desolate so that no one will cross them.
- 29 "They'll realize that I am GOD when I devastate the country because of all the obscenities they've practiced.

- 29 Then they will know that I am the LORD, when I have made the land a desolate waste because of all the detestable things they have done.'
- 30 "As for you, son of man, you've become quite the talk of the town. Your people meet on street corners and in front of their houses and say, 'Let's go hear the latest news from GOD.'
- 30 As for you, son of man, your countrymen are talking together about you by the walls and at the doors of the houses, saying to each other, 'Come and hear the message that has come from the LORD.'
- 31 They show up, as people tend to do, and sit in your company. They listen to you speak, but don't do a thing you say. They flatter you with compliments, but all they care about is making money and getting ahead.
- 31 My people come to you, as they usually do, and sit before you to listen to your words, but they do not put them into practice. With their mouths they express devotion, but their hearts are greedy for unjust gain.
- 32 To them you're merely entertainment--a country singer of sad love songs, playing a guitar. They love to hear you talk, but nothing comes of it.
- 32 Indeed, to them you are nothing more than one who sings love songs with a beautiful voice and plays an instrument well, for they hear your words but do not put them into practice.
- 33 "But when all this happens--and it is going to happen!--they'll realize that a prophet was among them."
- 33 When all this comes true--and it surely will--then they will know that a prophet has been among them.

Ezekiel 34

MSG

NIV

- 1 GOD's Message came to me:
- 1 The word of the LORD came to me:
- 2 "Son of man, prophesy against the shepherd-leaders of Israel. Yes, prophesy! Tell those shepherds, 'GOD, the Master, says: Doom to you shepherds of Israel, feeding your own mouths! Aren't shepherds supposed to feed sheep?'

- 2 Son of man, prophesy against the shepherds of Israel; prophesy and say to them: 'This is what the Sovereign LORD says: Woe to the shepherds of Israel who only take care of themselves! Should not shepherds take care of the flock?
- 3 You drink the milk, you make clothes from the wool, you roast the lambs, but you don't feed the sheep.
- 3 You eat the curds, clothe yourselves with the wool and slaughter the choice animals, but you do not take care of the flock.
- 4 You don't build up the weak ones, don't heal the sick, don't doctor the injured, don't go after the strays, don't look for the lost. You bully and badger them.
- 4 You have not strengthened the weak or healed the sick or bound up the injured. You have not brought back the strays or searched for the lost. You have ruled them harshly and brutally.
- 5 And now they're scattered every which way because there was no shepherd--scattered and easy pickings for wolves and coyotes.
- 5 So they were scattered because there was no shepherd, and when they were scattered they became food for all the wild animals.
- 6 Scattered--my sheep!--exposed and vulnerable across mountains and hills. My sheep scattered all over the world, and no one out looking for them!
- 6 My sheep wandered over all the mountains and on every high hill. They were scattered over the whole earth, and no one searched or looked for them.
- 7 "Therefore, shepherds, listen to the Message of GOD:
- 7 'Therefore, you shepherds, hear the word of the LORD:
- 8 As sure as I am the living God--Decree of GOD, the Master--because my sheep have been turned into mere prey, into easy meals for wolves because you shepherds ignored them and only fed yourselves,
- 8 As surely as I live, declares the Sovereign LORD, because my flock lacks a shepherd and so has been plundered and has become food for all the wild animals, and because my shepherds did not search for my flock but cared for themselves rather than for my flock,
- 9 listen to what GOD has to say:
- 9 therefore, O shepherds, hear the word of the LORD:

- 10 "'Watch out! I'm coming down on the shepherds and taking my sheep back. They're fired as shepherds of my sheep. No more shepherds who just feed themselves! I'll rescue my sheep from their greed. They're not going to feed off my sheep any longer!
- 10 This is what the Sovereign LORD says: I am against the shepherds and will hold them accountable for my flock. I will remove them from tending the flock so that the shepherds can no longer feed themselves. I will rescue my flock from their mouths, and it will no longer be food for them.
- 11 "'GOD, the Master, says: From now on, I myself am the shepherd. I'm going looking for them.
- 11 'For this is what the Sovereign LORD says: I myself will search for my sheep and look after them.
- 12 As shepherds go after their flocks when they get scattered, I'm going after my sheep. I'll rescue them from all the places they've been scattered to in the storms.
- 12 As a shepherd looks after his scattered flock when he is with them, so will I look after my sheep. I will rescue them from all the places where they were scattered on a day of clouds and darkness.
- 13 I'll bring them back from foreign peoples, gather them from foreign countries, and bring them back to their home country. I'll feed them on the mountains of Israel, along the streams, among their own people.
- 13 I will bring them out from the nations and gather them from the countries, and I will bring them into their own land. I will pasture them on the mountains of Israel, in the ravines and in all the settlements in the land.
- 14 I'll lead them into lush pasture so they can roam the mountain pastures of Israel, graze at leisure, feed in the rich pastures on the mountains of Israel.
- 14 I will tend them in a good pasture, and the mountain heights of Israel will be their grazing land. There they will lie down in good grazing land, and there they will feed in a rich pasture on the mountains of Israel.
- 15 And I myself will be the shepherd of my sheep. I myself will make sure they get plenty of rest.
- 15 I myself will tend my sheep and have them lie down, declares the Sovereign LORD.

- 16 I'll go after the lost, I'll collect the strays, I'll doctor the injured, I'll build up the weak ones and oversee the strong ones so they're not exploited.
- 16 I will search for the lost and bring back the strays. I will bind up the injured and strengthen the weak, but the sleek and the strong I will destroy. I will shepherd the flock with justice.
- 17 "'And as for you, my dear flock, I'm stepping in and judging between one sheep and another, between rams and goats.
- 17 'As for you, my flock, this is what the Sovereign LORD says: I will judge between one sheep and another, and between rams and goats.
- 18 Aren't you satisfied to feed in good pasture without taking over the whole place? Can't you be satisfied to drink from the clear stream without muddying the water with your feet?
- 18 Is it not enough for you to feed on the good pasture? Must you also trample the rest of your pasture with your feet? Is it not enough for you to drink clear water? Must you also muddy the rest with your feet?
- 19 Why do the rest of my sheep have to make do with grass that's trampled down and water that's been muddied?
- 19 Must my flock feed on what you have trampled and drink what you have muddied with your feet?
- 20 "'Therefore, GOD, the Master, says: I myself am stepping in and making things right between the plump sheep and the skinny sheep.
- 20 'Therefore this is what the Sovereign LORD says to them: See, I myself will judge between the fat sheep and the lean sheep.
- 21 Because you forced your way with shoulder and rump and butted at all the weaker animals with your horns till you scattered them all over the hills,
- 21 Because you shove with flank and shoulder, butting all the weak sheep with your horns until you have driven them away,
- 22 I'll come in and save my dear flock, no longer let them be pushed around. I'll step in and set things right between one sheep and another.
- 22 I will save my flock, and they will no longer be plundered. I will judge between one sheep and another.
- 23 "'I'll appoint one shepherd over them all: my servant David. He'll feed them. He'll be their shepherd.
- 23 I will place over them one shepherd, my servant David, and he will tend them; he will tend them and be their shepherd.

- 24 And I, GOD, will be their God. My servant David will be their prince. I, GOD, have spoken.
- 24 I the LORD will be their God, and my servant David will be prince among them. I the LORD have spoken.
- 25 "I'll make a covenant of peace with them. I'll banish fierce animals from the country so the sheep can live safely in the wilderness and sleep in the forest.
- 25 I will make a covenant of peace with them and rid the land of wild beasts so that they may live in the desert and sleep in the forests in safety.
- 26 I'll make them and everything around my hill a blessing. I'll send down plenty of rain in season--showers of blessing!
- 26 I will bless them and the places surrounding my hill. I will send down showers in season; there will be showers of blessing.
- 27 The trees in the orchards will bear fruit, the ground will produce, they'll feel content and safe on their land, and they'll realize that I am GOD when I break them out of their slavery and rescue them from their slave masters.
- 27 The trees of the field will yield their fruit and the ground will yield its crops; the people will be secure in their land. They will know that I am the LORD, when I break the bars of their yoke and rescue them from the hands of those who enslaved them.
- 28 "No longer will they be exploited by outsiders and ravaged by fierce beasts. They'll live safe and sound, fearless and free.
- 28 They will no longer be plundered by the nations, nor will wild animals devour them. They will live in safety, and no one will make them afraid.
- 29 I'll give them rich gardens, lavish in vegetables--no more living half-starved, no longer taunted by outsiders.
- 29 I will provide for them a land renowned for its crops, and they will no longer be victims of famine in the land or bear the scorn of the nations.
- 30 "They'll know, beyond doubting, that I, GOD, am their God, that I'm with them and that they, the people Israel, are my people. Decree of GOD, the Master:
- 30 Then they will know that I, the LORD their God, am with them and that they, the house of Israel, are my people, declares the Sovereign LORD.

31 You are my dear flock, the flock of my pasture, my human flock, And I am your God. Decree of GOD, the Master."

31 You my sheep, the sheep of my pasture, are people, and I am your God, declares the Sovereign LORD.' "

Ezekiel 35

MSG

NIV

1 GOD's Message came to me:

1 The word of the LORD came to me:

2 "Son of man, confront Mount Seir. Prophecy against it!

2 Son of man, set your face against Mount Seir; prophecy against it

3 Tell them, 'GOD, the Master, says: "'I'm coming down hard on you, Mount Seir. I'm stepping in and turning you to a pile of rubble.

3 and say: 'This is what the Sovereign LORD says: I am against you, Mount Seir, and I will stretch out my hand against you and make you a desolate waste.

4 I'll reduce your towns to piles of rocks. There'll be nothing left of you. Then you'll realize that I am GOD.

4 I will turn your towns into ruins and you will be desolate. Then you will know that I am the LORD.

5 "'I'm doing this because you've kept this age-old grudge going against Israel: You viciously attacked them when they were already down, looking their final punishment in the face.

5 'Because you harbored an ancient hostility and delivered the Israelites over to the sword at the time of their calamity, the time their punishment reached its climax,

6 Therefore, as sure as I am the living God, I'm lining you up for a real bloodbath. Since you loved blood so much, you'll be chased by rivers of blood.

6 therefore as surely as I live, declares the Sovereign LORD, I will give you over to bloodshed and it will pursue you. Since you did not hate bloodshed, bloodshed will pursue you.

7 I'll reduce Mount Seir to a heap of rubble. No one will either come or go from that place!

- 7 I will make Mount Seir a desolate waste and cut off from it all who come and go.
- 8 I'll blanket your mountains with corpses. Massacred bodies will cover your hills and fill up your valleys and ditches.
- 8 I will fill your mountains with the slain; those killed by the sword will fall on your hills and in your valleys and in all your ravines.
- 9 I'll reduce you to ruins and all your towns will be ghost towns--population zero. Then you'll realize that I am GOD.
- 9 I will make you desolate forever; your towns will not be inhabited. Then you will know that I am the LORD.
- 10 "'Because you said, 'These two nations, these two countries, are mine. I'm taking over' (even though GOD is right there watching, right there listening),
- 10 'Because you have said, 'These two nations and countries will be ours and we will take possession of them,' even though I the LORD was there,
- 11 I'll turn your hate-bloated anger and rage right back on you. You'll know I mean business when I bring judgment on you.
- 11 therefore as surely as I live, declares the Sovereign LORD, I will treat you in accordance with the anger and jealousy you showed in your hatred of them and I will make myself known among them when I judge you.
- 12 You'll realize then that I, GOD, have overheard all the vile abuse you've poured out against the mountains of Israel, saying, "They're roadkill and we're going to eat them up."
- 12 Then you will know that I the LORD have heard all the contemptible things you have said against the mountains of Israel. You said, "They have been laid waste and have been given over to us to devour."
- 13 You've strutted around, talking so big, insolently pitting yourselves against me. And I've heard it all.
- 13 You boasted against me and spoke against me without restraint, and I heard it.
- 14 "'This is the verdict of GOD, the Master: With the whole earth applauding, I'll demolish you.
- 14 This is what the Sovereign LORD says: While the whole earth rejoices, I will make you desolate.

- 15 Since you danced in the streets, thinking it was so wonderful when Israel's inheritance was demolished, I'll give you the same treatment: demolition. Mount Seir demolished--yes, every square inch of Edom. Then they'll realize that I am GOD!"
- 15 Because you rejoiced when the inheritance of the house of Israel became desolate, that is how I will treat you. You will be desolate, O Mount Seir, you and all of Edom. Then they will know that I am the LORD.' "

Ezekiel 36

MSG

NIV

- 1 "And now, son of man, prophesy to the mountains of Israel. Say, 'Mountains of Israel, listen to GOD's Message.
- 1 Son of man, prophesy to the mountains of Israel and say, 'O mountains of Israel, hear the word of the LORD.
- 2 GOD, the Master, says, Because the enemy crowed over you, "Good! Those old hills are now ours!"
- 2 This is what the Sovereign LORD says: The enemy said of you, "Aha! The ancient heights have become our possession." "
- 3 now here is a prophecy in the name of GOD, the Master: Because nations came at you from all sides, ripping and plundering, hauling pieces of you off every which way, and you've become the butt of cheap gossip and jokes,
- 3 Therefore prophesy and say, 'This is what the Sovereign LORD says: Because they ravaged and hounded you from every side so that you became the possession of the rest of the nations and the object of people's malicious talk and slander,
- 4 therefore, Mountains of Israel, listen to the Message of GOD, the Master. My Message to mountains and hills, to ditches and valleys, to the heaps of rubble and the emptied towns that are looted for plunder and turned into jokes by all the surrounding nations:
- 4 therefore, O mountains of Israel, hear the word of the Sovereign LORD: This is what the Sovereign LORD says to the mountains and hills, to the

- ravines and valleys, to the desolate ruins and the deserted towns that have been plundered and ridiculed by the rest of the nations around you--
- 5 Therefore, says GOD, the Master, now I'm speaking in a fiery rage against the rest of the nations, but especially against Edom, who in an orgy of violence and shameless insolence robbed me of my land, grabbed it for themselves.'
- 5 this is what the Sovereign LORD says: In my burning zeal I have spoken against the rest of the nations, and against all Edom, for with glee and with malice in their hearts they made my land their own possession so that they might plunder its pastureland.'
- 6 "Therefore prophesy over the land of Israel, preach to the mountains and hills, to every ditch and valley: 'The Message of GOD, the Master: Look! Listen! I'm angry--and I care. I'm speaking to you because you've been humiliated among the nations.
- 6 Therefore prophesy concerning the land of Israel and say to the mountains and hills, to the ravines and valleys: 'This is what the Sovereign LORD says: I speak in my jealous wrath because you have suffered the scorn of the nations.
- 7 Therefore I, GOD, the Master, am telling you that I've solemnly sworn that the nations around you are next. It's their turn to be humiliated.
- 7 Therefore this is what the Sovereign LORD says: I swear with uplifted hand that the nations around you will also suffer scorn.
- 8 "'But you, Mountains of Israel, will burst with new growth, putting out branches and bearing fruit for my people Israel. My people are coming home!
- 8 'But you, O mountains of Israel, will produce branches and fruit for my people Israel, for they will soon come home.
- 9 Do you see? I'm back again. I'm on your side. You'll be plowed and planted as before!
- 9 I am concerned for you and will look on you with favor; you will be plowed and sown,
- 10 I'll see to it that your population grows all over Israel, that the towns fill up with people, that the ruins are rebuilt.
- 10 and I will multiply the number of people upon you, even the whole house of Israel. The towns will be inhabited and the ruins rebuilt.

- 11 I'll make this place teem with life--human and animal. The country will burst into life, life, and more life, your towns and villages full of people just as in the old days. I'll treat you better than I ever have. And you'll realize that I am GOD.
- 11 I will increase the number of men and animals upon you, and they will be fruitful and become numerous. I will settle people on you as in the past and will make you prosper more than before. Then you will know that I am the LORD.
- 12 I'll put people over you--my own people Israel! They'll take care of you and you'll be their inheritance. Never again will you be a harsh and unforgiving land to them.
- 12 I will cause people, my people Israel, to walk upon you. They will possess you, and you will be their inheritance; you will never again deprive them of their children.
- 13 "GOD, the Master, says: Because you have a reputation of being a land that eats people alive and makes women barren,
- 13 'This is what the Sovereign LORD says: Because people say to you, You devour men and deprive your nation of its children,"
- 14 I'm now telling you that you'll never eat people alive again nor make women barren. Decree of GOD, the Master.
- 14 therefore you will no longer devour men or make your nation childless, declares the Sovereign LORD.
- 15 And I'll never again let the taunts of outsiders be heard over you nor permit nations to look down on you. You'll no longer be a land that makes women barren. Decree of GOD, the Master."
- 15 No longer will I make you hear the taunts of the nations, and no longer will you suffer the scorn of the peoples or cause your nation to fall, declares the Sovereign LORD.' "
- 16 GOD's Message came to me:
- 16 Again the word of the LORD came to me:
- 17 "Son of man, when the people of Israel lived in their land, they polluted it by the way they lived. I poured out my anger on them because of the polluted blood they poured out on the ground.
- 17 Son of man, when the people of Israel were living in their own land, they defiled it by their conduct and their actions. Their conduct was like a woman's monthly uncleanness in my sight.

- 18 And so I got thoroughly angry with them polluting the country with their wanton murders and dirty gods.
- 18 So I poured out my wrath on them because they had shed blood in the land and because they had defiled it with their idols.
- 19 I kicked them out, exiled them to other countries. I sentenced them according to how they had lived.
- 19 I dispersed them among the nations, and they were scattered through the countries; I judged them according to their conduct and their actions.
- 20 Wherever they went, they gave me a bad name. People said, 'These are GOD's people, but they got kicked off his land.'
- 20 And wherever they went among the nations they profaned my holy name, for it was said of them, 'These are the LORD's people, and yet they had to leave his land.'
- 21 I suffered much pain over my holy reputation, which the people of Israel blackened in every country they entered.
- 21 I had concern for my holy name, which the house of Israel profaned among the nations where they had gone.
- 22 "Therefore, tell Israel, 'Message of GOD, the Master: I'm not doing this for you, Israel. I'm doing it for me, to save my character, my holy name, which you've blackened in every country where you've gone.'
- 22 Therefore say to the house of Israel, 'This is what the Sovereign LORD says: It is not for your sake, O house of Israel, that I am going to do these things, but for the sake of my holy name, which you have profaned among the nations where you have gone.'
- 23 I'm going to put my great and holy name on display, the name that has been ruined in so many countries, the name that you blackened wherever you went. Then the nations will realize who I really am, that I am GOD, when I show my holiness through you so that they can see it with their own eyes.
- 23 I will show the holiness of my great name, which has been profaned among the nations, the name you have profaned among them. Then the nations will know that I am the LORD, declares the Sovereign LORD, when I show myself holy through you before their eyes.
- 24 "'For here's what I'm going to do: I'm going to take you out of these countries, gather you from all over, and bring you back to your own land.'

- 24 'For I will take you out of the nations; I will gather you from all the countries and bring you back into your own land.
- 25 I'll pour pure water over you and scrub you clean.
- 25 I will sprinkle clean water on you, and you will be clean; I will cleanse you from all your impurities and from all your idols.
- 26 I'll give you a new heart, put a new spirit in you. I'll remove the stone heart from your body and replace it with a heart that's God-willed, not self-willed.
- 26 I will give you a new heart and put a new spirit in you; I will remove from you your heart of stone and give you a heart of flesh.
- 27 I'll put my Spirit in you and make it possible for you to do what I tell you and live by my commands.
- 27 And I will put my Spirit in you and move you to follow my decrees and be careful to keep my laws.
- 28 You'll once again live in the land I gave your ancestors. You'll be my people! I'll be your God!
- 28 You will live in the land I gave your forefathers; you will be my people, and I will be your God.
- 29 "'I'll pull you out of that stinking pollution. I'll give personal orders to the wheat fields, telling them to grow bumper crops. I'll send no more famines.
- 29 I will save you from all your uncleanness. I will call for the grain and make it plentiful and will not bring famine upon you.
- 30 I'll make sure your fruit trees and field crops flourish. Other nations won't be able to hold you in contempt again because of famine.
- 30 I will increase the fruit of the trees and the crops of the field, so that you will no longer suffer disgrace among the nations because of famine.
- 31 "'And then you'll think back over your terrible lives--the evil, the shame--and be thoroughly disgusted with yourselves, realizing how badly you've lived--all those obscenities you've carried out.
- 31 Then you will remember your evil ways and wicked deeds, and you will loathe yourselves for your sins and detestable practices.
- 32 "'I'm not doing this for you. Get this through your thick heads! Shame on you. What a mess you made of things, Israel!
- 32 I want you to know that I am not doing this for your sake, declares the Sovereign LORD. Be ashamed and disgraced for your conduct, O house

of Israel!

33 "'Message of GOD, the Master: On the day I scrub you clean from all your filthy living, I'll also make your cities livable. The ruins will be rebuilt.

33 'This is what the Sovereign LORD says: On the day I cleanse you from all your sins, I will resettle your towns, and the ruins will be rebuilt.

34 The neglected land will be worked again, no longer overgrown with weeds and thistles, worthless in the eyes of passersby.

34 The desolate land will be cultivated instead of lying desolate in the sight of all who pass through it.

35 People will exclaim, "Why, this weed patch has been turned into a Garden of Eden! And the ruined cities, smashed into oblivion, are now thriving!"

35 They will say, "This land that was laid waste has become like the garden of Eden; the cities that were lying in ruins, desolate and destroyed, are now fortified and inhabited."

36 The nations around you that are still in existence will realize that I, GOD, rebuild ruins and replant empty waste places. I, GOD, said so, and I'll do it.

36 Then the nations around you that remain will know that I the LORD have rebuilt what was destroyed and have replanted what was desolate. I the LORD have spoken, and I will do it.'

37 "'Message of GOD, the Master: Yet again I'm going to do what Israel asks. I'll increase their population as with a flock of sheep.

37 This is what the Sovereign LORD says: Once again I will yield to the plea of the house of Israel and do this for them: I will make their people as numerous as sheep,

38 Like the milling flocks of sheep brought for sacrifices in Jerusalem during the appointed feasts, the ruined cities will be filled with flocks of people. And they'll realize that I am GOD."

38 as numerous as the flocks for offerings at Jerusalem during her appointed feasts. So will the ruined cities be filled with flocks of people. Then they will know that I am the LORD."

Ezekiel 37

MSG

NIV

- 1 GOD grabbed me. GOD's Spirit took me up and sat me down in the middle of an open plain strewn with bones.
- 1 The hand of the LORD was upon me, and he brought me out by the Spirit of the LORD and set me in the middle of a valley; it was full of bones.
- 2 He led me around and among them--a lot of bones! There were bones all over the plain--dry bones, bleached by the sun.
- 2 He led me back and forth among them, and I saw a great many bones on the floor of the valley, bones that were very dry.
- 3 He said to me, "Son of man, can these bones live?" I said, "Master GOD, only you know that."
- 3 He asked me, "Son of man, can these bones live?" I said, "O Sovereign LORD, you alone know."
- 4 He said to me, "Prophecy over these bones: 'Dry bones, listen to the Message of GOD!'"
- 4 Then he said to me, "Prophecy to these bones and say to them, 'Dry bones, hear the word of the LORD!'"
- 5 GOD, the Master, told the dry bones, "Watch this: I'm bringing the breath of life to you and you'll come to life.
- 5 This is what the Sovereign LORD says to these bones: I will make breath enter you, and you will come to life.
- 6 I'll attach sinews to you, put meat on your bones, cover you with skin, and breathe life into you. You'll come alive and you'll realize that I am GOD!"
- 6 I will attach tendons to you and make flesh come upon you and cover you with skin; I will put breath in you, and you will come to life. Then you will know that I am the LORD.' "
- 7 I prophesied just as I'd been commanded. As I prophesied, there was a sound and, oh, rustling! The bones moved and came together, bone to bone.
- 7 So I prophesied as I was commanded. And as I was prophesying, there was a noise, a rattling sound, and the bones came together, bone to bone.
- 8 I kept watching. Sinews formed, then muscles on the bones, then skin stretched over them. But they had no breath in them.

- 8 I looked, and tendons and flesh appeared on them and skin covered them, but there was no breath in them.
- 9 He said to me, "Prophesy to the breath. Prophesy, son of man. Tell the breath, 'GOD, the Master, says, Come from the four winds. Come, breath. Breathe on these slain bodies. Breathe life!'"
- 9 Then he said to me, "Prophesy to the breath; prophesy, son of man, and say to it, 'This is what the Sovereign LORD says: Come from the four winds, O breath, and breathe into these slain, that they may live.' "
- 10 So I prophesied, just as he commanded me. The breath entered them and they came alive! They stood up on their feet, a huge army.
- 10 So I prophesied as he commanded me, and breath entered them; they came to life and stood up on their feet--a vast army.
- 11 Then God said to me, "Son of man, these bones are the whole house of Israel. Listen to what they're saying: 'Our bones are dried up, our hope is gone, there's nothing left of us.'
- 11 Then he said to me: "Son of man, these bones are the whole house of Israel. They say, 'Our bones are dried up and our hope is gone; we are cut off.'
- 12 "Therefore, prophesy. Tell them, 'GOD, the Master, says: I'll dig up your graves and bring you out alive--O my people! Then I'll take you straight to the land of Israel.
- 12 Therefore prophesy and say to them: 'This is what the Sovereign LORD says: O my people, I am going to open your graves and bring you up from them; I will bring you back to the land of Israel.
- 13 When I dig up graves and bring you out as my people, you'll realize that I am GOD.
- 13 Then you, my people, will know that I am the LORD, when I open your graves and bring you up from them.
- 14 I'll breathe my life into you and you'll live. Then I'll lead you straight back to your land and you'll realize that I am GOD. I've said it and I'll do it. GOD's Decree.'"
- 14 I will put my Spirit in you and you will live, and I will settle you in your own land. Then you will know that I the LORD have spoken, and I have done it, declares the LORD.' "
- 15 GOD's Message came to me:
- 15 The word of the LORD came to me:

- 16 "You, son of man: Take a stick and write on it, 'For Judah, with his Israelite companions.' Then take another stick and write on it, 'For Joseph--Ephraim's stick, together with all his Israelite companions.'
- 16 Son of man, take a stick of wood and write on it, 'Belonging to Judah and the Israelites associated with him.' Then take another stick of wood, and write on it, 'Ephraim's stick, belonging to Joseph and all the house of Israel associated with him.'
- 17 Then tie the two sticks together so that you're holding one stick.
- 17 Join them together into one stick so that they will become one in your hand.
- 18 "When your people ask you, 'Are you going to tell us what you're doing?'
- 18 When your countrymen ask you, 'Won't you tell us what you mean by this?'
- 19 tell them, 'GOD, the Master, says, Watch me! I'll take the Joseph stick that is in Ephraim's hand, with the tribes of Israel connected with him, and lay the Judah stick on it. I'll make them into one stick. I'm holding one stick.'
- 19 say to them, 'This is what the Sovereign LORD says: I am going to take the stick of Joseph--which is in Ephraim's hand--and of the Israelite tribes associated with him, and join it to Judah's stick, making them a single stick of wood, and they will become one in my hand.'
- 20 "Then take the sticks you've inscribed and hold them up so the people can see them.
- 20 Hold before their eyes the sticks you have written on
- 21 Tell them, 'GOD, the Master, says, Watch me! I'm taking the Israelites out of the nations in which they've been exiled. I'll gather them in from all directions and bring them back home.
- 21 and say to them, 'This is what the Sovereign LORD says: I will take the Israelites out of the nations where they have gone. I will gather them from all around and bring them back into their own land.
- 22 I'll make them one nation in the land, on the mountains of Israel, and give them one king--one king over all of them. Never again will they be divided into two nations, two kingdoms.
- 22 I will make them one nation in the land, on the mountains of Israel. There will be one king over all of them and they will never again be two

- nations or be divided into two kingdoms.
- 23 Never again will they pollute their lives with their no-god idols and all those vile obscenities and rebellions. I'll save them out of all their old sinful haunts. I'll clean them up. They'll be my people! I'll be their God!
- 23 They will no longer defile themselves with their idols and vile images or with any of their offenses, for I will save them from all their sinful backsliding, and I will cleanse them. They will be my people, and I will be their God.
- 24 My servant David will be king over them. They'll all be under one shepherd. "They'll follow my laws and keep my statutes.
- 24 'My servant David will be king over them, and they will all have one shepherd. They will follow my laws and be careful to keep my decrees.
- 25 They'll live in the same land I gave my servant Jacob, the land where your ancestors lived. They and their children and their grandchildren will live there forever, and my servant David will be their prince forever.
- 25 They will live in the land I gave to my servant Jacob, the land where your fathers lived. They and their children and their children's children will live there forever, and David my servant will be their prince forever.
- 26 I'll make a covenant of peace with them that will hold everything together, an everlasting covenant. I'll make them secure and place my holy place of worship at the center of their lives forever.
- 26 I will make a covenant of peace with them; it will be an everlasting covenant. I will establish them and increase their numbers, and I will put my sanctuary among them forever.
- 27 I'll live right there with them. I'll be their God! They'll be my people!
- 27 My dwelling place will be with them; I will be their God, and they will be my people.
- 28 "The nations will realize that I, GOD, make Israel holy when my holy place of worship is established at the center of their lives forever."
- 28 Then the nations will know that I the LORD make Israel holy, when my sanctuary is among them forever.' "

Ezekiel 38

MSG

NIV

- 1 GOD's Message came to me:
- 1 The word of the LORD came to me:
- 2 "Son of man, confront Gog from the country of Magog, head of Meshech and Tubal. Prophecy against him.
- 2 Son of man, set your face against Gog, of the land of Magog, the chief prince of Meshech and Tubal; prophecy against him
- 3 Say, 'GOD, the Master, says: Be warned, Gog. I am against you, head of Meshech and Tubal.
- 3 and say: 'This is what the Sovereign LORD says: I am against you, O Gog, chief prince of Meshech and Tubal.
- 4 I'm going to turn you around, put hooks in your jaws, and drag you off with your whole army, your horses and riders in full armor--all those shields and bucklers and swords--fighting men armed to the teeth!
- 4 I will turn you around, put hooks in your jaws and bring you out with your whole army--your horses, your horsemen fully armed, and a great horde with large and small shields, all of them brandishing their swords.
- 5 Persia and Cush and Put will be in the ranks, also well-armed, as will
- 5 Persia, Cush and Put will be with them, all with shields and helmets,
- 6 Gomer and its army and Beth-togarmah out of the north with its army. Many nations will be with you!
- 6 also Gomer with all its troops, and Beth Togarmah from the far north with all its troops--the many nations with you.
- 7 "'Get ready to fight, you and the whole company that's been called out. Take charge and wait for orders.
- 7 'Get ready; be prepared, you and all the hordes gathered about you, and take command of them.
- 8 After a long time, you'll be given your orders. In the distant future you'll arrive at a country that has recovered from a devastating war. People from many nations will be gathered there on the mountains of Israel, for a long time now a wasteland. These people have been brought back from many countries and now live safe and secure.
- 8 After many days you will be called to arms. In future years you will invade a land that has recovered from war, whose people were gathered from many nations to the mountains of Israel, which had long been desolate. They had been brought out from the nations, and now all of them live in safety.

- 9 You'll rise like a thunderstorm and roll in like clouds and cover the land, you and the massed troops with you.
- 9 You and all your troops and the many nations with you will go up, advancing like a storm; you will be like a cloud covering the land.
- 10 "'Message of GOD, the Master: At that time you'll start thinking things over and cook up an evil plot.
- 10 'This is what the Sovereign LORD says: On that day thoughts will come into your mind and you will devise an evil scheme.
- 11 You'll say, "I'm going to invade a country without defenses, attack an unsuspecting, carefree people going about their business--no gates to their cities, no locks on their doors.
- 11 You will say, "I will invade a land of unwallled villages; I will attack a peaceful and unsuspecting people--all of them living without walls and without gates and bars.
- 12 And I'm going to plunder the place, march right in and clean them out, this rebuilt country risen from the ashes, these returned exiles and their booming economy centered down at the navel of the earth."
- 12 I will plunder and loot and turn my hand against the resettled ruins and the people gathered from the nations, rich in livestock and goods, living at the center of the land."
- 13 "'Sheba and Dedan and Tarshish, traders all out to make a fast buck, will say, "So! You've opened a new market for plunder! You've brought in your troops to get rich quick!"
- 13 Sheba and Dedan and the merchants of Tarshish and all her villages will say to you, "Have you come to plunder? Have you gathered your hordes to loot, to carry off silver and gold, to take away livestock and goods and to seize much plunder?" '
- 14 "Therefore, son of man, prophesy! Tell Gog, 'A Message from GOD, the Master: When my people Israel are established securely, will you make your move?
- 14 Therefore, son of man, prophesy and say to Gog: 'This is what the Sovereign LORD says: In that day, when my people Israel are living in safety, will you not take notice of it?
- 15 Will you come down out of the far north, you and that mob of armies, charging out on your horses like a tidal wave across the land,

- 15 You will come from your place in the far north, you and many nations with you, all of them riding on horses, a great horde, a mighty army.
- 16 and invade my people Israel, covering the country like a cloud? When the time's ripe, I'll unleash you against my land in such a way that the nations will recognize me, realize that through you, Gog, in full view of the nations, I am putting my holiness on display.
- 16 You will advance against my people Israel like a cloud that covers the land. In days to come, O Gog, I will bring you against my land, so that the nations may know me when I show myself holy through you before their eyes.
- 17 "'A Message of GOD, the Master: Years ago when I spoke through my servants, the prophets of Israel, wasn't it you I was talking about? Year after year they prophesied that I would bring you against them.
- 17 'This is what the Sovereign LORD says: Are you not the one I spoke of in former days by my servants the prophets of Israel? At that time they prophesied for years that I would bring you against them.
- 18 And when the day comes, Gog, you will attack that land of Israel. Decree of GOD, the Master. My raging anger will erupt.
- 18 This is what will happen in that day: When Gog attacks the land of Israel, my hot anger will be aroused, declares the Sovereign LORD.
- 19 Fueled by blazing jealousy, I tell you that then there will be an earthquake that rocks the land of Israel.
- 19 In my zeal and fiery wrath I declare that at that time there shall be a great earthquake in the land of Israel.
- 20 Fish and birds and wild animals--even ants and beetles!--and every human being will tremble and shake before me. Mountains will disintegrate, terraces will crumble.
- 20 The fish of the sea, the birds of the air, the beasts of the field, every creature that moves along the ground, and all the people on the face of the earth will tremble at my presence. The mountains will be overturned, the cliffs will crumble and every wall will fall to the ground.
- 21 I'll order all-out war against you, Gog--Decree of GOD, the Master--Gog killing Gog on all the mountains of Israel.
- 21 I will summon a sword against Gog on all my mountains, declares the Sovereign LORD. Every man's sword will be against his brother.

- 22 I'll deluge Gog with judgment: disease and massacre, torrential rain and hail, volcanic lava pouring down on you and your mobs of troops and people.
- 22 I will execute judgment upon him with plague and bloodshed; I will pour down torrents of rain, hailstones and burning sulfur on him and on his troops and on the many nations with him.
- 23 "'I'll show you how great I am, how holy I am. I'll make myself known all over the world. Then you'll realize that I am GOD.'
- 23 And so I will show my greatness and my holiness, and I will make myself known in the sight of many nations. Then they will know that I am the LORD.'

Ezekiel 39

MSG

NIV

- 1 "Son of man, prophesy against Gog. Say, 'A Message of GOD, the Master: I'm against you, Gog, head of Meshech and Tubal.
- 1 Son of man, prophesy against Gog and say: 'This is what the Sovereign LORD says: I am against you, O Gog, chief prince of Meshech and Tubal.
- 2 I'm going to turn you around and drag you out, drag you out of the far north and down on the mountains of Israel.
- 2 I will turn you around and drag you along. I will bring you from the far north and send you against the mountains of Israel.
- 3 Then I'll knock your bow out of your left hand and your arrows from your right hand.
- 3 Then I will strike your bow from your left hand and make your arrows drop from your right hand.
- 4 On the mountains of Israel you'll be slaughtered, you and all your troops and the people with you. I'll serve you up as a meal to carrion birds and scavenging animals.
- 4 On the mountains of Israel you will fall, you and all your troops and the nations with you. I will give you as food to all kinds of carrion birds and to the wild animals.

- 5 You'll be killed in the open field. I've given my word. Decree of GOD, the Master.'
- 5 You will fall in the open field, for I have spoken, declares the Sovereign LORD.
- 6 "I'll set fire to Magog and the far-off islands, where people are so seemingly secure. And they'll realize that I am GOD.
- 6 I will send fire on Magog and on those who live in safety in the coastlands, and they will know that I am the LORD.
- 7 "I'll reveal my holy name among my people Israel. Never again will I let my holy name be dragged in the mud. Then the nations will realize that I, GOD, am The Holy in Israel.
- 7 'I will make known my holy name among my people Israel. I will no longer let my holy name be profaned, and the nations will know that I the LORD am the Holy One in Israel.
- 8 "It's coming! Yes, it will happen! This is the day I've been telling you about.
- 8 It is coming! It will surely take place, declares the Sovereign LORD. This is the day I have spoken of.
- 9 "People will come out of the cities of Israel and make a huge bonfire of the weapons of war, piling on shields large and small, bows and arrows, clubs and spears, a fire they'll keep going for seven years.
- 9 'Then those who live in the towns of Israel will go out and use the weapons for fuel and burn them up--the small and large shields, the bows and arrows, the war clubs and spears. For seven years they will use them for fuel.
- 10 They won't need to go into the woods to get fuel for the fire. There'll be plenty of weapons to keep it going. They'll strip those who stripped them. They'll rob those who robbed them. Decree of GOD, the Master.
- 10 They will not need to gather wood from the fields or cut it from the forests, because they will use the weapons for fuel. And they will plunder those who plundered them and loot those who looted them, declares the Sovereign LORD.
- 11 "At that time I'll set aside a burial ground for Gog in Israel at Traveler's Rest, just east of the sea. It will obstruct the route of travelers, blocking their way, the mass grave of Gog and his mob of an army. They'll call the place Gog's Mob.

- 11 'On that day I will give Gog a burial place in Israel, in the valley of those who travel east toward the Sea. It will block the way of travelers, because Gog and all his hordes will be buried there. So it will be called the Valley of Hamon Gog.
- 12 "Israel will bury the corpses in order to clean up the land. It will take them seven months.
- 12 'For seven months the house of Israel will be burying them in order to cleanse the land.
- 13 All the people will turn out to help with the burials. It will be a big day for the people when it's all done and I'm given my due.
- 13 All the people of the land will bury them, and the day I am glorified will be a memorable day for them, declares the Sovereign LORD.
- 14 Men will be hired full-time for the cleanup burial operation and will go through the country looking for defiling, decomposing corpses. At the end of seven months, there'll be an all-out final search.
- 14 'Men will be regularly employed to cleanse the land. Some will go throughout the land and, in addition to them, others will bury those that remain on the ground. At the end of the seven months they will begin their search.
- 15 Anyone who sees a bone will mark the place with a stick so the buriers can get it and bury it in the mass burial site, Gog's Mob.
- 15 As they go through the land and one of them sees a human bone, he will set up a marker beside it until the gravediggers have buried it in the Valley of Hamon Gog.
- 16 (A town nearby is called Mobville, or Hamonah.) That's how they'll clean up the land.
- 16 (Also a town called Hamonah will be there.) And so they will cleanse the land.'
- 17 "Son of man, GOD, the Master, says: Call the birds! Call the wild animals! Call out, 'Gather and come, gather around my sacrificial meal that I'm preparing for you on the mountains of Israel. You'll eat meat and drink blood.
- 17 Son of man, this is what the Sovereign LORD says: Call out to every kind of bird and all the wild animals: 'Assemble and come together from all around to the sacrifice I am preparing for you, the great sacrifice on the mountains of Israel. There you will eat flesh and drink blood.

- 18 You'll eat off the bodies of great heroes and drink the blood of famous princes as if they were so many rams and lambs, goats and bulls, the choicest grain-fed animals of Bashan.
- 18 You will eat the flesh of mighty men and drink the blood of the princes of the earth as if they were rams and lambs, goats and bulls--all of them fattened animals from Bashan.
- 19 At the sacrificial meal I'm fixing for you, you'll eat fat till you're stuffed and drink blood till you're drunk.
- 19 At the sacrifice I am preparing for you, you will eat fat till you are gluttoned and drink blood till you are drunk.
- 20 At the table I set for you, you'll stuff yourselves with horses and riders, heroes and fighters of every kind.' Decree of GOD, the Master.
- 20 At my table you will eat your fill of horses and riders, mighty men and soldiers of every kind,' declares the Sovereign LORD.
- 21 "I'll put my glory on display among the nations and they'll all see the judgment I execute, see me at work handing out judgment.
- 21 I will display my glory among the nations, and all the nations will see the punishment I inflict and the hand I lay upon them.
- 22 From that day on, Israel will realize that I am their GOD.
- 22 From that day forward the house of Israel will know that I am the LORD their God.
- 23 And the nations will get the message that it was because of their sins that Israel went into exile. They were disloyal to me and I turned away from them. I turned them over to their enemies and they were all killed.
- 23 And the nations will know that the people of Israel went into exile for their sin, because they were unfaithful to me. So I hid my face from them and handed them over to their enemies, and they all fell by the sword.
- 24 I treated them as their polluted and sin-sated lives deserved. I turned away from them, refused to look at them.
- 24 I dealt with them according to their uncleanness and their offenses, and I hid my face from them.
- 25 "But now I will return Jacob back from exile, I'll be compassionate with all the people of Israel, and I'll be zealous for my holy name.
- 25 Therefore this is what the Sovereign LORD says: I will now bring Jacob back from captivity and will have compassion on all the people of Israel, and I will be zealous for my holy name.

- 26 Eventually the memory will fade, the memory of their shame over their betrayals of me when they lived securely in their own land, safe and unafraid.
- 26 They will forget their shame and all the unfaithfulness they showed toward me when they lived in safety in their land with no one to make them afraid.
- 27 Once I've brought them back from foreign parts, gathered them in from enemy territories, I'll use them to demonstrate my holiness with all the nations watching.
- 27 When I have brought them back from the nations and have gathered them from the countries of their enemies, I will show myself holy through them in the sight of many nations.
- 28 Then they'll realize for sure that I am their GOD, for even though I sent them off into exile, I will gather them back to their own land, leaving not one soul behind.
- 28 Then they will know that I am the LORD their God, for though I sent them into exile among the nations, I will gather them to their own land, not leaving any behind.
- 29 After I've poured my Spirit on Israel, filled them with my life, I'll no longer turn away. I'll look them full in the face. Decree of GOD, the Master."
- 29 I will no longer hide my face from them, for I will pour out my Spirit on the house of Israel, declares the Sovereign LORD."

Ezekiel 40

MSG

NIV

- 1 In the twenty-fifth year of our exile, at the beginning of the year on the tenth of the month--it was the fourteenth year after the city fell--GOD touched me and brought me here.
- 1 In the twenty-fifth year of our exile, at the beginning of the year, on the tenth of the month, in the fourteenth year after the fall of the city--on that very day the hand of the LORD was upon me and he took me there.
- 2 He brought me in divine vision to the land of Israel and set me down on a high mountain. To the south there were buildings that looked like a city.

- 2 In visions of God he took me to the land of Israel and set me on a very high mountain, on whose south side were some buildings that looked like a city.
- 3 He took me there and I met a man deeply tanned, like bronze. He stood at the entrance holding a linen cord and a measuring stick.
- 3 He took me there, and I saw a man whose appearance was like bronze; he was standing in the gateway with a linen cord and a measuring rod in his hand.
- 4 The man said to me, "Son of man, look and listen carefully. Pay close attention to everything I'm going to show you. That's why you've been brought here. And then tell Israel everything you see."
- 4 The man said to me, "Son of man, look with your eyes and hear with your ears and pay attention to everything I am going to show you, for that is why you have been brought here. Tell the house of Israel everything you see."
- 5 First I saw a wall around the outside of the Temple complex. The measuring stick in the man's hand was about ten feet long. He measured the thickness of the wall: about ten feet. The height was also about ten feet.
- 5 I saw a wall completely surrounding the temple area. The length of the measuring rod in the man's hand was six long cubits, each of which was a cubit and a handbreadth. He measured the wall; it was one measuring rod thick and one rod high.
- 6 He went into the gate complex that faced the east and went up the seven steps.
- 6 Then he went to the gate facing east. He climbed its steps and measured the threshold of the gate; it was one rod deep.
- 7 He measured the depth of the outside threshold of the gate complex: ten feet. There were alcoves flanking the gate corridor, each ten feet square, each separated by a wall seven and a half feet thick. The inside threshold of the gate complex that led to the porch facing into the Temple courtyard was ten feet deep.
- 7 The alcoves for the guards were one rod long and one rod wide, and the projecting walls between the alcoves were five cubits thick. And the threshold of the gate next to the portico facing the temple was one rod deep.

- 8 He measured the inside porch of the gate complex:
- 8 Then he measured the portico of the gateway;
- 9 twelve feet deep, flanked by pillars three feet thick. The porch opened onto the Temple courtyard.
- 9 it was eight cubits deep and its jambs were two cubits thick. The portico of the gateway faced the temple.
- 10 Inside this east gate complex were three alcoves on each side. Each room was the same size and the separating walls were identical.
- 10 Inside the east gate were three alcoves on each side; the three had the same measurements, and the faces of the projecting walls on each side had the same measurements.
- 11 He measured the outside entrance to the gate complex: fifteen feet wide and nineteen and a half feet deep.
- 11 Then he measured the width of the entrance to the gateway; it was ten cubits and its length was thirteen cubits.
- 12 In front of each alcove was a low wall eighteen inches high. The alcoves were ten feet square.
- 12 In front of each alcove was a wall one cubit high, and the alcoves were six cubits square.
- 13 He measured the width of the gate complex from the outside edge of the alcove roof on one side to the outside edge of the alcove roof on the other: thirty-seven and a half feet from one top edge to the other.
- 13 Then he measured the gateway from the top of the rear wall of one alcove to the top of the opposite one; the distance was twenty-five cubits from one parapet opening to the opposite one.
- 14 He measured the inside walls of the gate complex: ninety feet to the porch leading into the courtyard.
- 14 He measured along the faces of the projecting walls all around the inside of the gateway--sixty cubits. The measurement was up to the portico facing the courtyard.
- 15 The distance from the entrance of the gate complex to the far end of the porch was seventy-five feet.
- 15 The distance from the entrance of the gateway to the far end of its portico was fifty cubits.
- 16 The alcoves and their connecting walls inside the gate complex were topped by narrow windows all the way around. The porch also. All the

windows faced inward. The doorjambs between the alcoves were decorated with palm trees.

16 The alcoves and the projecting walls inside the gateway were surmounted by narrow parapet openings all around, as was the portico; the openings all around faced inward. The faces of the projecting walls were decorated with palm trees.

17 The man then led me to the outside courtyard and all its rooms. A paved walkway had been built connecting the courtyard gates. Thirty rooms lined the courtyard.

17 Then he brought me into the outer court. There I saw some rooms and a pavement that had been constructed all around the court; there were thirty rooms along the pavement.

18 The walkway was the same length as the gateways. It flanked them and ran their entire length. This was the walkway for the outside courtyard.

18 It abutted the sides of the gateways and was as wide as they were long; this was the lower pavement.

19 He measured the distance from the front of the entrance gateway across to the entrance of the inner court: one hundred fifty feet. Then he took me to the north side.

19 Then he measured the distance from the inside of the lower gateway to the outside of the inner court; it was a hundred cubits on the east side as well as on the north.

20 Here was another gate complex facing north, exiting the outside courtyard. He measured its length and width.

20 Then he measured the length and width of the gate facing north, leading into the outer court.

21 It had three alcoves on each side. Its gateposts and porch were the same as in the first gate: eighty-seven and a half feet by forty-three and three-quarters feet.

21 Its alcoves--three on each side--its projecting walls and its portico had the same measurements as those of the first gateway. It was fifty cubits long and twenty-five cubits wide.

22 The windows and palm trees were identical to the east gateway. Seven steps led up to it, and its porch faced inward.

22 Its openings, its portico and its palm tree decorations had the same measurements as those of the gate facing east. Seven steps led up to it,

with its portico opposite them.

23 Opposite this gate complex was a gate complex to the inside courtyard, on the north as on the east. The distance between the two was one hundred seventy-five feet.

23 There was a gate to the inner court facing the north gate, just as there was on the east. He measured from one gate to the opposite one; it was a hundred cubits.

24 Then he took me to the south side, to the south gate complex. He measured its gateposts and its porch. It was the same size as the others.

24 Then he led me to the south side and I saw a gate facing south. He measured its jambs and its portico, and they had the same measurements as the others.

25 The porch with its windows was the same size as those previously mentioned.

25 The gateway and its portico had narrow openings all around, like the openings of the others. It was fifty cubits long and twenty-five cubits wide.

26 It also had seven steps up to it. Its porch opened onto the outside courtyard, with palm trees decorating its gateposts on both sides.

26 Seven steps led up to it, with its portico opposite them; it had palm tree decorations on the faces of the projecting walls on each side.

27 Opposite to it, the gate complex for the inner court faced south. He measured the distance across the courtyard from gate to gate: one hundred seventy-five feet.

27 The inner court also had a gate facing south, and he measured from this gate to the outer gate on the south side; it was a hundred cubits.

28 He led me into the inside courtyard through the south gate complex. He measured it and found it the same as the outside ones.

28 Then he brought me into the inner court through the south gate, and he measured the south gate; it had the same measurements as the others.

29 Its alcoves, connecting walls, and vestibule were the same. The gate complex and porch, windowed all around, measured eighty-seven and a half by forty-three and three-quarters feet.

29 Its alcoves, its projecting walls and its portico had the same measurements as the others. The gateway and its portico had openings all around. It was fifty cubits long and twenty-five cubits wide.

- 30 The vestibule of each of the gate complexes leading to the inside courtyard was forty-three and three-quarters by eight and three-quarters feet.
- 30 (The porticoes of the gateways around the inner court were twenty-five cubits wide and five cubits deep.)
- 31 Each vestibule faced the outside courtyard. Palm trees were carved on its doorposts. Eight steps led up to it.
- 31 Its portico faced the outer court; palm trees decorated its jambs, and eight steps led up to it.
- 32 He then took me to the inside courtyard on the east and measured the gate complex. It was identical to the others--
- 32 Then he brought me to the inner court on the east side, and he measured the gateway; it had the same measurements as the others.
- 33 alcoves, connecting walls, and vestibule all the same. The gate complex and vestibule had windows all around. It measured eighty-seven and a half by forty-three and three-quarters feet.
- 33 Its alcoves, its projecting walls and its portico had the same measurements as the others. The gateway and its portico had openings all around. It was fifty cubits long and twenty-five cubits wide.
- 34 Its porch faced the outside courtyard. There were palm trees on the doorposts on both sides. And it had eight steps.
- 34 Its portico faced the outer court; palm trees decorated the jambs on either side, and eight steps led up to it.
- 35 He brought me to the gate complex to the north and measured it: same measurements.
- 35 Then he brought me to the north gate and measured it. It had the same measurements as the others,
- 36 The alcoves, connecting walls, and vestibule with its windows: eighty-seven and a half by forty-three and three-quarters feet.
- 36 as did its alcoves, its projecting walls and its portico, and it had openings all around. It was fifty cubits long and twenty-five cubits wide.
- 37 Its porch faced the outside courtyard. There were palm trees on its doorposts on both sides. And it had eight steps.
- 37 Its portico faced the outer court; palm trees decorated the jambs on either side, and eight steps led up to it.

- 38 There was a room with a door at the vestibule of the gate complex where the burnt offerings were cleaned.
- 38 A room with a doorway was by the portico in each of the inner gateways, where the burnt offerings were washed.
- 39 Two tables were placed within the vestibule, one on either side, on which the animals for burnt offerings, sin offerings, and guilt offerings were slaughtered.
- 39 In the portico of the gateway were two tables on each side, on which the burnt offerings, sin offerings and guilt offerings were slaughtered.
- 40 Two tables were also placed against both outside walls of the vestibule--
- 40 By the outside wall of the portico of the gateway, near the steps at the entrance to the north gateway were two tables, and on the other side of the steps were two tables.
- 41 four tables inside and four tables outside, eight tables in all for slaughtering the sacrificial animals.
- 41 So there were four tables on one side of the gateway and four on the other--eight tables in all--on which the sacrifices were slaughtered.
- 42 The four tables used for the burnt offerings were thirty-one and a half inches square and twenty-one inches high. The tools for slaughtering the sacrificial animals and other sacrifices were kept there.
- 42 There were also four tables of dressed stone for the burnt offerings, each a cubit and a half long, a cubit and a half wide and a cubit high. On them were placed the utensils for slaughtering the burnt offerings and the other sacrifices.
- 43 Meat hooks, three inches long, were fastened to the walls. The tables were for the sacrificial animals.
- 43 And double-pronged hooks, each a handbreadth long, were attached to the wall all around. The tables were for the flesh of the offerings.
- 44 Right where the inside gate complex opened onto the inside courtyard there were two rooms, one at the north gate facing south and the one at the south gate facing north.
- 44 Outside the inner gate, within the inner court, were two rooms, one at the side of the north gate and facing south, and another at the side of the south gate and facing north.
- 45 The man told me, "The room facing south is for the priests who are in charge of the Temple.

- 45 He said to me, "The room facing south is for the priests who have charge of the temple,
- 46 And the room facing north is for the priests who are in charge of the altar. These priests are the sons of Zadok, the only sons of Levi permitted to come near to GOD to serve him."
- 46 and the room facing north is for the priests who have charge of the altar. These are the sons of Zadok, who are the only Levites who may draw near to the LORD to minister before him."
- 47 He measured the inside courtyard: a hundred seventy-five feet square. The altar was in front of the Temple.
- 47 Then he measured the court: It was square--a hundred cubits long and a hundred cubits wide. And the altar was in front of the temple.
- 48 He led me to the porch of the Temple and measured the gateposts of the porch: eight and three-quarters feet high on both sides.
- 48 He brought me to the portico of the temple and measured the jambs of the portico; they were five cubits wide on either side. The width of the entrance was fourteen cubits and its projecting walls were three cubits wide on either side.
- 49 The entrance to the gate complex was twenty-one feet wide and its connecting walls were four and a half feet thick. The vestibule itself was thirty-five feet wide and twenty-one feet deep. Ten steps led up to the porch. Columns flanked the gateposts.
- 49 The portico was twenty cubits wide, and twelve cubits from front to back. It was reached by a flight of stairs, and there were pillars on each side of the jambs.

Ezekiel 41

MSG

NIV

- 1 He brought me into the Temple itself and measured the doorposts on each side. Each was ten and a half feet thick.
- 1 Then the man brought me to the outer sanctuary and measured the jambs; the width of the jambs was six cubits on each side.
- 2 The entrance was seventeen and a half feet wide. The walls on each side were eight and three-quarters feet thick. He also measured the Temple

Sanctuary: seventy feet by thirty-five feet.

- 2 The entrance was ten cubits wide, and the projecting walls on each side of it were five cubits wide. He also measured the outer sanctuary; it was forty cubits long and twenty cubits wide.
- 3 He went further in and measured the doorposts at the entrance: Each was three and a half feet thick. The entrance itself was ten and a half feet wide, and the entrance walls were twelve and a quarter feet thick.
- 3 Then he went into the inner sanctuary and measured the jambs of the entrance; each was two cubits wide. The entrance was six cubits wide, and the projecting walls on each side of it were seven cubits wide.
- 4 He measured the inside Sanctuary, thirty-five feet square, set at the end of the main Sanctuary. He told me, "This is The Holy of Holies."
- 4 And he measured the length of the inner sanctuary; it was twenty cubits, and its width was twenty cubits across the end of the outer sanctuary. He said to me, "This is the Most Holy Place."
- 5 He measured the wall of the Temple. It was ten and a half feet thick. The side rooms around the Temple were seven feet wide.
- 5 Then he measured the wall of the temple; it was six cubits thick, and each side room around the temple was four cubits wide.
- 6 There were three floors of these side rooms, thirty rooms on each of the three floors. There were supporting beams around the Temple wall to hold up the side rooms, but they were freestanding, not attached to the wall itself.
- 6 The side rooms were on three levels, one above another, thirty on each level. There were ledges all around the wall of the temple to serve as supports for the side rooms, so that the supports were not inserted into the wall of the temple.
- 7 The side rooms around the Temple became wider from first floor to second floor to third floor. A staircase went from the bottom floor, through the middle, and then to the top floor.
- 7 The side rooms all around the temple were wider at each successive level. The structure surrounding the temple was built in ascending stages, so that the rooms widened as one went upward. A stairway went up from the lowest floor to the top floor through the middle floor.
- 8 I observed that the Temple had a ten-and-a-half-foot-thick raised base around it, which provided a foundation for the side rooms.

- 8 I saw that the temple had a raised base all around it, forming the foundation of the side rooms. It was the length of the rod, six long cubits.
- 9 The outside walls of the side rooms were eight and three-quarters feet thick. The open area between the side rooms of the Temple
- 9 The outer wall of the side rooms was five cubits thick. The open area between the side rooms of the temple
- 10 and the priests' rooms was a thirty-five-foot-wide strip all around the Temple.
- 10 and the priests' rooms was twenty cubits wide all around the temple.
- 11 There were two entrances to the side rooms from the open area, one placed on the north side, the other on the south. There were eight and three-quarters feet of open space all around.
- 11 There were entrances to the side rooms from the open area, one on the north and another on the south; and the base adjoining the open area was five cubits wide all around.
- 12 The house that faced the Temple courtyard to the west was one hundred twenty-two and a half feet wide, with eight-and-three-quarters-foot-thick walls. The length of the wall and building was one hundred fifty-seven and a half feet.
- 12 The building facing the temple courtyard on the west side was seventy cubits wide. The wall of the building was five cubits thick all around, and its length was ninety cubits.
- 13 He measured the Temple: one hundred seventy-five feet long. The Temple courtyard and the house, including its walls, measured a hundred seventy-five feet.
- 13 Then he measured the temple; it was a hundred cubits long, and the temple courtyard and the building with its walls were also a hundred cubits long.
- 14 The breadth of the front of the Temple and the open area to the east was a hundred seventy-five feet.
- 14 The width of the temple courtyard on the east, including the front of the temple, was a hundred cubits.
- 15 He measured the length of the house facing the courtyard at the back of the Temple, including the shelters on each side: one hundred seventy-

- five feet. The main Sanctuary, the inner Sanctuary, and the vestibule facing the courtyard
- 15 Then he measured the length of the building facing the courtyard at the rear of the temple, including its galleries on each side; it was a hundred cubits. The outer sanctuary, the inner sanctuary and the portico facing the court,
- 16 were paneled with wood, and had window frames and door frames in all three sections. From floor to windows the walls were paneled.
- 16 as well as the thresholds and the narrow windows and galleries around the three of them--everything beyond and including the threshold was covered with wood. The floor, the wall up to the windows, and the windows were covered.
- 17 Above the outside entrance to the inner Sanctuary and on the walls at regular intervals all around the inner Sanctuary and the main Sanctuary,
- 17 In the space above the outside of the entrance to the inner sanctuary and on the walls at regular intervals all around the inner and outer sanctuary
- 18 angel-cherubim and palm trees were carved in alternating sequence. Each angel-cherub had two faces:
- 18 were carved cherubim and palm trees. Palm trees alternated with cherubim. Each cherub had two faces:
- 19 a human face toward the palm tree on the right and the face of a lion toward the palm tree on the left. They were carved around the entire Temple.
- 19 the face of a man toward the palm tree on one side and the face of a lion toward the palm tree on the other. They were carved all around the whole temple.
- 20 The cherubim-palm tree motif was carved from floor to door height on the wall of the main Sanctuary.
- 20 From the floor to the area above the entrance, cherubim and palm trees were carved on the wall of the outer sanctuary.
- 21 The main Sanctuary had a rectangular doorframe. In front of the Holy Place was something that looked like
- 21 The outer sanctuary had a rectangular doorframe, and the one at the front of the Most Holy Place was similar.
- 22 an altar of wood, five and a quarter feet high and three and a half feet square. Its corners, base, and sides were of wood. The man said to me,

"This is the table that stands before GOD."

22 There was a wooden altar three cubits high and two cubits square; its corners, its base and its sides were of wood. The man said to me, "This is the table that is before the LORD."

23 Both the main Sanctuary and the Holy Place had double doors.

23 Both the outer sanctuary and the Most Holy Place had double doors.

24 Each door had two leaves: two hinged leaves for each door, one set swinging inward and the other set outward.

24 Each door had two leaves--two hinged leaves for each door.

25 The doors of the main Sanctuary were carved with angel-cherubim and palm trees. There was a canopy of wood in front of the vestibule outside.

25 And on the doors of the outer sanctuary were carved cherubim and palm trees like those carved on the walls, and there was a wooden overhang on the front of the portico.

26 There were narrow windows alternating with carved palm trees on both sides of the porch.

26 On the sidewalls of the portico were narrow windows with palm trees carved on each side. The side rooms of the temple also had overhangs.

Ezekiel 42

MSG

NIV

1 The man led me north into the outside courtyard and brought me to the rooms that are in front of the open space and the house facing north.

1 Then the man led me northward into the outer court and brought me to the rooms opposite the temple courtyard and opposite the outer wall on the north side.

2 The length of the house on the north was one hundred seventy-five feet, and its width eighty-seven and a half feet.

2 The building whose door faced north was a hundred cubits long and fifty cubits wide.

3 Across the thirty-five feet that separated the inside courtyard from the paved walkway at the edge of the outside courtyard, the rooms rose level by level for three stories.

- 3 Both in the section twenty cubits from the inner court and in the section opposite the pavement of the outer court, gallery faced gallery at the three levels.
- 4 In front of the rooms on the inside was a hallway seventeen and a half feet wide and one hundred seventy-five feet long. Its entrances were from the north.
- 4 In front of the rooms was an inner passageway ten cubits wide and a hundred cubits long. Their doors were on the north.
- 5 The upper rooms themselves were narrower, their galleries being wider than on the first and second floors of the building.
- 5 Now the upper rooms were narrower, for the galleries took more space from them than from the rooms on the lower and middle floors of the building.
- 6 The rooms on the third floor had no pillars like the pillars in the outside courtyard and were smaller than the rooms on the first and second floors.
- 6 The rooms on the third floor had no pillars, as the courts had; so they were smaller in floor space than those on the lower and middle floors.
- 7 There was an outside wall parallel to the rooms and the outside courtyard. It fronted the rooms for eighty-seven and a half feet.
- 7 There was an outer wall parallel to the rooms and the outer court; it extended in front of the rooms for fifty cubits.
- 8 The row of rooms facing the outside courtyard was eighty-seven and a half feet long. The row on the side nearest the Sanctuary was one hundred seventy-five feet long.
- 8 While the row of rooms on the side next to the outer court was fifty cubits long, the row on the side nearest the sanctuary was a hundred cubits long.
- 9 The first-floor rooms had their entrance from the east, coming in from the outside courtyard.
- 9 The lower rooms had an entrance on the east side as one enters them from the outer court.
- 10 On the south side along the length of the courtyard's outside wall and fronting on the Temple courtyard were rooms
- 10 On the south side along the length of the wall of the outer court, adjoining the temple courtyard and opposite the outer wall, were rooms

- 11 with a walkway in front of them. These were just like the rooms on the north--same exits and dimensions--with the main entrance from the east leading to the hallway and the doors to the rooms the same as those on the north side.
- 11 with a passageway in front of them. These were like the rooms on the north; they had the same length and width, with similar exits and dimensions. Similar to the doorways on the north
- 12 The design on the south was a mirror image of that on the north.
- 12 were the doorways of the rooms on the south. There was a doorway at the beginning of the passageway that was parallel to the corresponding wall extending eastward, by which one enters the rooms.
- 13 Then he said to me, "The north and south rooms adjacent to the open area are holy rooms where the priests who come before GOD eat the holy offerings. There they place the holy offerings--grain offerings, sin offerings, and guilt offerings. These are set-apart rooms, holy space.
- 13 Then he said to me, "The north and south rooms facing the temple courtyard are the priests' rooms, where the priests who approach the LORD will eat the most holy offerings. There they will put the most holy offerings--the grain offerings, the sin offerings and the guilt offerings--for the place is holy.
- 14 After the priests have entered the Sanctuary, they must not return to the outside courtyard and mingle among the people until they change the sacred garments in which they minister and put on their regular clothes."
- 14 Once the priests enter the holy precincts, they are not to go into the outer court until they leave behind the garments in which they minister, for these are holy. They are to put on other clothes before they go near the places that are for the people."
- 15 After he had finished measuring what was inside the Temple area, he took me out the east gate and measured it from the outside.
- 15 When he had finished measuring what was inside the temple area, he led me out by the east gate and measured the area all around:
- 16 Using his measuring stick, he measured the east side: eight hundred seventy-five feet.
- 16 He measured the east side with the measuring rod; it was five hundred cubits.
- 17 He measured the north side: eight hundred seventy-five feet.

- 17 He measured the north side; it was five hundred cubits by the measuring rod.
- 18 He measured the south side: eight hundred seventy-five feet.
- 18 He measured the south side; it was five hundred cubits by the measuring rod.
- 19 Last of all he went to the west side and measured it: eight hundred seventy-five feet.
- 19 Then he turned to the west side and measured; it was five hundred cubits by the measuring rod.
- 20 He measured the wall on all four sides. Each wall was eight hundred seventy-five feet. The walls separated the holy from the ordinary.
- 20 So he measured the area on all four sides. It had a wall around it, five hundred cubits long and five hundred cubits wide, to separate the holy from the common.

Ezekiel 43

MSG

NIV

- 1 The man brought me to the east gate.
- 1 Then the man brought me to the gate facing east,
- 2 Oh! The bright Glory of the God of Israel rivered out of the east sounding like the roar of floodwaters, and the earth itself glowed with the bright Glory.
- 2 and I saw the glory of the God of Israel coming from the east. His voice was like the roar of rushing waters, and the land was radiant with his glory.
- 3 It looked just like what I had seen when he came to destroy the city, exactly like what I had seen earlier at the Kebar River. And again I fell, face to the ground.
- 3 The vision I saw was like the vision I had seen when he came to destroy the city and like the visions I had seen by the Kebar River, and I fell facedown.
- 4 The bright Glory of GOD poured into the Temple through the east gate.
- 4 The glory of the LORD entered the temple through the gate facing east.

- 5 The Spirit put me on my feet and led me to the inside courtyard and--oh! the bright Glory of GOD filled the Temple!
- 5 Then the Spirit lifted me up and brought me into the inner court, and the glory of the LORD filled the temple.
- 6 I heard someone speaking to me from inside the Temple while the man stood beside me.
- 6 While the man was standing beside me, I heard someone speaking to me from inside the temple.
- 7 He said, "Son of man, this is the place for my throne, the place I'll plant my feet. This is the place where I'll live with the Israelites forever. Neither the people of Israel nor their kings will ever again drag my holy name through the mud with their whoring and the no-god idols their kings set up at all the wayside shrines.
- 7 He said: "Son of man, this is the place of my throne and the place for the soles of my feet. This is where I will live among the Israelites forever. The house of Israel will never again defile my holy name--neither they nor their kings--by their prostitution and the lifeless idols of their kings at their high places.
- 8 When they set up their worship shrines right alongside mine with only a thin wall between them, they dragged my holy name through the mud with their obscene and vile worship. Is it any wonder that I destroyed them in anger?
- 8 When they placed their threshold next to my threshold and their doorposts beside my doorposts, with only a wall between me and them, they defiled my holy name by their detestable practices. So I destroyed them in my anger.
- 9 So let them get rid of their whoring ways and the stinking no-god idols introduced by their kings and I'll move in and live with them forever.
- 9 Now let them put away from me their prostitution and the lifeless idols of their kings, and I will live among them forever.
- 10 "Son of man, tell the people of Israel all about the Temple so they'll be dismayed by their wayward lives. Get them to go over the layout.
- 10 Son of man, describe the temple to the people of Israel, that they may be ashamed of their sins. Let them consider the plan,
- 11 That will bring them up short. Show them the whole plan of the Temple, its ins and outs, the proportions, the regulations, and the laws. Draw a

picture so they can see the design and meaning and live by its design and intent.

- 11 and if they are ashamed of all they have done, make known to them the design of the temple--its arrangement, its exits and entrances--its whole design and all its regulations and laws. Write these down before them so that they may be faithful to its design and follow all its regulations.
- 12 "This is the law of the Temple: As it radiates from the top of the mountain, everything around it becomes holy ground. Yes, this is law, the meaning, of the Temple.
- 12 This is the law of the temple: All the surrounding area on top of the mountain will be most holy. Such is the law of the temple.
- 13 "These are the dimensions of the altar, using the long (twenty-one-inch) ruler. The gutter at its base is twenty-one inches
- 13 These are the measurements of the altar in long cubits, that cubit being a cubit and a handbreadth: Its gutter is a cubit deep and a cubit wide, with a rim of one span around the edge. And this is the height of the altar:
- 14 deep and twenty-one inches wide, with a four-inch lip around its edge. "The height of the altar is three and a half feet from the base to the first ledge and twenty inches wide. From the first ledge to the second ledge it is seven feet high and twenty-one inches wide.
- 14 From the gutter on the ground up to the lower ledge it is two cubits high and a cubit wide, and from the smaller ledge up to the larger ledge it is four cubits high and a cubit wide.
- 15 The altar hearth is another seven feet high. Four horns stick upward from the hearth twenty-one inches high.
- 15 The altar hearth is four cubits high, and four horns project upward from the hearth.
- 16 "The top of the altar, the hearth, is square, twenty-one by twenty-one feet.
- 16 The altar hearth is square, twelve cubits long and twelve cubits wide.
- 17 The upper ledge is also square, twenty-four and a half feet on each side, with a ten-and-a-half-inch lip and a twenty-one-inch-wide gutter all the way around. "The steps of the altar ascend from the east."
- 17 The upper ledge also is square, fourteen cubits long and fourteen cubits wide, with a rim of half a cubit and a gutter of a cubit all around. The steps of the altar face east."

- 18 Then the man said to me, "Son of man, GOD, the Master, says: 'These are the ordinances for conduct at the altar when it is built, for sacrificing burnt offerings and sprinkling blood on it.
- 18 Then he said to me, "Son of man, this is what the Sovereign LORD says: These will be the regulations for sacrificing burnt offerings and sprinkling blood upon the altar when it is built:
- 19 "'For a sin offering, give a bull to the priests, the Levitical priests who are from the family of Zadok who come into my presence to serve me.
- 19 You are to give a young bull as a sin offering to the priests, who are Levites, of the family of Zadok, who come near to minister before me, declares the Sovereign LORD.
- 20 Take some of its blood and smear it on the four horns of the altar that project from the four corners of the top ledge and all around the lip. That's to purify the altar and make it fit for the sacrifice.
- 20 You are to take some of its blood and put it on the four horns of the altar and on the four corners of the upper ledge and all around the rim, and so purify the altar and make atonement for it.
- 21 Then take the bull for the sin offerings and burn it in the place set aside for this in the courtyard outside the Sanctuary.
- 21 You are to take the bull for the sin offering and burn it in the designated part of the temple area outside the sanctuary.
- 22 "'On the second day, offer a male goat without blemish for a sin offering. Purify the altar the same as you purified it for the bull.
- 22 On the second day you are to offer a male goat without defect for a sin offering, and the altar is to be purified as it was purified with the bull.
- 23 Then, when you have purified it, offer a bull without blemish and a ram without blemish from the flock.
- 23 When you have finished purifying it, you are to offer a young bull and a ram from the flock, both without defect.
- 24 Present them before GOD. Sprinkle salt on them and offer them as a burnt offering to GOD.
- 24 You are to offer them before the LORD, and the priests are to sprinkle salt on them and sacrifice them as a burnt offering to the LORD.
- 25 "'For seven days, prepare a goat for a sin offering daily, and also a bull and a ram from the flock, animals without blemish.

- 25 For seven days you are to provide a male goat daily for a sin offering; you are also to provide a young bull and a ram from the flock, both without defect.
- 26 For seven days the priests are to get the altar ready for its work, purifying it. This is how you dedicate it.
- 26 For seven days they are to make atonement for the altar and cleanse it; thus they will dedicate it.
- 27 "'After these seven days of dedication, from the eighth day on, the priests will present your burnt offerings and your peace offerings. And I'll accept you with pleasure, with delight! Decree of GOD, the Master.'"
- 27 At the end of these days, from the eighth day on, the priests are to present your burnt offerings and fellowship offerings on the altar. Then I will accept you, declares the Sovereign LORD."

Ezekiel 44

MSG

NIV

- 1 Then the man brought me back to the outside gate complex of the Sanctuary that faces east. But it was shut.
- 1 Then the man brought me back to the outer gate of the sanctuary, the one facing east, and it was shut.
- 2 GOD spoke to me: "This gate is shut and it's to stay shut. No one is to go through it because GOD, the God of Israel, has gone through it. It stays shut.
- 2 The LORD said to me, "This gate is to remain shut. It must not be opened; no one may enter through it. It is to remain shut because the LORD, the God of Israel, has entered through it.
- 3 Only the prince, because he's the prince, may sit there to eat in the presence of GOD. He is to enter the gate complex through the porch and leave by the same way."
- 3 The prince himself is the only one who may sit inside the gateway to eat in the presence of the LORD. He is to enter by way of the portico of the gateway and go out the same way."
- 4 The man led me through the north gate to the front of the Temple. I looked, and--oh!--the bright Glory of GOD filling the Temple of GOD! I

fell on my face in worship.

- 4 Then the man brought me by way of the north gate to the front of the temple. I looked and saw the glory of the LORD filling the temple of the LORD, and I fell facedown.
- 5 GOD said to me, "Son of man, get a grip on yourself. Use your eyes, use your ears, pay careful attention to everything I tell you about the ordinances of this Temple of GOD, the way all the laws work, instructions regarding it and all the entrances and exits of the Sanctuary.
- 5 The LORD said to me, "Son of man, look carefully, listen closely and give attention to everything I tell you concerning all the regulations regarding the temple of the LORD. Give attention to the entrance of the temple and all the exits of the sanctuary.
- 6 "Tell this bunch of rebels, this family Israel, 'Message of GOD, the Master: No more of these vile obscenities, Israel,
- 6 Say to the rebellious house of Israel, 'This is what the Sovereign LORD says: Enough of your detestable practices, O house of Israel!
- 7 dragging irreverent and unrepentant outsiders, uncircumcised in heart and flesh, into my Sanctuary, feeding them the sacrificial offerings as if it were the food for a neighborhood picnic. With all your vile obscenities, you've broken trust with me, the solemn covenant I made with you.
- 7 In addition to all your other detestable practices, you brought foreigners uncircumcised in heart and flesh into my sanctuary, desecrating my temple while you offered me food, fat and blood, and you broke my covenant.
- 8 You haven't taken care of my holy things. You've hired out the work to foreigners who care nothing for this place, my Sanctuary.
- 8 Instead of carrying out your duty in regard to my holy things, you put others in charge of my sanctuary.
- 9 No irreverent and unrepentant aliens, uncircumcised in heart or flesh, not even the ones who live among Israelites, are to enter my Sanctuary.'
- 9 This is what the Sovereign LORD says: No foreigner uncircumcised in heart and flesh is to enter my sanctuary, not even the foreigners who live among the Israelites.
- 10 "The Levites who walked off and left me, along with everyone else--all Israel--who took up with all the no-god idols, will pay for everything they did wrong.

- 10 'The Levites who went far from me when Israel went astray and who wandered from me after their idols must bear the consequences of their sin.
- 11 From now on they'll do only the menial work in the Sanctuary: guard the gates and help out with the Temple chores--and also kill the sacrificial animals for the people and serve them.
- 11 They may serve in my sanctuary, having charge of the gates of the temple and serving in it; they may slaughter the burnt offerings and sacrifices for the people and stand before the people and serve them.
- 12 Because they acted as priests to the no-god idols and made my people Israel stumble and fall, I've taken an oath to punish them. Decree of GOD, the Master. Yes, they'll pay for what they've done.
- 12 But because they served them in the presence of their idols and made the house of Israel fall into sin, therefore I have sworn with uplifted hand that they must bear the consequences of their sin, declares the Sovereign LORD.
- 13 They're fired from the priesthood. No longer will they come into my presence and take care of my holy things. No more access to The Holy Place! They'll have to live with what they've done, carry the shame of their vile and obscene lives.
- 13 They are not to come near to serve me as priests or come near any of my holy things or my most holy offerings; they must bear the shame of their detestable practices.
- 14 From now on, their job is to sweep up and run errands. That's it.
- 14 Yet I will put them in charge of the duties of the temple and all the work that is to be done in it.
- 15 "But the Levitical priests who descend from Zadok, who faithfully took care of my Sanctuary when everyone else went off and left me, are going to come into my presence and serve me. They are going to carry out the priestly work of offering the solemn sacrifices of worship. Decree of GOD, the Master.
- 15 'But the priests, who are Levites and descendants of Zadok and who faithfully carried out the duties of my sanctuary when the Israelites went astray from me, are to come near to minister before me; they are to stand before me to offer sacrifices of fat and blood, declares the Sovereign LORD.

- 16 They're the only ones permitted to enter my Sanctuary. They're the only ones to approach my table and serve me, accompanying me in my work.
- 16 They alone are to enter my sanctuary; they alone are to come near my table to minister before me and perform my service.
- 17 "When they enter the gate complex of the inside courtyard, they are to dress in linen. No woolens are to be worn while serving at the gate complex of the inside courtyard or inside the Temple itself.
- 17 "When they enter the gates of the inner court, they are to wear linen clothes; they must not wear any woolen garment while ministering at the gates of the inner court or inside the temple.
- 18 They're to wear linen turbans on their heads and linen underclothes--nothing that makes them sweat.
- 18 They are to wear linen turbans on their heads and linen undergarments around their waists. They must not wear anything that makes them perspire.
- 19 When they go out into the outside courtyard where the people gather, they must first change out of the clothes they have been serving in, leaving them in the sacred rooms where they change to their everyday clothes, so that they don't trivialize their holy work by the way they dress.
- 19 When they go out into the outer court where the people are, they are to take off the clothes they have been ministering in and are to leave them in the sacred rooms, and put on other clothes, so that they do not consecrate the people by means of their garments.
- 20 "They are to neither shave their heads nor let their hair become unkempt, but must keep their hair trimmed and neat.
- 20 "They must not shave their heads or let their hair grow long, but they are to keep the hair of their heads trimmed.
- 21 "No priest is to drink on the job--no wine while in the inside courtyard.
- 21 No priest is to drink wine when he enters the inner court.
- 22 "Priests are not to marry widows or divorcees, but only Israelite virgins or widows of priests.
- 22 They must not marry widows or divorced women; they may marry only virgins of Israelite descent or widows of priests.
- 23 "Their job is to teach my people the difference between the holy and the common, to show them how to discern between unclean and clean.

- 23 They are to teach my people the difference between the holy and the common and show them how to distinguish between the unclean and the clean.
- 24 "When there's a difference of opinion, the priests will arbitrate. They'll decide on the basis of my judgments, laws, and statutes. They are in charge of making sure the appointed feasts are honored and my Sabbaths kept holy in the ways I've commanded.
- 24 'In any dispute, the priests are to serve as judges and decide it according to my ordinances. They are to keep my laws and my decrees for all my appointed feasts, and they are to keep my Sabbaths holy.
- 25 "A priest must not contaminate himself by going near a corpse. But when the dead person is his father or mother, son or daughter, brother or unmarried sister, he can approach the dead.
- 25 'A priest must not defile himself by going near a dead person; however, if the dead person was his father or mother, son or daughter, brother or unmarried sister, then he may defile himself.
- 26 But after he has been purified, he must wait another seven days.
- 26 After he is cleansed, he must wait seven days.
- 27 Then, when he returns to the inside courtyard of the Sanctuary to do his priestly work in the Sanctuary, he must first offer a sin offering for himself. Decree of GOD, the Master.
- 27 On the day he goes into the inner court of the sanctuary to minister in the sanctuary, he is to offer a sin offering for himself, declares the Sovereign LORD.
- 28 "As to priests owning land, I am their inheritance. Don't give any land in Israel to them. I am their 'land,' their inheritance.
- 28 'I am to be the only inheritance the priests have. You are to give them no possession in Israel; I will be their possession.
- 29 They'll take their meals from the grain offerings, the sin offerings, and the guilt offerings. Everything in Israel offered to GOD in worship is theirs.
- 29 They will eat the grain offerings, the sin offerings and the guilt offerings; and everything in Israel devoted to the LORD will belong to them.
- 30 The best of everything grown, plus all special gifts, comes to the priests. All that is given in worship to GOD goes to them. Serve them first.

Serve from your best and your home will be blessed.

30 The best of all the firstfruits and of all your special gifts will belong to the priests. You are to give them the first portion of your ground meal so that a blessing may rest on your household.

31 "Priests are not to eat any meat from bird or animal unfit for ordinary human consumption, such as carcasses found dead on the road or in the field.

31 The priests must not eat anything, bird or animal, found dead or torn by wild animals.

Ezekiel 45

MSG

NIV

1 "When you divide up the inheritance of the land, you must set aside part of the land as sacred space for GOD: approximately seven miles long by six miles wide, all of it holy ground.

1 'When you allot the land as an inheritance, you are to present to the LORD a portion of the land as a sacred district, 25,000 cubits long and 20,000 cubits wide; the entire area will be holy.

2 Within this rectangle, reserve a seven-hundred-fifty-foot square for the Sanctuary with a seventy-five-foot buffer zone surrounding it.

2 Of this, a section 500 cubits square is to be for the sanctuary, with 50 cubits around it for open land.

3 Mark off within the sacred reserve a section seven miles long by three miles wide. The Sanctuary with its Holy of Holies will be placed there.

3 In the sacred district, measure off a section 25,000 cubits long and 10,000 cubits wide. In it will be the sanctuary, the Most Holy Place.

4 This is where the priests will live, those who lead worship in the Sanctuary and serve GOD there. Their houses will be there along with The Holy Place.

4 It will be the sacred portion of the land for the priests, who minister in the sanctuary and who draw near to minister before the LORD. It will be a place for their houses as well as a holy place for the sanctuary.

5 "To the north of the sacred reserve, an area roughly seven miles long and two and a quarter miles wide will be set aside as land for the villages of

- the Levites who administer the affairs of worship in the Sanctuary.
- 5 An area 25,000 cubits long and 10,000 cubits wide will belong to the Levites, who serve in the temple, as their possession for towns to live in.
- 6 "To the south of the sacred reserve, measure off a section seven miles long and about a mile and a half wide for the city itself, an area held in common by the whole family of Israel.
- 6 'You are to give the city as its property an area 5,000 cubits wide and 25,000 cubits long, adjoining the sacred portion; it will belong to the whole house of Israel.
- 7 "The prince gets the land abutting the seven-mile east and west borders of the central sacred square, extending eastward toward the Jordan and westward toward the Mediterranean.
- 7 'The prince will have the land bordering each side of the area formed by the sacred district and the property of the city. It will extend westward from the west side and eastward from the east side, running lengthwise from the western to the eastern border parallel to one of the tribal portions.
- 8 This is the prince's possession in Israel. My princes will no longer bully my people, running roughshod over them. They'll respect the land as it has been allotted to the tribes.
- 8 This land will be his possession in Israel. And my princes will no longer oppress my people but will allow the house of Israel to possess the land according to their tribes.
- 9 "This is the Message of GOD, the Master: 'I've put up with you long enough, princes of Israel! Quit bullying and taking advantage of my people. Do what's just and right for a change.
- 9 'This is what the Sovereign LORD says: You have gone far enough, O princes of Israel! Give up your violence and oppression and do what is just and right. Stop dispossessing my people, declares the Sovereign LORD.
- 10 Use honest scales--honest weights and honest measures.
- 10 You are to use accurate scales, an accurate ephah and an accurate bath.
- 11 Every pound must have sixteen ounces. Every gallon must measure four quarts. The ounce is the basic measure for both.
- 11 The ephah and the bath are to be the same size, the bath containing a tenth of a homer and the ephah a tenth of a homer; the homer is to be the

standard measure for both.

12 And your coins must be honest--no wooden nickels!

12 The shekel is to consist of twenty gerahs. Twenty shekels plus twenty-five shekels plus fifteen shekels equal one mina.

13 "These are the prescribed offerings you are to supply: one-sixtieth part of your wheat, one-sixtieth part of your barley,

13 'This is the special gift you are to offer: a sixth of an ephah from each homer of wheat and a sixth of an ephah from each homer of barley.

14 one-hundredth part of your oil,

14 The prescribed portion of oil, measured by the bath, is a tenth of a bath from each cor (which consists of ten baths or one homer, for ten baths are equivalent to a homer).

15 one sheep out of every two hundred from the lush pastures of Israel. These will be used for the grain offerings, burnt offerings, and peace offerings for making the atonement sacrifices for the people. Decree of GOD, the Master.

15 Also one sheep is to be taken from every flock of two hundred from the well-watered pastures of Israel. These will be used for the grain offerings, burnt offerings and fellowship offerings to make atonement for the people, declares the Sovereign LORD.

16 "Everyone in the land must contribute to these special offerings that the prince in Israel will administer.

16 All the people of the land will participate in this special gift for the use of the prince in Israel.

17 It's the prince's job to provide the burnt offerings, grain offerings, and drink offerings at the Holy Festivals, the New Moons, and the Sabbaths--all the commanded feasts among the people of Israel. Sin offerings, grain offerings, burnt offerings, and peace offerings for making atonement for the people of Israel are his responsibility.

17 It will be the duty of the prince to provide the burnt offerings, grain offerings and drink offerings at the festivals, the New Moons and the Sabbaths--at all the appointed feasts of the house of Israel. He will provide the sin offerings, grain offerings, burnt offerings and fellowship offerings to make atonement for the house of Israel.

18 "This is the Message from GOD, the Master: On the first day of the first month, take an unblemished bull calf and purify the Sanctuary.

- 18 'This is what the Sovereign LORD says: In the first month on the first day you are to take a young bull without defect and purify the sanctuary.
- 19 The priest is to take blood from the sin offerings and rub it on the doorposts of the Temple, on the four corners of the ledge of the altar, and on the gate entrance to the inside courtyard.
- 19 The priest is to take some of the blood of the sin offering and put it on the doorposts of the temple, on the four corners of the upper ledge of the altar and on the gateposts of the inner court.
- 20 Repeat this ritual on the seventh day of the month for anyone who sins without knowing it. In this way you make atonement for the Temple.
- 20 You are to do the same on the seventh day of the month for anyone who sins unintentionally or through ignorance; so you are to make atonement for the temple.
- 21 "'On the fourteenth day of the first month, you will observe the Passover, a feast of seven days. During the feast you will eat bread made without yeast.
- 21 'In the first month on the fourteenth day you are to observe the Passover, a feast lasting seven days, during which you shall eat bread made without yeast.
- 22 "'On Passover, the prince supplies a bull as a sin offering for himself and all the people of the country.
- 22 On that day the prince is to provide a bull as a sin offering for himself and for all the people of the land.
- 23 Each day for each of the seven days of the feast, he will supply seven bulls and seven rams unblemished as a burnt offering to GOD, and also each day a male goat.
- 23 Every day during the seven days of the Feast he is to provide seven bulls and seven rams without defect as a burnt offering to the LORD, and a male goat for a sin offering.
- 24 "'He will supply about five and a half gallons of grain offering and a gallon of oil for each bull and each ram.
- 24 He is to provide as a grain offering an ephah for each bull and an ephah for each ram, along with a hin of oil for each ephah.
- 25 "'On the fifteenth day of the seventh month, and on each of the seven days of the feast, he is to supply the same materials for sin offerings, burnt offerings, grain offerings, and oil.

25 'During the seven days of the Feast, which begins in the seventh month on the fifteenth day, he is to make the same provision for sin offerings, burnt offerings, grain offerings and oil.

Ezekiel 46

MSG

NIV

- 1 "'Message from GOD, the Master: The gate of the inside courtyard on the east is to be shut on the six working days, but open on the Sabbath. It is also to be open on the New Moon.
- 1 'This is what the Sovereign LORD says: The gate of the inner court facing east is to be shut on the six working days, but on the Sabbath day and on the day of the New Moon it is to be opened.
- 2 The prince will enter through the entrance area of the gate complex and stand at the gateposts as the priests present his burnt offerings and peace offerings while he worships there on the porch. He will then leave, but the gate won't be shut until evening.
- 2 The prince is to enter from the outside through the portico of the gateway and stand by the gatepost. The priests are to sacrifice his burnt offering and his fellowship offerings. He is to worship at the threshold of the gateway and then go out, but the gate will not be shut until evening.
- 3 On Sabbaths and New Moons, the people are to worship before GOD at the outside entrance to that gate complex.
- 3 On the Sabbaths and New Moons the people of the land are to worship in the presence of the LORD at the entrance to that gateway.
- 4 "'The prince supplies for GOD the burnt offering for the Sabbath--six unblemished lambs and an unblemished ram.
- 4 The burnt offering the prince brings to the LORD on the Sabbath day is to be six male lambs and a ram, all without defect.
- 5 The grain offering to go with the ram is about five and a half gallons plus a gallon of oil, and a handful of grain for each lamb.
- 5 The grain offering given with the ram is to be an ephah, and the grain offering with the lambs is to be as much as he pleases, along with a hin of oil for each ephah.

- 6 ""At the New Moon he is to supply a bull calf, six lambs, and a ram, all without blemish.
- 6 On the day of the New Moon he is to offer a young bull, six lambs and a ram, all without defect.
- 7 He will also supply five and a half gallons of grain offering and a gallon of oil for both ram and bull, and a handful of grain offering for each lamb.
- 7 He is to provide as a grain offering one ephah with the bull, one ephah with the ram, and with the lambs as much as he wants to give, along with a hin of oil with each ephah.
- 8 ""When the prince enters, he will go through the entrance vestibule of the gate complex and leave the same way.
- 8 When the prince enters, he is to go in through the portico of the gateway, and he is to come out the same way.
- 9 ""But when the people of the land come to worship GOD at the commanded feasts, those who enter through the north gate will exit from the south gate, and those who enter though the south gate will exit from the north gate. You don't exit the gate through which you enter, but through the opposite gate.
- 9 'When the people of the land come before the LORD at the appointed feasts, whoever enters by the north gate to worship is to go out the south gate; and whoever enters by the south gate is to go out the north gate. No one is to return through the gate by which he entered, but each is to go out the opposite gate.
- 10 The prince is to be there, mingling with them, going in and out with them.
- 10 The prince is to be among them, going in when they go in and going out when they go out.
- 11 ""At the festivals and the commanded feasts, the appropriate grain offering is five and a half gallons, with a gallon of oil for the bull and ram and a handful of grain for each lamb.
- 11 'At the festivals and the appointed feasts, the grain offering is to be an ephah with a bull, an ephah with a ram, and with the lambs as much as one pleases, along with a hin of oil for each ephah.
- 12 ""When the prince brings a freewill offering to GOD, whether a burnt offering or a peace offering, the east gate is to be opened for him. He

offers his burnt or peace offering the same as he does on the Sabbath. Then he leaves, and after he is out, the gate is shut.

- 12 When the prince provides a freewill offering to the LORD-- whether a burnt offering or fellowship offerings--the gate facing east is to be opened for him. He shall offer his burnt offering or his fellowship offerings as he does on the Sabbath day. Then he shall go out, and after he has gone out, the gate will be shut.
- 13 "Every morning you are to bring a yearling lamb unblemished for a burnt offering to GOD.
- 13 'Every day you are to provide a year-old lamb without defect for a burnt offering to the LORD; morning by morning you shall provide it.
- 14 Also, every morning bring a grain offering of about a gallon of grain with a quart or so of oil to moisten it. Presenting this grain offering to GOD is standard procedure.
- 14 You are also to provide with it morning by morning a grain offering, consisting of a sixth of an ephah with a third of a hin of oil to moisten the flour. The presenting of this grain offering to the LORD is a lasting ordinance.
- 15 The lamb, the grain offering, and the oil for the burnt offering are a regular daily ritual.
- 15 So the lamb and the grain offering and the oil shall be provided morning by morning for a regular burnt offering.
- 16 "A Message from GOD, the Master: If the prince deeds a gift from his inheritance to one of his sons, it stays in the family.
- 16 'This is what the Sovereign LORD says: If the prince makes a gift from his inheritance to one of his sons, it will also belong to his descendants; it is to be their property by inheritance.
- 17 But if he deeds a gift from his inheritance to a servant, the servant keeps it only until the year of liberation (the Jubilee year). After that, it comes back to the prince. His inheritance is only for his sons. It stays in the family.
- 17 If, however, he makes a gift from his inheritance to one of his servants, the servant may keep it until the year of freedom; then it will revert to the prince. His inheritance belongs to his sons only; it is theirs.
- 18 The prince must not take the inheritance from any of the people, dispossessing them of their land. He can give his sons only what he

- himself owns. None of my people are to be run off their land."
- 18 The prince must not take any of the inheritance of the people, driving them off their property. He is to give his sons their inheritance out of his own property, so that none of my people will be separated from his property.' "
- 19 Then the man brought me through the north gate into the holy chambers assigned to the priests and showed me a back room to the west.
- 19 Then the man brought me through the entrance at the side of the gate to the sacred rooms facing north, which belonged to the priests, and showed me a place at the western end.
- 20 He said, "This is the kitchen where the priests will cook the guilt offering and sin offering and bake the grain offering so that they won't have to do it in the outside courtyard and endanger the unprepared people out there with The Holy."
- 20 He said to me, "This is the place where the priests will cook the guilt offering and the sin offering and bake the grain offering, to avoid bringing them into the outer court and consecrating the people."
- 21 He proceeded to take me to the outside courtyard and around to each of its four corners. In each corner I observed another court.
- 21 He then brought me to the outer court and led me around to its four corners, and I saw in each corner another court.
- 22 In each of the four corners of the outside courtyard were smaller courts sixty by forty-five feet, each the same size.
- 22 In the four corners of the outer court were enclosed courts, forty cubits long and thirty cubits wide; each of the courts in the four corners was the same size.
- 23 On the inside walls of the courts was a stone shelf, and beneath the shelves, hearths for cooking.
- 23 Around the inside of each of the four courts was a ledge of stone, with places for fire built all around under the ledge.
- 24 He said, "These are the kitchens where those who serve in the Temple will cook the sacrifices of the people."
- 24 He said to me, "These are the kitchens where those who minister at the temple will cook the sacrifices of the people."

Ezekiel 47

MSG

NIV

- 1 Now he brought me back to the entrance to the Temple. I saw water pouring out from under the Temple porch to the east (the Temple faced east). The water poured from the south side of the Temple, south of the altar.
- 1 The man brought me back to the entrance of the temple, and I saw water coming out from under the threshold of the temple toward the east (for the temple faced east). The water was coming down from under the south side of the temple, south of the altar.
- 2 He then took me out through the north gate and led me around the outside to the gate complex on the east. The water was gushing from under the south front of the Temple.
- 2 He then brought me out through the north gate and led me around the outside to the outer gate facing east, and the water was flowing from the south side.
- 3 He walked to the east with a measuring tape and measured off fifteen hundred feet, leading me through water that was ankle-deep.
- 3 As the man went eastward with a measuring line in his hand, he measured off a thousand cubits and then led me through water that was ankle-deep.
- 4 He measured off another fifteen hundred feet, leading me through water that was knee-deep. He measured off another fifteen hundred feet, leading me through water waist-deep.
- 4 He measured off another thousand cubits and led me through water that was knee-deep. He measured off another thousand and led me through water that was up to the waist.
- 5 He measured off another fifteen hundred feet. By now it was a river over my head, water to swim in, water no one could possibly walk through.
- 5 He measured off another thousand, but now it was a river that I could not cross, because the water had risen and was deep enough to swim in--a river that no one could cross.

- 6 He said, "Son of man, have you had a good look?" Then he took me back to the riverbank.
- 6 He asked me, "Son of man, do you see this?" Then he led me back to the bank of the river.
- 7 While sitting on the bank, I noticed a lot of trees on both sides of the river.
- 7 When I arrived there, I saw a great number of trees on each side of the river.
- 8 He told me, "This water flows east, descends to the Arabah and then into the sea, the sea of stagnant waters. When it empties into those waters, the sea will become fresh.
- 8 He said to me, "This water flows toward the eastern region and goes down into the Arabah, where it enters the Sea. When it empties into the Sea, the water there becomes fresh.
- 9 Wherever the river flows, life will flourish--great schools of fish--because the river is turning the salt sea into fresh water. Where the river flows, life abounds.
- 9 Swarms of living creatures will live wherever the river flows. There will be large numbers of fish, because this water flows there and makes the salt water fresh; so where the river flows everything will live.
- 10 Fishermen will stand shoulder to shoulder along the shore from En-gedi all the way north to En-eglaim, casting their nets. The sea will teem with fish of all kinds, like the fish of the Great Mediterranean.
- 10 Fishermen will stand along the shore; from En Gedi to En Eglaim there will be places for spreading nets. The fish will be of many kinds--like the fish of the Great Sea.
- 11 "The swamps and marshes won't become fresh. They'll stay salty.
- 11 But the swamps and marshes will not become fresh; they will be left for salt.
- 12 "But the river itself, on both banks, will grow fruit trees of all kinds. Their leaves won't wither, the fruit won't fail. Every month they'll bear fresh fruit because the river from the Sanctuary flows to them. Their fruit will be for food and their leaves for healing."
- 12 Fruit trees of all kinds will grow on both banks of the river. Their leaves will not wither, nor will their fruit fail. Every month they will bear,

because the water from the sanctuary flows to them. Their fruit will serve for food and their leaves for healing."

13 A Message from GOD, the Master: "These are the boundaries by which you are to divide up the inheritance of the land for the twelve tribes of Israel, with Joseph getting two parcels.

13 This is what the Sovereign LORD says: "These are the boundaries by which you are to divide the land for an inheritance among the twelve tribes of Israel, with two portions for Joseph.

14 It is to be divided up equally. I swore in a solemn oath to give it to your ancestors, swore that this land would be your inheritance.

14 You are to divide it equally among them. Because I swore with uplifted hand to give it to your forefathers, this land will become your inheritance.

15 "These are the boundaries of the land: "The northern boundary runs from the Great Mediterranean Sea along the Hethlon road to where you turn off to the entrance of Hamath, Zedad,

15 This is to be the boundary of the land: On the north side it will run from the Great Sea by the Hethlon road past Lebo Hamath to Zedad,

16 Berothah, and Sibraim, which lies between the territory of Damascus and the territory of Hamath, and on to Hazer-hatticon on the border of Hauran.

16 Berothah and Sibraim (which lies on the border between Damascus and Hamath), as far as Hazer Hatticon, which is on the border of Hauran.

17 The boundary runs from the Sea to Hazer-enon, with the territories of Damascus and Hamath to the north. That is the northern boundary.

17 The boundary will extend from the sea to Hazer Enan, along the northern border of Damascus, with the border of Hamath to the north. This will be the north boundary.

18 "The eastern boundary runs between Damascus and Hauran, down along the Jordan between Gilead and the land of Israel to the Eastern Sea as far as Tamar. This is the eastern boundary.

18 On the east side the boundary will run between Hauran and Damascus, along the Jordan between Gilead and the land of Israel, to the eastern sea and as far as Tamar. This will be the east boundary.

19 "The southern boundary runs west from Tamar to the waters of Meribah-kadesh, along the Brook of Egypt, and out to the Great

- Mediterranean Sea. This is the southern boundary.
- 19 On the south side it will run from Tamar as far as the waters of Meribah Kadesh, then along the Wadi of Egypt to the Great Sea. This will be the south boundary.
- 20 "The western boundary is formed by the Great Mediterranean Sea north to where the road turns east toward the entrance to Hamath. This is the western boundary.
- 20 On the west side, the Great Sea will be the boundary to a point opposite Lebo Hamath. This will be the west boundary.
- 21 "Divide up this land among the twelve tribes of Israel.
- 21 You are to distribute this land among yourselves according to the tribes of Israel.
- 22 Divide it up as your inheritance, and include in it the resident aliens who have made themselves at home among you and now have children. Treat them as if they were born there, just like yourselves. They also get an inheritance among the tribes of Israel.
- 22 You are to allot it as an inheritance for yourselves and for the aliens who have settled among you and who have children. You are to consider them as native-born Israelites; along with you they are to be allotted an inheritance among the tribes of Israel.
- 23 In whatever tribe the resident alien lives, there he gets his inheritance. Decree of GOD, the Master.
- 23 In whatever tribe the alien settles, there you are to give him his inheritance," declares the Sovereign LORD.

Ezekiel 48

MSG

NIV

- 1 "These are the tribes: "Dan: one portion, along the northern boundary, following the Hethlon road that turns off to the entrance of Hamath as far as Hazor-enon so that the territory of Damascus lies to the north alongside Hamath, the northern border stretching from east to west.
- 1 These are the tribes, listed by name: At the northern frontier, Dan will have one portion; it will follow the Hethlon road to Lebo Hamath; Hazar

- Enan and the northern border of Damascus next to Hamath will be part of its border from the east side to the west side.
- 2 "Asher: one portion, bordering Dan from east to west.
2 Asher will have one portion; it will border the territory of Dan from east to west.
- 3 "Naphtali: one portion, bordering Asher from east to west.
3 Naphtali will have one portion; it will border the territory of Asher from east to west.
- 4 "Manasseh: one portion, bordering Naphtali from east to west.
4 Manasseh will have one portion; it will border the territory of Naphtali from east to west.
- 5 "Ephraim: one portion, bordering Manasseh from east to west.
5 Ephraim will have one portion; it will border the territory of Manasseh from east to west.
- 6 "Reuben: one portion, bordering Ephraim from east to west.
6 Reuben will have one portion; it will border the territory of Ephraim from east to west.
- 7 "Judah: one portion, bordering Reuben from east to west.
7 Judah will have one portion; it will border the territory of Reuben from east to west.
- 8 "Bordering Judah from east to west is the consecrated area that you will set aside as holy: a square approximately seven by seven miles, with the Sanctuary set at the center.
- 8 Bordering the territory of Judah from east to west will be the portion you are to present as a special gift. It will be 25,000 cubits wide, and its length from east to west will equal one of the tribal portions; the sanctuary will be in the center of it.
- 9 The consecrated area reserved for GOD is to be seven miles long and a little less than three miles wide.
- 9 The special portion you are to offer to the LORD will be 25,000 cubits long and 10,000 cubits wide.
- 10 "This is how it will be parceled out. The priest will get the area measuring seven miles on the north and south boundaries, with a width of a little more than three miles at the east and west boundaries. The Sanctuary of GOD will be at the center.

- 10 This will be the sacred portion for the priests. It will be 25,000 cubits long on the north side, 10,000 cubits wide on the west side, 10,000 cubits wide on the east side and 25,000 cubits long on the south side. In the center of it will be the sanctuary of the LORD.
- 11 This is for the consecrated priests, the Zadokites who stayed true in their service to me and didn't get off track as the Levites did when Israel wandered off the main road.
- 11 This will be for the consecrated priests, the Zadokites, who were faithful in serving me and did not go astray as the Levites did when the Israelites went astray.
- 12 This is their special gift, a gift from the land itself, most holy ground, bordering the section of the Levites.
- 12 It will be a special gift to them from the sacred portion of the land, a most holy portion, bordering the territory of the Levites.
- 13 "The Levites get a section equal in size to that of the priests, roughly seven by three miles.
- 13 Alongside the territory of the priests, the Levites will have an allotment 25,000 cubits long and 10,000 cubits wide. Its total length will be 25,000 cubits and its width 10,000 cubits.
- 14 They are not permitted to sell or trade any of it. It's the choice part of the land, to say nothing of being holy to GOD.
- 14 They must not sell or exchange any of it. This is the best of the land and must not pass into other hands, because it is holy to the LORD.
- 15 "What's left of the 'sacred square'--each side measures out at seven miles by a mile and a half--is for ordinary use: the city and its buildings with open country around it, but the city at the center.
- 15 The remaining area, 5,000 cubits wide and 25,000 cubits long, will be for the common use of the city, for houses and for pastureland. The city will be in the center of it
- 16 The north, south, east, and west sides of the city are each about a mile and a half in length.
- 16 and will have these measurements: the north side 4,500 cubits, the south side 4,500 cubits, the east side 4,500 cubits, and the west side 4,500 cubits.
- 17 A strip of pasture, one hundred twenty-five yards wide, will border the city on all sides.

- 17 The pastureland for the city will be 250 cubits on the north, 250 cubits on the south, 250 cubits on the east, and 250 cubits on the west.
- 18 The remainder of this portion, three miles of countryside to the east and to the west of the sacred precinct, is for farming. It will supply food for the city.
- 18 What remains of the area, bordering on the sacred portion and running the length of it, will be 10,000 cubits on the east side and 10,000 cubits on the west side. Its produce will supply food for the workers of the city.
- 19 Workers from all the tribes of Israel will serve as field hands to farm the land.
- 19 The workers from the city who farm it will come from all the tribes of Israel.
- 20 "This dedicated area, set apart for holy purposes, will be a square, seven miles by seven miles, a 'holy square,' which includes the part set aside for the city.
- 20 The entire portion will be a square, 25,000 cubits on each side. As a special gift you will set aside the sacred portion, along with the property of the city.
- 21 "The rest of this land, the country stretching east to the Jordan and west to the Mediterranean from the seven-mile sides of the 'holy square,' belongs to the prince. His land is sandwiched between the tribal portions north and south, and goes out both east and west from the 'sacred square' with its Temple at the center.
- 21 What remains on both sides of the area formed by the sacred portion and the city property will belong to the prince. It will extend eastward from the 25,000 cubits of the sacred portion to the eastern border, and westward from the 25,000 cubits to the western border. Both these areas running the length of the tribal portions will belong to the prince, and the sacred portion with the temple sanctuary will be in the center of them.
- 22 The land set aside for the Levites on one side and the city on the other is in the middle of the territory assigned to the prince. The 'sacred square' is flanked east and west by the prince's land and bordered on the north and south by the territories of Judah and Benjamin respectively.
- 22 So the property of the Levites and the property of the city will lie in the center of the area that belongs to the prince. The area belonging to the prince will lie between the border of Judah and the border of Benjamin.

- 23 "And then the rest of the tribes: "Benjamin: one portion, stretching from the eastern to the western boundary.
- 23 As for the rest of the tribes: Benjamin will have one portion; it will extend from the east side to the west side.
- 24 "Simeon: one portion, bordering Benjamin from east to west.
- 24 Simeon will have one portion; it will border the territory of Benjamin from east to west.
- 25 "Issachar: one portion, bordering Simeon from east to west.
- 25 Issachar will have one portion; it will border the territory of Simeon from east to west.
- 26 "Zebulun: one portion, bordering Issachar from east to west.
- 26 Zebulun will have one portion; it will border the territory of Issachar from east to west.
- 27 "Gad: one portion, bordering Zebulun from east to west.
- 27 Gad will have one portion; it will border the territory of Zebulun from east to west.
- 28 "The southern boundary of Gad will run south from Tamar to the waters of Meribah-kadesh, along the Brook of Egypt and then out to the Great Mediterranean Sea.
- 28 The southern boundary of Gad will run south from Tamar to the waters of Meribah Kadesh, then along the Wadi of Egypt to the Great Sea.
- 29 "This is the land that you are to divide up among the tribes of Israel as their inheritance. These are their portions." Decree of GOD, the Master.
- 29 This is the land you are to allot as an inheritance to the tribes of Israel, and these will be their portions, declares the Sovereign LORD.
- 30 "These are the gates of the city. On the north side, which is 2,250 yards long
- 30 These will be the exits of the city: Beginning on the north side, which is 4,500 cubits long,
- 31 (the gates of the city are named after the tribes of Israel), three gates: the gate of Reuben, the gate of Judah, the gate of Levi.
- 31 the gates of the city will be named after the tribes of Israel. The three gates on the north side will be the gate of Reuben, the gate of Judah and the gate of Levi.
- 32 "On the east side, measuring 2,250 yards, three gates: the gate of Joseph, the gate of Benjamin, the gate of Dan.

- 32 On the east side, which is 4,500 cubits long, will be three gates: the gate of Joseph, the gate of Benjamin and the gate of Dan.
- 33 "On the south side, measuring 2,250 yards, three gates: the gate of Simeon, the gate of Issachar, the gate of Zebulun.
- 33 On the south side, which measures 4,500 cubits, will be three gates: the gate of Simeon, the gate of Issachar and the gate of Zebulun.
- 34 "On the west side, measuring 2,250 yards, three gates: the gate of Gad, the gate of Asher, the gate of Naphtali.
- 34 On the west side, which is 4,500 cubits long, will be three gates: the gate of Gad, the gate of Asher and the gate of Naphtali.
- 35 "The four sides of the city measure to a total of nearly six miles. "From now on the name of the city will be YAHWEH-SHAMMAH: "GOD-IS-THERE."
- 35 The distance all around will be 18,000 cubits. And the name of the city from that time on will be: THE LORD IS THERE."